

Golden Moments of Reflection

The Thirty-Fifth Annual Meeting of the General Service Conference of Alcoholics Anonymous

1985

Final Report

**Roosevelt Hotel
New York City
April 14—20**

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Regional Map Of U.S. and Canada

A.A. Regional Forums: See trustee committee and staff reports, pages 42-43.

Regional trustees: See talks by retiring trustees, pages 6, 9; report of trustees' Nominating Committee, pages 44-45; new trustees, page 53; brief biographies, pages 62-63.

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35th Conference Celebrates 50 Years

Opening day

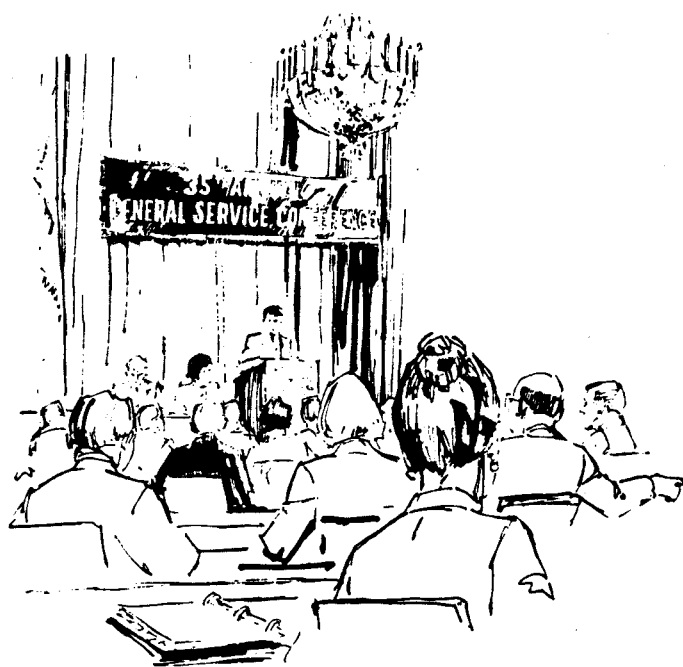
The 35th General Service Conference was held at the Roosevelt Hotel in New York City on April 14-20, 1985. The Conference theme, "Golden Moments of Reflection," was a unifying force throughout the week as Conference members assessed the Fellowship's growth and progress during its first 50 years. This week-long A.A. business meeting (representing the collective group conscience of A.A. in the U.S. and Canada) included delegates from the Conference areas of the U.S. and Canada (Panels 34 and 35), trustees (alcoholic and nonalcoholic), A.A.W.S. and Grapevine directors, G.S.O. and Grapevine staffs, and many hard-working behind-the-scenes personnel.

A trusted servants' sharing session, held on Sunday afternoon, allowed Conference members time to become acquainted and feel more at ease. Lois Fisher (G.S.O. staff) opened the proceedings and introduced Gordon Patrick (chairperson of the General Service Board), John Bragg (G.S.O. general manager), and Dale Skelton (Panel 34, Southwest Ohio/Northern Kentucky), delegate chairperson. Mary Ann Bagi (Panel 34, New Mexico), alternate delegate chairperson, served as moderator.

The sharing session provided new Conference members with the opportunity to become familiarized with all who comprise the Conference and their different points of view and contributions. All speakers who participated expressed in various ways their gratitude for sobriety and for their service responsibilities. Dr. John Norris, trustee emeritus, shared a vision of the Fellowship's future (and past) as being "the road less traveled"—the group conscience road—which is the reason A.A. has survived. He urged Conference members to find the collective group conscience during the coming week and to listen for the voice of the Higher Power, A.A.'s only authority: "We must make sure that we listen enough." The sharing session was followed by regional trustees' orientation sessions for Panels 34 and 35 delegates.

On Sunday evening, the Grand Ballroom of the Roosevelt "came alive" as Conference members and guests gathered for dinner and fellowship. The dinner was followed by an A.A. meeting. Bob Pearson (chairperson, general services) extended a gracious welcome to all and then introduced Tillie McNulty (Panel 34, New Hampshire), chairperson of the A.A. meeting. Ken Beck-erich (Panel 34, Oregon) led the meeting and introduced the following speakers: Gene Austin (Grapevine staff), Sue Wieland (Panel 34, Hudson/Mohawk/Berkshire), Frank Rice (Panel 34, Georgia), Cheryl Ann Burke (G.S.O. staff), and Jack Ford (trustee-at-large/Canada). These A.A.'s shared moments from their active alcoholism and their recovery in A.A. Each speaker expressed gratitude for the gift of A.A.—a "legacy of life."

The 35th Conference began officially on Monday morning when Conference members convened in the Terrace Room. Gordon Patrick opened the proceedings with reassuring words of trust in the Fellowship. He reminded Conference members that they are "custodians" of A.A.'s Steps, Traditions, and Legacies and urged them to trust that the Higher Power is in charge of the Fellowship and the Conference. John Bragg conducted roll call, and then Dale Skelton, delegate chairperson, gave the welcoming talk. Michael Alexander (Class A trustee) gave the keynote address, which chronicled his own "golden moments" with the Fellowship. (Condensed versions of the welcome and keynote addresses are given on page 6.) Following Gordon Patrick's General Service Board report, Conference members began to apply themselves to the week's rigorous agenda, including countless committee meetings, reports, presentation/discussion sessions, workshops, a sharing session, and an Ask-It Basket session.



Committee reports and discussion took place on Thursday and Friday. Each committee recommendation was discussed and voted upon by the full Conference. During these proceedings, it was evident that the Higher Power was indeed in charge of the Conference. The smooth-flowing deliberations and voting reflected an informed collective conscience and a willingness to trust our committee system (see Advisory Actions, page 50).

Early on Friday afternoon, a "What's on Your Mind?" sharing session gave Conference members time to share pressing concerns. The following topics were discussed: Conference-approved literature; the availability of A.A. literature for the native North American population (Advisory Action No. 1, page 50); the need for more Spanish A.A. literature; translation of the three Workbooks into Spanish (Advisory Action No. 2, page 50); how one becomes a director; the increasing numbers of pre-teens coming to A.A.; gratitude to A.A.'s nonalcoholic trustees; and praise for the Grapevine.

Later on Friday afternoon, Conference members listened to several inspiring presentations on the Conference theme, "Golden Moments of Reflection," followed by a closing talk given by Dennis Manders (G.S.O. controller/business administrator).

The closing brunch on Saturday morning was a time of reaffirmation and renewal. Rotating trustees bid farewell, and Conference members shared their last precious "golden moments" together. About to depart for various places in the U.S. and Canada, delegates and trustees renewed their commitments to their common bond in service—to carry the message of the Conference to their areas so that the hand of A.A. will continue to be there "when-ever anyone, anywhere reaches out for help." The 35th Conference—a significant landmark on A.A.'s "road less traveled."

A reply to an invitation to attend the Conference opening dinner read as follows: "Regrets—too old and too poor! But getting an invitation is great! Good meeting to you! (P.S.: Today is my 32nd A.A. birthday. Thanks! Thanks! Thanks!)"

Welcome

'A vision-stretching process'

Reflecting on last year's Conference, I thought that I had arrived at the Conference with an open mind, but soon discovered differently. I assumed that all areas were structured the same as ours. What a rude awakening I had! I discovered that my mind was not completely open, and that I had better talk to my Higher Power about this. From that moment, things were different. I put God back in the driver's seat and learned to listen to all of you. Then I could truly share with you.

On Monday, I could feel the presence of a loving God through you, just as I can today. On Thursday and Friday, during the committee reports and discussion, the Conference seemed to start to pull apart; but the presence of a Higher Power came through, and unanimity was achieved. Before we knew it, the Conference was over. We all grew a little bit. I left with a feeling that Bill Wilson so aptly described as "a vision-stretching process."

As we start this 35th General Service Conference, let us share to our fullest this week. We are all here for one purpose: our concern for our Fellowship. Let us have faith in a loving and guiding Higher Power, trust in our committee system, and trust in one another. This will enable us to leave this Conference with a tremendous bond of unity—that unity and trust which continues to ensure the future of A.A. Also, we will be able to carry with us "Golden Moments of Reflection."

Dale Skelton (Southwestern Ohio/Northern Kentucky)

Keynote

Special golden moments

This year, with deep gratitude, we are celebrating the 50th anniversary of the birth of the Fellowship of Alcoholics Anonymous, and we also are celebrating the 35th anniversary of the convening of the General Service Conference. The story of Bill W. and Dr. Bob, in large measure, is the story of A.A., and it is filled with "Golden Moments of Reflection." Like beauty in the eyes of the beholder, these golden moments are whatever our minds make them out to be.



Each time we think of Bill Wilson, Dr. Bob Smith, Lois Wilson, Bernard B. Smith, Dr. John Norris, or Dr. Milton Maxwell, it is a brilliant moment because without them and others like them there would be no A.A. (at least not the way we know it today). Each time an alcoholic realizes that, by the grace of God and the help of A.A., he has been sober for an hour, a day, a month, or a year, it is a lustrous moment because at that instant that alcoholic is both sober and sane. Each time our hand reaches out to an alcoholic who needs A.A., it is a priceless moment because we cannot save ourselves without saving others.

Bill W. and Dr. Bob first met a few weeks before A.A. came into existence. That first meeting is a radiant moment in A.A.—improbable but inevitable. Alone in Akron, Bill felt a desperate need to share his alcoholic plight with another alcoholic. A name chosen at random from a bulletin board led Bill to a sympathetic minister who gave him ten names to call. Nine either failed to respond or offered little encouragement. The tenth brought Bill and Dr. Bob together. It was, indeed, an improbable meeting, but it also was inevitable because a Higher Power surely ordained it.

I was introduced to A.A. in 1952. It is a special moment of reflection for me. Bill Wilson and Bernard Smith (who was then chairperson of the Board of Trustees) were deeply involved with the fledgling General Service Conference and the charter, which was to make the Conference a permanent fixture. As I watched those two talented and devoted men struggle with the A.A. structure, I sensed that I was a witness to history and, perhaps, in a very small way, a participant in it. Their prodigious efforts led to the Conference Charter and the transfer of functions from the A.A. founders to the A.A. Conference in 1955. It was a marvelous development for A.A.—one that offers a precious moment of reflection for us.

The Conference Charter is a delicate and sensitive balance of interests among the A.A. elements, allowing each to discharge responsibilities without interference from the others. The Charter also is a guard against impulsive and imprudent action in A.A. Each time the Charter prevents a dispute, induces tolerance, or prompts restraint, it is a magnificent moment for A.A.

With a spark of inspiration, Bill Wilson and Dr. Bob Smith kindled the flame of Alcoholics Anonymous and, as long as they lived, shielded the flame from all the ill winds that blew its way. Now we are the keepers of the flame; and, with God's help, we, too, will keep it burning for as long as there is an alcoholic who needs it.

Michael Alexander (Class A trustee)

Clearly in God's hands

Many visitors, Conference delegates, G.S.O. staff members, and past trustees and delegates gathered in the G.S.O. fifth-floor conference room on Friday, April 12, for a special pre-Conference 4-6-8 Meeting of A.A. Anticipation, awe, gratitude, and joy were expressed for the Conference and for the gift of sobriety. Visitors and newcomers were amazed at the diversity of A.A.'s attending the meeting. Most pre-Conference "jitters" were dispelled as A.A. members reaffirmed that the Conference itself, as well as our own lives, is clearly in God's hands.



Delegates' meeting

On Tuesday evening, Panels 34 and 35 delegates dined together and then met informally. The agenda included presentations, discussions, a sharing session, and election of officers. Mary Reynolds (Eastern Massachusetts) was elected the new delegate chairperson; Dick Klaras (Southern Minnesota), the alternate delegate chairperson. Because of their exceptional quality, the delegates voted to have the presentations distributed with other Conference presentations and excerpted here.

Responsibilities of a delegate

I feel that my responsibilities go far beyond the suggestions on pages 54-56 of "The A.A. Service Manual." I believe that I must always keep an open mind and be willing to lend an ear when a fellow A.A. is experiencing difficulties and keep all channels of communication open so we may always be able to reach the suffering alcoholic. Becoming a delegate and experiencing the fulfillment of my duties have been the most rewarding and growing part of my life. I now have a better awareness of the responsibilities we all have toward unity.

It is a delegate's responsibility to ensure that the area officers, D.C.M.'s, and G.S.R.'s are living up to their obligations. The delegate must make the effort to assure every A.A. member that he or she is a vital part of our Fellowship and make certain that he or she understands the Third Legacy procedure (especially current G.S.R.'s, area officers, and D.C.M.'s). It is a delegate's responsibility to ensure that the area utilizes the available communication tools so that more people may want to become involved in service.

Let us always keep in mind, whatever our job or responsibilities may be in A.A., that always and forever our primary purpose—to maintain our own sobriety and help the suffering alcoholic—is what this program is all about.

M. Lee Forsythe (New Brunswick/Prince Edward Island)

Recipe for gratitude

John Quinn (Panel 35, Northern New Jersey) had an unforgettable "then-and-now" experience during Conference week. It seems that John had haunted a bar only one block from the Roosevelt during his drinking days!

Communication

Communication within the Fellowship comes first, of course—not only because it is important to know what is happening throughout the world of A.A., but also because it helps us to become a part of the whole. In an area as scattered as my own, we depend upon all the members of the area committee, as well as the delegate, to carry the message of service and provide an update on what's happening. Therefore, we try very hard to exchange any information we receive. Having arrived at this Conference the first time as a newly elected alternate (and on very short notice), I realize how important it is to keep the alternate delegate fully informed.

Our D.C.M.'s have not always been considered as part of the area committee; but in the few short years that they have been included, most have taken their responsibilities seriously. They are contacted for input before making up the agenda for area assemblies; and many phone calls are made monthly to explore feelings on a subject or just to visit. Mini-roundups or workshops are held in each district, some of which have become very well established and well attended.

The groups are the most important and most difficult with which to maintain communication. I'm sure that worldwide many members of every group feel that by attending meetings and not drinking they are doing all they need to do to attain their concept of sobriety. If a G.S.R. is chosen from one of these members, chances are the lines of communication are broken right there. Sometimes we are fortunate to have an interested person elected G.S.R.—one who takes his job seriously (at first).

I believe personal contact is always the best form of communication. If a G.S.R. has become indifferent to the job, chances are he or she will not be too helpful to the newly elected G.S.R. Indifference breeds indifference, and we try a little gentle persuasion if we see it happening.

Agnes Krueger (North Dakota)

Service involvement

Involvement in service is generally an evolutionary process—the manner described in "The A.A. Service Manual" and used as a guideline by most areas. When we first arrive at A.A., most of us cannot present much more than a warm body, devoid of the physical, emotional, and spiritual growth we are there to find. Before long, someone has placed a broom in our shaking hands, and we start to feel that we belong. [I am a good (or bad) example of the "broom to sobriety" philosophy, and I know it works.] Becoming involved in the business of staying sober, we lose sight of most of our horrendous problems and find ourselves in the middle of service. If this were true of all A.A. members, we would need triple-primaries just to reduce the G.S.R. candidates to an acceptable number. Nearly all A.A. members are caring, loving people, yet a relative few are willing to make and keep the commitments required in service.

Sponsorship, particularly service sponsorship, is a positive and potential answer. This is the silent legacy of our Fellowship given to us by those who went before. It can spell the difference between survival and stagnation within the group, district, area, and A.A.W.S. We who are active in service need to transmit this

enthusiasm to those who follow into all levels of service. We need to remind those who pronounce their gratitude for this program that this carries a responsibility: Being grateful implies we will reciprocate (pay back) for what we have been given.

Soon it will be time for me to give serious thought to returning to the "end of the broom" as my contribution to service. No matter where I am in the service structure involvement, it is important for me to remember that the highest I can get in the program of recovery is *sober*!

Bob O'Rourke (Kansas)

Growth

What about the influx of newcomers from the courts, treatment centers, and other agencies? What about the rapid growth of our Fellowship, and how do we handle it? One way is to get newcomers involved in beginners meetings. As A.A. continues to grow, some of these newcomers may start a new group. What's wrong with starting a new group?

In our area, we have had meetings (not groups) that fail because they misunderstand our Traditions and lack leadership by experienced A.A. members. These meetings were held by former treatment center patients and newcomers. Perhaps if more time had been spent with newcomers, these meetings would not have failed. Helping newcomers to become familiar with our Traditions and involved is one way to keep them and also help us grow.

We will need more groups to handle the growth of our Fellowship. More groups mean more districts, and more districts mean a larger service area. More service-minded A.A. members are needed. In 1973, the Conference recommended that newcomers should learn about and become involved in the A.A. service structure as soon as possible. I wholeheartedly agree with this recommendation.

Lawrence Schuler (South Carolina)

Closing talk

A nonalcoholic G.S.O. employee delivered a memorable closing talk (excerpted below) to the 35th Conference late on Friday afternoon. Retiring this year, Dennis Manders shared a few "golden moments" from early Conferences (he has attended 35 Conferences).

'The golden moments are many'

As this Conference draws closer to its end, I am reminded that this will be the last one I will attend and I am taken back to the very first Conference. In 1951, General Service Headquarters (as G.S.O. was then known) was a small naive operation compared to today. Excluding Bill W., a total of 17 people were employed in the service of the Fellowship: five A.A.'s and 12 non-A.A.'s. In anticipation of the first Conference, the overriding emotion was "terror." Here we were, about to be scrutinized and "found out" by a bunch of out-of-state examiners (better known as "first-panel delegates"). When we realized that fear of the unknown had also infected those first delegates, we began to relax.

At the 1953 Conference someone requested a so-called "Gripe Box." I was asked to find one post haste. It had to be a fair-sized box with a slot in the top and a lock on it to keep it secure (or, more probably, anonymous). Where was I going to find one on such notice? I tried several stationery stores and other sources—to no avail. Feeling like a failure, I was walking back to the hotel (and the Conference) when I saw a marvelous fishing creel in the window of a sporting goods' store which seemed to fit the specifications. When I got back to the hotel, Hank Grieme (our general manager and my boss) gave me a peculiar look. Fortunately he did not ask how much it had cost. But, then again, I always say that cheap is cheap—after all, it has lasted for 32 years. In 1954 the Alcoholic Foundation officially became the General Service Board of A.A., and the G.S.R. Plan was born. The "Gripe Box" became the "Question Box" or "Questions Anonymous." In 1958 it became the beloved "Ask-It Basket."

My most memorable Conference was the ninth and final session of the 1955 Conference, held in the Kiel Auditorium in St. Louis, Missouri, and conducted as part of the closing session of the 20th Anniversary Convention. After much discussion, 76 delegates stood in silence for 30 seconds to invoke the guidance of the Higher Power before taking that crucial vote to adopt the permanent charter of the Conference structure.

I have shared just a few memories from the first five years. The "golden moments" are many; and I guess too many of those golden moments have put the silver in my hair. I cannot tell you how grateful I am to have been a part of all this, no matter how small. I count my blessings and my A.A. friends in the thousands. I would like to end with a phrase I have heard often through the years: Thank you for sharing!

Dennis I. Manders (G.S.O. controller/business administrator)

Estimates of Groups and Members— January 1, 1985

	Groups	Members
United States	31,754	630,679
Canada	4,286	71,632
Overseas	24,221 ¹	575,681 ²
Treatment facilities	1,047 ¹	26,175 ¹
Correctional facilities	1,552 ¹	46,560 ¹
Internationalists		555
Lone Members		511
	62,860	1,351,793

1 At the end of 1984, we had reported members from 66 of the 107 overseas countries with A.A. groups. These totaled 20,146 groups and 468,698 members. To establish an estimate for the 41 countries not yet replying, we excluded the eight largest responding and obtained an average of the balance. This average was applied to the 41, and the overall estimate emerged.

2 U.S. and Canada only.

The estimated group counts in the U.S. and Canada include only those that ask to be listed at G.S.O.; thousands do not.

Among listed groups in the U.S. and Canada, many do not report membership figures. For each nonreporting group, an estimate of membership is arrived at by taking an average among reporting groups within the Conference area concerned. Even among reporting groups, membership figures include only those now active and attending meetings; there is no way to count sober members who no longer have a home group.

Closing brunch

An outstanding Conference

On Saturday morning, members of the 35th General Service Conference came together for the last time to share a hearty brunch and bid farewell to Panel 34 delegates and rotating trustees. After the brunch, Gordon Patrick introduced Dale Skelton (Southwestern Ohio/Northern Kentucky), outgoing delegate chairperson. Dale thanked the delegates for being so well prepared and urged them to carry the Conference message to their areas. The new delegate chairperson, Mary Reynolds (Eastern Massachusetts), read "How It Works." Bob Pearson then expressed gratitude for the abundance of his life—all due to sobriety in A.A. Seeing the Conference as a time of rebirth and renewal for the Fellowship, Bob noted the outstanding nature of the 35th Conference and thanked all behind-the-scenes workers for their tireless efforts.

Trustees leaving the board were introduced by Gordon Patrick. Their brief talks are summarized here:

David Aronofsky, trustee-at-large/U.S., celebrated his 18th A.A. birthday during Conference week. Filled with vivid memories of "where he came from," David expressed gratitude for his sobriety and faith in the principle of rotation. David's wish for A.A. members was that they "may continue to let God bless us and keep us" by continuing to stay sober and help another alcoholic achieve sobriety. "It is not time to say goodbye," David concluded, "but *gracias, merci beaucoup, and thank you.*"

Michael Alexander, Class A trustee, shared that, during his nine years as trustee, "A.A. has been the most time-consuming element in my life other than sleep." Through the influence of A.A., Mike felt he had become a different, hopefully better, person. He noted particularly the compassion, humility, understanding, and kindness of A.A. members, with no limits on goodness. Thanking all for the many blessings received and for the profound privilege of having served, Mike bid the Conference, "*Auf Wiedersehen.*"

O. S. (Buck) Bruner, East Central U.S. regional trustee, reminded everyone that a silent miracle had taken place during Conference week—Buck didn't go to the microphone to speak all week! He thanked Conference members for the best Conference he ever attended, noting especially the serious hard work done by 1985 Conference members—working together with peace, equanimity, and cooperation. Reminding everyone that the Fellowship must "Keep It Simple" to survive, Buck also emphasized the tremendous debt A.A. owes its nonalcoholic friends. Buck said that he shall return to the most important job in A.A.—trying to be a good member of his own home group.

Jackie Solomon, general service trustee, highlighted her beginnings in the Fellowship and her service as trustee. Jackie spent much of her early sobriety volunteering her time at G.S.O. on 45th Street, New York City, where she worked at a table set up for her in Bill Wilson's office. Needless to say, those were formative years for her A.A. service life. Although saddened at having to leave her "A.A. family" on the board, Jackie affirmed the principle of rotation as a spiritual necessity.

Joe Kraus, Southeast U.S. regional trustee, reminded everyone that he had been "pulled out of the hat" as trustee. Looking at his past and present A.A. life, Joe asserted that he had been given much more than he could ever give back. Not worried about his



future—it seemed to be planned out for him—Joe was struck by how many thousands of lives must have been touched by members of the 35th Conference. Joe thanked everyone "for all you've given me."

Urging everyone to "keep passing it on," Gordon Patrick led members of the 35th General Service Conference in the Lord's Prayer.

Conference sidelights

A week of exciting activities was planned for spouses of Conference delegates by a committee of New York A.A.'s and Al-Anons. Monday, April 15: a trip to Chinatown; a visit to G.S.O. and Al-Anon offices. Tuesday: a tour of the Cloisters; lunch in Fort Tryon Park. Wednesday: a visit to the Metropolitan Museum of Art; an informal gathering at the home of a committee member; Thursday: a tour of Soho and Greenwich Village or a tour of South Street Seaport and historic Old New York. Friday: a Circle Line boat trip around Manhattan. . . . The following statistics (in years) give a composite sketch of the 1985 Conference delegate: age—from 35 to 74, averaging 53.8; length of sobriety—from 6 to 37, averaging 12.9; length of A.A. service activity—from 5 to 20, averaging 9.9.

At the pre-Conference A.A. meeting on Friday, April 25, past trustee Sam Smith (Florida) expressed gratitude for being invited to the Conference dinner each year. "However," he said dryly, "it's the only dinner that costs me \$700." . . . Sam also told of how his drinking brought him to live in a shack with two skid-row bums—a situation that continued for some time. Finally, the two bums kicked him out, saying, "Get out of here you skid-row bum!"

Presentations Spotlight A.A.'s Heritage

Will the hand of A.A. always be there?

On Monday morning, the first 1985 presentation/discussion session addressed a timely and thought-provoking topic. Buck Bruner, East Central U.S. regional trustee, served as moderator. (All presentations in this section have been condensed.)

The middle years of sobriety—a dangerous time

Webster defines "middle" as "halfway between two points," so we must assume that we have had a few years of sobriety. Could this point in our lives become one of lethargy and complacency? Yes, I think it can if we adopt a stand-still attitude—something an alcoholic can ill-afford. We must continue to grow or else deteriorate.

In my middle years of sobriety, I have been guilty of saying I am too busy with much more important matters now. That is a near perfect prescription for comfort and complacency. We know that the price of such self-satisfaction is an inevitable backslide, punctuated at some point by a very rude awakening.

We discover that we receive guidance for our lives to just about the extent that we stop making demands upon God to give it to us on order and on our terms. God will help us through our middle years or at any other point in our quest for sobriety if we just let Him and let it be His will, not ours.

Max Wilson (Nebraska)

Communication within the Fellowship

When I was elected delegate, I decided to concentrate on the districts that were not attending the assemblies and find out how we could help. They had become lost islands, unaware that their voice as a group conscience, expressed through the General Service Conference, became an active voice and the effective conscience of our whole society in its world affairs. Different problems presented themselves. Our lost districts are now attending our assemblies, and we are hoping to start a buddy system in our area to communicate on a more personal basis in sharing our service experience throughout the year.

Are we using the information we have? Last year, we were given the results of a survey which indicated that 31% of our members are coming to us from treatment centers. Will it be 51% or 81% in the next survey? Are we preparing ourselves? We must distinguish between wishful fantasy about a happy tomorrow and the present use of our powers of thoughtful estimate. This can spell the difference between future progress and unforeseen woe.

Are we listening? When I was given the gift of sobriety, I learned to listen to the emotions and thinking—to keep an open mind as well as an open heart. It is important to me to be an active "part of" an A.A. meeting, an assembly, or the Conference, which means to participate by either listening carefully or sharing when asked. Are we listening to things being said as well as not said, events that happen and do not happen, circumstances that lead us, but we do not follow? In other words, are we truly listening to the heartbeat of A.A.?



Our program has given us back our dreams and the ability to make our dreams come true. Bob and Bill and our early members wrote their visions of what should be in our Third Legacy, which we know today as the Twelve Concepts, to guide us. Are we allowing our reasons to become weak excuses, born through ego and self-righteousness, for not making their dream a reality? They gave us a Legacy, and it is up to us to "pass it on."

Kathleen Tartre (Alberta/Northwest Territories)

Are we diluting ourselves?

There is much concern today about A.A. trying to be "all things to all people." It is very difficult, if not impossible, to find a "pure alcoholic," whatever that may be! However, I feel that A.A.'s who become irate at meetings where other A.A.'s share their drug-using experience are cutting themselves off from full participation in A.A.

Some A.A. members feel that the spirit of meetings is being diluted by the presence of many persons referred by the courts or treatment centers. This may be perceived as a problem for meetings that have small attendance. But how is it a problem? I see it as a problem when treatment centers send people who have other compulsive disorders, without also being alcoholic, to closed A.A. meetings.

I wonder how much "viewing with alarm" we need to do. Two

things come to mind here: One is a sentence from the Big Book that says "... the realm of the Spirit is broad, roomy, all-inclusive, not dark and foreboding"; second, we can look at A.A. the day before the Jack Alexander article appeared in the *Saturday Evening Post* in 1941 and during the days after. Our Fellowship grew from 2,000 to about 8,000 in a few weeks. Not only did we survive this influx, but we devised new, more effective ways of communicating and carrying the message.

To attempt to please everyone is to please no one. Similarly, to try to gear an A.A. meeting to address all compulsive disorders is to fail in our primary purpose. I have seen meetings attempt this and fail, and then cease to exist. I have been to a few meetings where people with all kinds of addictions were allowed to share, and they were very strange gatherings indeed. Have you had similar experiences?

I feel that any perversion of our primary purpose, intended or not, spells doom for an A.A. group. As long as our motives are right, we can have confidence in our Higher Power to direct and protect us.

Tom McKay (San Diego, California)

Will the hand of A.A. always be there?

On Monday evening, Conference members participated in a workshop on the same theme as the morning's presentation/discussion. Small groups met in separate rooms; Panel 34 delegates, trustees, and directors served as moderators and reporters. The following is a summary of the reports from all rooms, giving both the general consensus and, in some cases, reactions from various groups.

1 Specifically, how does your group extend the hand of fellowship to newcomers? How does your group ensure that the hand of A.A. is always there for "oldtimers"?

Welcome newcomers with a smile and a handshake by having greeters at the door. Pay attention to them by talking to them before and after the meeting and perhaps inviting them for coffee or ice cream. Some groups provide "Beginners Kits" comprised of basic recovery pamphlets. (Such kits are prepared by the group and are *not* available from G.S.O.) Many groups provide temporary sponsors. Having meeting schedules available is important, and it's helpful if newcomers are offered transportation and accompanied to meetings. Many groups give beginners a Grapevine and encourage them to keep coming back. Making the newcomer feel he or she is the most important person in the room was stressed.

A message by fire

Millie Baeseman (Panel 35, Southern Wisconsin) told the story of an A.A. member who became disgruntled and stopped going to meetings. His sponsor visited him; he was greeted cordially and invited into the man's house. Sponsor and sponsee sat down in front of the fireplace and stared into the fire without exchanging words. After a while, the sponsor reached into the fire, took out a live coal, and placed it on the hearth. Still, neither man said a word. They stared at the live coal; in a short time, it went out. More silence. Finally, the sponsor left. On the next day, the sponsee returned to A.A. meetings.



Some groups direct their remarks to newcomers or emphasize Step One. Large groups might have a First Step table at discussion meetings or provide beginners meetings. (A Guide for Leading Beginners Meetings is available from G.S.O. for \$1.50.)

The chip system is used by some groups. Beginners are given "desire" chips at their first meeting and receive different chips at various intervals (three months, six months, one year, etc.).

Use of the telephone, encouragement to share and join a home group, and assuming responsibility in the group were emphasized.

Alkathons are helpful during major holidays, and many newcomers are attracted by conventions.

Finally, we can show by example that A.A. works.

Oldtimers also need to feel welcome at meetings. If they aren't attending meetings regularly, give them an encouraging call. Be aware that oldtimers can be alcoholics who still suffer. Utilize their experience by encouraging activity in service work, involvement with Twelfth Step work, and serving on group steering committees. Oldtimers may also be asked to serve as group archivists. All A.A.'s can benefit from an annual "Oldtimers Day."

2 How do our Twelve Traditions guarantee that the hand of A.A. will always be there? Which Traditions specifically apply?

It was pointed out that the Traditions do not guarantee a thing unless we use them. The Traditions help us guard against taking A.A. for granted. Traditions One and Five remind us to put our unity first and that we have a primary purpose. Tradition Three opens the door to everyone with a desire to stop drinking. The Seventh Tradition prevents A.A. from being beholden to anyone. Our Traditions make the group aware that A.A. is more than attending meetings. Building a strong service structure is one guarantee for A.A.'s future because the Traditions are emphasized at area assemblies. The consensus was that all the Traditions are a guarantee that the hand of A.A. will always be there; they protect us from ourselves.

3 Individuals, groups, districts, and areas share the responsibility to help see that A.A. will continue. What can each do, specifically, to ensure this continuity by the individual, group, district, and area?

Unselfishness and love are the keys at every level.

As individuals, we can stay sober and join a home group. We can read A.A. literature, become teachable, and therefore better-

informed members. We can speak up for A.A.'s principles and practice the Twelve Steps to the best of our ability. We can regularly attend our group's business meetings and contribute both time and money.

Groups are responsible for welcoming newcomers and holding regularly scheduled meetings. They can help other A.A. groups by being supportive. To ensure A.A.'s survival, groups should become familiar with A.A.'s Traditions and emphasize the importance of an informed group conscience, rotation, and anonymity. They can choose the best possible member to serve as G.S.R. and pay for his or her expenses to attend service meetings. The group should participate in district activities and financially support the central/intergroup office, district committee, area committee, and G.S.O. The group must remain united and carry out its primary purpose.

Districts and areas can ensure continuity by welcoming people into service, holding regularly scheduled service meetings, and following "The A.A. Service Manual." Members of district and area committees should be encouraged to practice rotation, sponsor others into service, and elect alternates. A good service structure can be developed through workshops and service meetings on the Traditions and Concepts. Communication can be improved through newsletters and having committee reports at assemblies and service meetings. The importance of leading by personal example, our unity of purpose, Third Legacy principles, and self-support was stressed.

Participate, be available, be responsible, and sponsor others.

4 P.I. and C.P.C. efforts have done much to inform nonalcoholics about A.A. What are we doing to inform our *own* members about how and why A.A. works? What is your experience with encouraging members to share in Traditions meetings and fostering an understanding about our history?

We can inform our own members by mentioning service when we talk. Service meetings and workshops on the Traditions are helpful. A script for a Traditions play is available from G.S.O., and it has been helpful in some areas. Let A.A.'s know the Preamble contains the essence of our Traditions. Be aware that Traditions breaks can lead to a study of the Traditions. "How It Works," from the Big Book, and the Twelve Traditions may be read at all meetings. Each of us can be responsible for speaking up when the group gets off the track in terms of our Traditions. Literature about how and why A.A. works should be available. In addition to having a month which emphasizes gratitude, the Traditions might also be stressed.

An understanding of A.A.'s history can be encouraged by giving "A.A. Comes of Age," "Pass It On," and "Dr. Bob and the Good Oldtimers" as A.A. birthday or anniversary gifts. Groups might celebrate A.A.'s anniversary on June 10th. Groups, districts, and areas can form archives committees to preserve A.A. history. Films and filmstrips relevant to A.A. history can be shown with followup workshops; the filmstrip "Markings on the Journey" was mentioned as being especially helpful. Oldtimers may be asked to tape their experiences and recollections of A.A. history.

5 Since so many members suffer from other problems in addition to alcoholism, how do we keep our A.A. meetings focused on our primary purpose?



The answers to this question ran the gamut from "Get hard-nosed with treatment facilities regarding sending addicts to closed meetings" to "Love them till they come around." It was suggested that newcomers be allowed some latitude while older members should stick to the subject. Nonalcoholic drug addicts may be directed to Narcotics Anonymous when possible. Responsible A.A. committees can visit treatment centers and explain what A.A. can and cannot do as part of bridging the gap. Speakers may be reminded that A.A. meetings are for people with a drinking problem.

Sponsorship might be the solution! Older members can accompany newcomers to several meetings and explain that the only requirement for membership is a desire to stop drinking (Tradition Three). There are no pat answers, but as long as we keep talking about things, everything will be okay.

International Convention

Before lunch on Monday, Conference members listened attentively to presentations on A.A.'s upcoming 50th-Birthday Party. Sarah Price (G.S.O. staff) moderated the session.

Convention 'fever'

A.A.'s 50th-Birthday Party is without a doubt going to be the biggest and most exciting we have ever had. All the downtown hotel space committed to us was sold out within six or seven weeks after registration forms were sent out. The overwhelming number of registrants made it necessary to secure 3,000 more rooms, bringing our total to 15,000. Montreal's downtown public transportation system is excellent and (except for limited shuttle-bus service in the areas near the airports) will be adequate.

People staying in the additional housing in the outlying areas will have to provide their own transportation. Registrants who are assigned this housing are being told about the situation and that they may cancel if they choose. Most seem to be taking the news good-naturedly. At an average of 2.3 people in a room, this will help fill demand.

Following are recommendations for program additions that the committee has approved over the past year:

1 A French-Language Marathon Meeting and (if desired by the Spanish-speaking A.A.'s) a Spanish-Language Marathon Meeting. (The Spanish choose not to hold one this time.)

2 A two-day Big Book Study Meeting (from 9:00 a.m. until 5:00 p.m. on Friday and Saturday).

3 Workshops on: "Carrying the Message to Minorities"; "Reaching the Handicapped Alcoholic"; and "How A.A. Cooperates With Other Self-Help Groups."

4 Special-interest meetings for: "Native People," "Gays in A.A.," and "Birds of a Feather" (airline personnel).

"A.A. and the Armed Forces," "A.A. and Medical and Nursing Schools," and "How Professionals Cooperate With A.A." will be combined into one panel—"A.A. as a Community Resource"—so that these topics may gain broader exposure. (Participants for the panel will be from each of the above disciplines.)

We also approved the appointments of Pierre Prenoveau (Area 87 past delegate) as Host Committee chairperson, and Rosalind Bell (Englewood, Colorado) as English-Language Marathon coordinator. Laurent Biron will chair a committee to assist G.S.O. with the selection of speakers for the French-language workshops; and Rosaire Vanasse will coordinate the French-Language Marathon. (Both Laurent and Rosaire are past delegates from Quebec.)

After reviewing the scheduling and procedure for alkathons at the 1980 International Convention, the committee recommended some changes. For 1985, we recommended that delegates still be asked to submit speakers' names from their areas, to be put in a hat and the necessary number of names drawn. We will continue to hold the regional alkathons. But instead of having alkathons for each state and province, they will be general and fewer in number.

In addition to revising our program, the long-standing name of our Past Delegates' Luncheon has also been changed to "Present and Past Delegates' and Present and Past Trustees' Luncheon."

Since our Convention will be held in French-speaking Quebec, it was recommended that we have two additional sales booths—one for La Vigne and one for the new edition of the French-language Big Book. Also, the proposed souvenir booklet, a special item created especially for the Convention, was approved and will be printed in English and French.

In honor of A.A.'s 50th anniversary, the committee gave its approval to G.S.O. to invite, as guests of the board, several of our Fellowship's very early pioneers (both A.A.'s and non-A.A.'s), to be introduced at the Convention. And we are about to reach the five-million mark in sales of the Big Book. We will present the five-millionth copy to Ruth Hock (Bill Wilson's nonalcoholic secretary, who typed the original manuscript).

Ken Dunphy (Eastern Canada regional trustee)

Airport Twelfth Step

As Dave O'Leary (Panel 35, Nova Scotia/Newfoundland/Labrador) was going through customs at Montreal's Dorval airport, a woman pleaded with him to buy her two 40-oz. bottles of duty-free liquor. Dave obliged. Handing her the liquor, Dave told the woman he was a member of A.A. She became extremely flustered and began making all kinds of excuses as to why she "needed" the booze. Dave couldn't help being amazed by this opportunity to carry the message.

'50 years with gratitude'

My friends, the countdown to July 4th has started—the beginning of A.A.'s 50th-Birthday Party in Montreal. The whole city (and I would venture to say the province) is ready to welcome the largest group of A.A.'s, Al-Anons, and friends ever assembled. Early arrivals will find countless attractions in Montreal, the world's second largest French-speaking city, which combines the lifestyle of the old world with the spirit of the new—a unique convention city. Our Host Committee is hard at work to make sure we will have A.A. members available everywhere they are needed. The atmosphere among the volunteers is one of joy and anticipation.

My friends, don't miss the opportunity to be part of the largest A.A. meeting ever. "50 Years With Gratitude" will reflect on the faces and in the hearts of thousands of grateful alcoholics from many countries.

The housing situation in Montreal is critical but not a cause for panic. Lodging on the outskirts of the city is still available; local A.A. members are organizing emergency housing in private homes; and we are hopeful of accommodating everybody. So come on up.

Georges Fillion (Southwestern Quebec)

World service

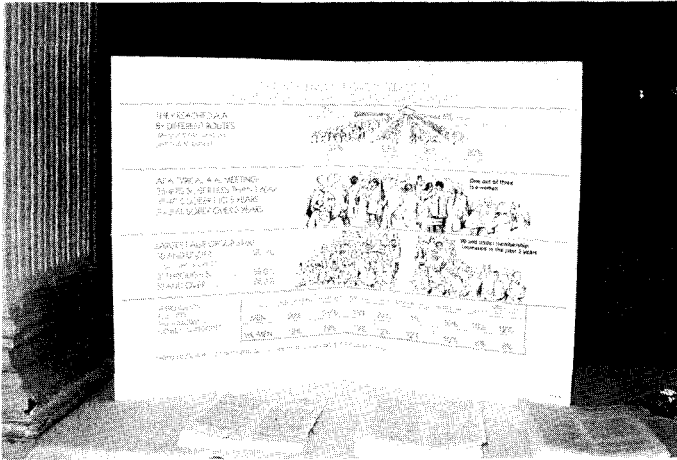
On Monday afternoon, Conference members were uplifted by the following reports on A.A. activity throughout the world. Helen Harmon, trustee-at-large/Canada, moderated a lively discussion.

Third European Service Meeting

"Are We Growing Into Our Responsibilities?" was the theme of the Third European Service Meeting held in Frankfurt am Main, West Germany, on March 8-10, 1985. Fifteen countries were represented, including the English-speaking Intergroup of continental Europe; 28 delegates participated. The general secretary of G.S.O. in Great Britain coordinated the Meeting, assisted by seven staff members, including two secretaries from Great Britain. France was unable to attend due to their General Service Conference; Portugal, Spain, and Switzerland were absent again. An invitation will go out next time to Israel.

The program was well organized, beginning Friday night with my keynote address and then country reports. The delegates were asked to highlight their structures, giving estimated numbers of A.A. groups and members. The smallest group, Malta (22 members) had the longest report (six pages); and Poland gave a spontaneous report (Rajmund and Andrej had only three days' notice). Poland has had an increase in the number of A.A. groups (now 42) and has formed a National Service Board. Following the country reports, three subjects were discussed: (1) regionalizing in England/Scotland; (2) financing the European Service Meeting; and (3) Holland's troubles with group support.

Three committees met on Saturday. Three workshops also were held. On Saturday afternoon committee recommendations were discussed with great care and approved. On Saturday evening a sharing session was followed by three presentations. On Sunday



This display board, depicting the results of the latest survey of young people in A.A., was set up (along with other displays) at the back of the Terrace Room.

morning workshop report-backs were followed by the election of the new delegate chairperson (the delegate from Great Britain). Several delegates spoke about the weekend, and the Meeting closed at 1:00 p.m. on Sunday afternoon.

The most significant result of this third European Service Meeting is the service-information exchange between countries. Also, we welcomed a new structure in Poland, with the hope that other Eastern European countries will contact Poland to share experience. (The Finnish G.S.O. has agreed to print "44 Questions" in Polish free of charge.)

I am grateful to A.A.W.S., Inc., for sending me to this Meeting. Many delegates are currently W.S.M. delegates, which ties the service meetings together. Other countries send different delegates to European Service Meetings so more A.A.'s can learn about service structures in other countries. The small size of the European Service Meeting enables everyone to get to know each other. A.A. is well and very alive in Europe!

Susan Daly (G.S.O. staff)

Eighth World Service Meeting

The Eighth World Service Meeting of Alcoholics Anonymous was held at the Roosevelt Hotel in New York City, October 21-25, 1984; 38 delegates from 25 countries gathered to share on the theme "The World Service Meeting Takes Its Inventory." Simultaneous (English/Spanish) translation was again used with success in the general sessions. The U.S. was represented at the meeting by David Aronofsky, trustee-at-large/U.S.; Canada was represented by Helen Harmon, trustee-at-large/Canada.

The first general session was opened by Gordon Patrick (chairperson of the General Service Board, U.S./Canada). Before conducting roll call, Bob Pearson (chairperson of General Services and president of A.A.W.S., Inc., U.S./Canada) shared his remembrances of the beginnings of the World Service Meeting. As he began to share A.A.'s history and Bill Wilson's desire for such a Meeting, all eyes began to shine. Next, John Henderson (South Africa) gave an inspiring keynote address.

The days that followed were filled with committee meetings, reports, service highlights, workshops, presentations, and workshop report-backs—interspersed with coffee breaks, dinners, and sharing sessions. On Thursday afternoon, second-term delegates expressed spontaneously how the W.S.M. experience had enhanced, not only their personal lives, but also their roles as trusted servants—a truly moving experience for all.

Today there are more than 52,000 A.A. groups throughout the world (over 22,000 of them outside of North America). Language barriers and fears that the Akron-born movement was not "exportable" have not kept A.A. from being accepted in 114 countries. More than 466,000 overseas members comprise 41.2% of our estimated 1,132,000 A.A. members.

In 1967 Bill W. first looked beyond the boundaries of North America with a vision of A.A. around the world. The most exciting and rewarding experiences with our overseas brothers and sisters have evolved into the World Service Meeting, held every two years. The next World Service Meeting will be held in Guatemala in 1986. (A *Final Report of the Eighth World Service Meeting* is available to A.A. members.)

David Aronofsky (trustee-at-large, U.S./Canada)

The A.A. Grapevine

The Tuesday-morning Conference session began with an informative and engrossing look at the A.A. Grapevine, offered by the following presenters. Jim Shannon, Grapevine director, moderated an enthusiastic discussion.

The Grapevine at the area level

Idaho is a better-than-average area for the Grapevine. I personally have been involved with the Grapevine as a GvR. The Grapevine Committee in my area does an excellent job of making certain a large portion of the state, county, and city jails and institutions have Grapevine subscriptions. Many expressions of gratitude are received from these institutions, which inspires incoming Committee members to ensure the subscriptions are renewed.

The groups in my immediate area always have a few people who are willing to distribute Grapevines to prominent doctors' offices. The Grapevine also has various roles on other committees, e.g., H.&I., C.P.C., and P.I. The treatment facilities in my district now include a one-year Grapevine subscription in their treatment programs.

Involvement in service has taken me to various A.A. functions outside my area. It never ceases to amaze me that the Grapevine is mentioned in discussions. Even more surprising is that usually there is some person present who has written a Grapevine article or knows someone who did.

In my area, the Grapevine is an invaluable for carrying the A.A. message to the newcomer. We try to give a "first-timer" one or two recent Grapevines with several members' phone numbers written on them—the newcomer thus receives the Twelve Steps, Twelve Traditions, something to laugh at, and a warehouse of other valuable information.

Since I've realized how important the Grapevine is to the Fellowship, when I hear some A.A.'s complain about its not being Conference-approved, I simply remind them that they are probably not Conference-approved either.

Jeff Hampton (Idaho)

The Grapevine: its role in service

During my time with the Grapevine, I've seen the circulation grow from 88,800 to 124,400 in December 1984, much of it due to GvR activity. The GvR program has grown from 287 GvR's in June 1977 to over 10,000 in April 1985, and it is expected that those numbers will continue to climb this year. This GvR program has given more members an opportunity to become active in service, and these A.A.'s have become part of an area service committee as Grapevine committees developed. It has been a stepping-stone for many to rotate on to other service jobs.

It is not possible to evaluate the service the Grapevine has been to the Fellowship over the years or its importance as a sobriety tool. What better service can any of us do than to carry the A.A. message—and the Grapevine literally does that in the form of a meeting in print every month to about 300,000 readers.

"The Preamble" (written by a Grapevine editor) focuses on some of our Traditions while clearly stating what A.A. is: "Closed Meeting Topics" are used at many discussion meetings and are especially helpful in isolated areas. "Your A.A. Calendar" brings us together at conferences, roundups, and service meetings. The gray pages, "About Alcoholism" (a subject for Conference discussion several times), consolidate new items about the disease of alcoholism as expressed by non-A.A.'s. And "Once Over Lightly" lets us laugh at ourselves, while "Victor E." reminds us that "victory over the first drink" is our first priority.

The Grapevine tapes of selected articles, developed as a service to the blind and handicapped, brought forth an overwhelming response and desire for these tapes from all A.A.'s. They are used as discussion-starters in meetings and provide traveling A.A.'s with good meetings "on the road."

At the time A.A. celebrates its 50th birthday, the Grapevine will celebrate its 41st, with the experience of never having "closed its meeting" for any reason. In spite of difficulties over the years

A bit of history

Ann Garrity (Southern California) worked for "Dr. Jack" during the 1940's as an industrial nurse. Now Ann wonders whether Dr. Jack was "planting A.A. seeds" at that time.

A warm welcome

On Friday morning, Conference members were delighted and relieved to see Retha Gresham sitting at the back of the Terrace Room. Called to the mike, Retha received much applause and then thanked all for their love and concern. Hospitalized with a foot infection during most of Conference week, Retha participated in the last day's proceedings with her foot elevated and supported by a chair.

(finances, loss of key personnel, and problems with outside services), an issue has been printed every month—482 to date.

So long as the Grapevine staff and its editorial and corporate boards are guided by the Traditions in our endeavor to carry out our inherited responsibility and are cognizant of the Concepts as they apply to this service arm of A.A., and so long as the Grapevine staff has the talent and is afforded the editorial integrity it must have, these services will continue.

Retha Gresham (managing editor)

The Grapevine: journey through A.A.

I invite you to come aboard for a journey through A.A. Let's start in New York City, in June 1944, when six A.A. members decided to start a newsletter to improve communication among the local groups. The Grapevine was a local newsletter in name only; and, indeed, in 1945, the groups voted to make it the national A.A. magazine. (Later, in the January 1949 issue, the designation "international journal of Alcoholics Anonymous" appeared for the first time.)

The issues of the mid- and late forties caught the spirit of sobriety just as today's magazine does. The differences, though, are fascinating. The Fellowship they mirrored was young—groups bustin' out all over without the guidance of formulated customs and principles. Since the Traditions weren't adopted until 1950, the 1940's Grapevines were casual, to say the least, about matters that today would be cause for instant rotation of the entire staff and board.

In the 1940's, the Grapevine published Bill's Traditions articles. Bill was a Grapevine consulting editor almost from the beginning, and he saw the magazine as the "voice of A.A." Bill used the magazine as a primary vehicle of communicating with A.A. groups.

The need for the experience of, by, and for older members became more evident as the Grapevine matured along with the Fellowship. The Grapevine changed to a magazine format with the September 1948 issue, so there were fewer "hard news" items and more articles as we know them today. In the 1950's and early 1960's, articles about the drinking days still appeared fairly often. But gradually readers made it known that they needed to read about solutions more than problems, sobriety more than "drunk-logs," and the magazine has moved in that direction ever since. And today, the vast majority of readers ask for articles on the Steps, Traditions, and other tools and principles of the program.

What's new in the Grapevine of the 1980's? Everything—the Grapevine is about sobriety, and sobriety is new every day. And nothing—in the sense that the more things change, the more they remain the same. The Grapevines of the 1940's were the mirror of the A.A. Fellowship in the process of transition, from an inexperienced group of ex-drunks (often flying blind) to a unified Fellowship with tested guiding principles. The Grapevines of the 1980's reflect a Fellowship in the throes of coping with success brought about by adherence to these guiding principles. Yet the specific problems remain much the same—differences between the needs of newcomers and oldtimers, drugs and pills, our relation to the alcoholism field, and anonymity.

Ann Warner (editor)

A director's look into the future

My views are colored by some of the difficulties that the Grapevine has experienced during my tenure as a director, particularly the financial difficulties and the controversies surrounding them. As a result of these financial problems, I think we can predict with a certain amount of confidence that there will always be a great deal of caution in the Grapevine's dealing with its own finances. Internal financial monitoring mechanisms that have been put in place and will continue to evolve will give early warning signals of any disruption in the Grapevine's financial balance; and quick steps will be taken to be sure that the Grapevine is self-supporting.

In recent years, in an attempt to cope with circulation difficulties, A.A. groups became involved in distributing the Grapevine. This movement highlighted the GvR's effectiveness and service role. It became clear that perhaps one of the most important aspects of the GV-GvR system was the development of another service role, another powerful recovery tool. I think the role of the GvR will be presented more and more as a service opportunity, gaining wider acceptance.

In this year of A.A.'s 50th-Birthday Party in Montreal, we have become more aware of the international nature of A.A. I think the Grapevine will increasingly include more articles from other countries. Its international flavor will grow, and the Grapevine will become a vehicle for all the Fellowship to become aware of A.A. activities in other countries.

In conclusion, I see the Grapevine getting stronger and developing a clearer picture of the readership, developing confidence in its stability to communicate its message in a variety of ways (not simply through print), and becoming an increasingly active voice of the needs of the Fellowship.

William Flynn, M.D. (Class A trustee)

Finance

Following lunch on Tuesday, Conference members enjoyed three presentations which outlined the Fellowship's financial picture. Jim McNight, Panel 34, Saskatchewan, was the moderator.

Treasurer's report

The overall financial operations of G.S.O. were satisfactory. Contributions, although way short of operating expenses, exceeded the 1983 total by \$187,000, representing an increase of 9.7% but falling below our budgeted 11.0%. The publishing operation did better: Sales finished up a strong 13.7% over 1983 as compared to a budgeted 11.0%. After a 6% discount allowed to A.A. groups, sales showed an increase of \$690,400.

Expense increases for G.S.O. were pretty much as anticipated, reflecting Fellowship growth and, to some extent, the continuing inflation factor. Total operating expenses were slightly over budget by 1.8%. Part of this increase was, of course, generated by the increase in publishing activity (postage, packing supplies, etc.). Net income for the year totaled \$356,300.

The G.S.O. budget for 1985 reflects the additional sales income from "Pass It On." Sales income has been budgeted to show an

increase of 26%, a large increase based on the sale of 150,000 copies of the new book for 1985. Realistically, contributions are budgeted only 8% higher. Operating expenses, as compared with 1984, are budgeted to show an increase of 10.8%.

Grapevine total income for 1984 increased by \$72,000 over 1983, and expenses increased by \$67,600, or 6%. Net income from operations totaled \$18,000 as compared to a net income from operations of \$13,700 for 1983. Compared to the budget, both income and expense were close to target. The Grapevine budget for 1985 projects an increase of 20% in income and 18% in expenses over the preceding year. A net operating income of \$38,200 is anticipated.

Robert P. Morse, Class A trustee (treasurer, General Service Board)

Some financial history and facts

In the early beginnings, the budding movement of A.A. expected a tremendous influx of outside cash. This money would be used to assist in building and staffing a chain of rehabilitation centers and hospitals clear across the country. To handle these expected large sums of money, the founding fathers set up the Alcoholic Foundation in April 1938.

In time, of course, the founding fathers were able to accept the fact that no large sums of money were going to be given to them by Mr. Rockefeller's friends and came to understand their wisdom in feeling that too much money could spoil this new organization. As a matter of fact, our Seventh Tradition grew out of this experience.

Also, in 1938, a trust indenture was set up that could be considered as the first background for the Finance Committee as it stands today. Five trustees were empowered to administer what was referred to as the "Fund." Two of these trustees were to be alcoholic and three nonalcoholic. The "Fund" was described as "all money or property which may be received by the trustees for the use of the Foundation [now known as the General Service Board of A.A., Inc.] by gift, bequest, or devise."

The first board meeting in 1945 appointed a standing finance committee; its first report was presented to the board in May 1945. There were only three members on the committee—all non-alcoholics. Somewhere along the line, it was decided that alcoholics had become more trustworthy, and A.A. members were



Ed Gordon (left), G.S.O. assistant controller, and Dennis Manders, G.S.O. controller/business administrator, enjoy a leisurely Conference coffee break.

added. The committee functioned within the board structure but was not formalized until 1956 when the activities of the Finance and Budgetary Committee were presented to the Conference as formal committee reports.

Dennis I. Manders (G.S.O. controller/business administrator)

Future projections

As many of you may be aware, there is abundant evidence supporting an extremely high correlation between literature distribution and A.A. growth worldwide. In 1975, A.A.W.S., Inc., distributed 411,167 books and booklets (exclusive of pamphlets); in 1984, the total was 1,354,760, an increase of 330%. Based on the past ten years' experience, we expect that 3,155,000 books and booklets will be sold in 1990. If, we accept the relationship between literature distribution and the growth of A.A., we might comfortably anticipate the continued growth of A.A. during the next five years.

The publishing dollar, derived from the sale of all those books, is applied to the cost of continued literature publication and supports other A.A. activities and objectives. In 1984, a typical year, publishing income was divided as follows: printing costs (including royalties), 44.5%; publishing overhead, 35.3%; other board expenses, 6.7%; shortfall of group contributions, 7.9%; and net income, 5.6%. The labels on the pie are likely to remain the same during the foreseeable future, although the percentage allocation will vary slightly from year to year, depending on need.

One aspect of future planning has a less than positive connotation. In preparing each year's budget, an item appears that usually quite accurately predicts the amount by which A.A. groups will fall short of supporting the services provided by G.S.O. From 1975 to 1984, the shortfall of group contributions amounted to \$2,358,326.90. Speculation on how this money might have been employed in carrying the A.A. message is limited only by imagination, but it serves no useful purpose unless we are inspired to lovingly educate A.A. groups as to the importance of becoming fully self-supporting. If we agree to the worth of this objective and are effective in accomplishing it, in ten years someone might address the 1995 Conference and describe how the price of literature had been dramatically reduced and group services significantly expanded—all because the groups were in harmony with the Seventh Tradition.

Tom Jasper (A.A.W.S. director)

The Warranties

On Tuesday afternoon, Natalie Schwanke, Pacific regional trustee, moderated an informative presentation/discussion session on a topic vital to the Conference structure.

Warranties One and Two

The Warranties, Twelve Steps, and Twelve Traditions cannot be changed by the General Service Conference. An amendment or a cancellation of any part of the Warranties requires the written consent of three-quarters of all the directory-listed A.A. groups around the world.

Warranty One: "that the Conference never becomes the seat of perilous wealth or power."

"Perilous wealth" does not mean that the Conference should not have any money. We must have money to carry on all our services, and, as long as we do not accept money from outside sources and hold individual gifts to a reasonable amount, we are not likely to become wealthy.

It is highly unlikely that our trusted servants could be given too much authority. If the practice of rotation is followed diligently, we will be protected from calamities. Long experience suggests that we are unlikely to encounter too much service authority; on the contrary, we sometimes have difficulty in maintaining enough.

Warranty Two: "that sufficient operating funds, plus an ample reserve, be its prudent financial principle."

In many cases, we are unable to get financial support from groups. In 1984, only 55% of the groups in the U.S. and Canada supported general services. I believe that we are falling down in carrying the proper message to A.A. groups that are not contributing.

The cost of our world service office is a small sum compared to other societies of our size and activity. A prudent reserve is important; the goal is to have a reserve equal to one year's operating expenses for A.A.W.S., G.S.O., and The A.A. Grapevine, Inc. In 1984 the reserve was \$3,848,000 (64% of 1984), or the equivalent of seven and a half months. Between 1954 and 1984, there has only been one year when group contributions have met the needs of world service.

The Warranties of Article 12 express the wisdom of taking forethought for the future based on lessons of the past. In this way, we will protect ourselves against needless errors and our very natural human temptations to wealth, prestige, and power.

Mel Hanna (Western Ontario)

Warranties Three and Four

The Six Warranties in Concept Twelve are referred to as "counsels of prudence." Warranties Three and Four are counsels of prudence in personal relatedness.

Warranty Three: "that none of the Conference members shall ever be placed in a position of unqualified authority over any of the others."

It's my understanding that the Conference, which is not a legal instrument, should always be made up of persons representing the different entities which are affected by its actions: (1) the A.A. groups (represented by the area delegates, which make up two-thirds of the Conference members); (2) A.A. World Services, Inc., and The A.A. Grapevine, Inc. (represented by the trustees, directors, and staff, which make up one-third of the Conference members). With each Conference member having one vote and each group of servants represented in reasonable proportion, the Conference has guaranteed a voting participation for each entity.

Warranty Four: "that all important decisions be reached by dis-

cussion, vote, and, whenever possible, by substantial unanimity."

This simple statement, with no specific mandate spelled out, creates the opportunity for God to work through the majority vote and also be heard through the "frequent wisdom of minorities."

Frank Sauer (Mid-Southern California)

Warranties Five and Six

Warranty Five: "that no Conference action ever be personally punitive or an incitement to public controversy."

If the Fellowship of A.A. fails to follow sound spiritual principles, alcohol will cut us down. We do not need to succumb to penalizing anyone or anything. It is imperative that we maintain our "single-mindedness of purpose."

How can we best defend A.A. if we were to come under public attack or ridicule? Bill W. said the best defense would be "no defense whatever—namely, complete silence." We might wish to privately acknowledge justified criticism, but never with anger or punitive words or measures. This policy should be inflexible. We are the guardians of A.A. Traditions, and privately we can handle any matter that could be a threat to A.A. or our Traditions.

Warranty Six: "that, though the Conference may act for the service of Alcoholics Anonymous, it shall never perform any acts of government; and that, like the Society of Alcoholics Anonymous which it serves, the Conference itself will always remain democratic in thought and action."

Here are the Traditions in a nutshell, emphasizing no punishment or expulsion from A.A.! Run your group the way you wish unless you harm A.A. as a whole; give money freely but voluntarily; and, finally, any group of alcoholics may be an A.A. group, providing they have no outside affiliations. Curtailment in the Conference isn't necessary if we follow the Warranties.

Elke Forbes (Maryland)

Concept V—the Rights of "Appeal" and "Petition"

After the coffee break on Wednesday morning, an informative presentation/discussion on Concept V was moderated by Wayne Parks, Southwest U.S. regional trustee.

In the group

I would like to present some situations and ask some questions, hoping you may supply the answers. In creating these scenarios, a few phrases kept coming into my mind and seemed to answer the problem; but when I tried to nail it down, it drifted away like a puff of smoke. For instance, the phrase "*there is but one ultimate authority—a loving God as He may express Himself in our group conscience*" sounds good as long as all involved go along. However, what about the situation where a few involved don't cooperate? Another phrase is "*Our leaders are but trusted servants; they do not govern.*" Who decides who does what after an appeal is heard?



Four districts decide to put on a quarterly conference. It goes well, and they make money—several thousands of dollars. When it comes time to disperse the money, because one district really didn't do as well as the rest, the three D.C.M.'s vote not to give the fourth D.C.M. a share. The fourth D.C.M. petitions the area committee for redress of grievance. Although the district doesn't have as many G.S.R.'s, the people who were available did work. The area committee votes that the money should be equally divided between all four districts. Then the three districts again decide that they will not give the fourth district the money. Now the D.C.M. of the fourth district wants to know how are decisions enforced and who is responsible to see that it happens?

The only A.A. group in a small town has four meetings. During a very heated business meeting, a very hasty and uninformed decision is made that all meetings will be open meetings. One member contacts the D.C.M. and says that he took a newcomer to a meeting: An O.A. member was chairing the meeting; an N.A. member was participating; and a secretary with less than three months' sobriety was in charge of selecting chairpersons. The member of this group, although not involved in service, wants to know how he can have his voice heard by the angry group.

It seems that Tradition Four and Concept V come together and cause confusion or render each other either more powerful or useless, however you look at it. How does A.A. keep the majority out of rule? Who does enforce the decisions? And (the big question) who does a person petition for redress?

Kathleen Carr (Alaska)

In the district

One of the definitions of "appeal" is "an application (as to a recognized authority) for corroboration, vindication or decision." "Petition" means "an earnest request, something asked or requested." Minorities at all levels of service should be encouraged to file minority reports when they feel a majority to be in considerable error. The majority should always listen carefully to the minority opinion even when it may seem to be uninformed, misinformed, hasty, or angry.

The district is the level of service that should first hear the appeal or petition. The value of hearing appeals and petitions at the district level are many. The most important is having the right to present the minority opinion, having a thorough discussion, and getting a district conscience. (The district benefits if it's only a lesson in patience and tolerance. Those who think they know everything irritate those of us who do.)

In the Tucson area, we have bimonthly meetings of five districts. All G.S.R.'s, D.C.M.'s, and interested A.A.'s are welcome to participate. This is another place where the appeals and petitions may be heard and another conscience taken. There are three other similar assemblies in the Arizona area.

The trusted servants in A.A. do those things that are not practical for the groups themselves to do, but we should never become above reproach. We don't have higher courts to appeal to, but we do have larger group consciences. May we always heed and use them.

Dave Hill (Arizona)

In the area

Concept V says that the traditional "Right of Appeal" should permit any person in our service structure, whether paid or unpaid, to petition for the redress of personal grievance, carrying the complaint, if so desired, directly to the General Service Board. He or she should be able to do this without prejudice or fear of reprisal.

Within the area, I feel the grievance should be considered at each service structure level. If the group or a member has a problem, the G.S.R. would be the first to look at it. If necessary, the D.C.M. could attempt a solution. Then, if it needed to be carried further, the problem could go to the area delegate, area committee, or assembly.

We had an example of Concept V working within our area officers. The area secretary stated that the workload was too much for one person. Not much attention was paid until it was brought up as a grievance at an area committee meeting. A motion was made to expand the officer panel from five to six people and have two secretaries to split the duties. This motion was returned to the groups for discussion and voted on at the next assembly—it passed. In granting this traditional "Right of Appeal," we recognized that minorities frequently can be right.

Leslie Watson (Northern Interior California)

Especially grateful

Christina Heindel (Northern Wisconsin/Upper Peninsula Michigan) and her husband were involved in a severe auto accident on their way to the airport heading for the Conference. Chris arrived at the Conference shaken up and injured but was able to get through the week, one day at a time. Asked about her ordeal, Chris expressed gratitude to the Higher Power for being able to participate at the Conference. She felt it was her intense desire to carry on as delegate that helped her pull through the accident in such good shape. "It was worth it," she shared, with tears of joy, "to be here!"

At the Conference

I know of no other large organization or society which has gone to such great lengths to ensure a hearing of minority opinion as has A.A. Indeed, such minority opinion is not only tolerated; it is actually encouraged. The minority opinion is the vehicle which often gives rise to a closer and more thorough look at a problem.

Our trustees are but a trusted minority of A.A. servants who do what the group conscience of A.A. as a whole could not do for itself—oversee the operation of our world service structure. As delegates to this Conference, we are also a minority group who, as a collective body, act as A.A.'s group conscience in matters related to world service.

All A.A. members have the Rights of "Appeal" and "Petition" as set forth in Concept V. The area delegate structure provides the means whereby individual A.A.'s and local groups can be heard at the Conference. Appeals and petitions can be presented for consideration to the appropriate Conference and trustees' committees by the delegate.

Willard Machen (Northwest Texas)

Beyond the Seventh Tradition—group responsibility

Late on Wednesday afternoon, four presentations on a topic of great concern engendered thoughtful discussion. Shepherd Raimi, A.A. W.S. director, served as moderator.

In the meeting place

How often we take things for granted—how we automatically think there will be a meeting place to go to! We take for granted that someone will have the chairs set up, the coffee made, a topic thought of, literature set out, and we (meaning I) just have to show up for that meeting. We then leave and go on our merry ways. Are you like me, taking all this for granted? Are not each one of us, as members of an A.A. group, responsible to pitch in and help?

Most meetings are held at clubs, churches, and schools. What kind of a rapport does our group have with those who offer us their facilities? Do we cooperate with them and help in any way possible? Do we leave the place in a total disarray, or do we take pride in our meeting place and learn to be responsible? I was told a long time ago that I may be the only example of the Big Book that someone may see—and it would be wise if I were a good example. Our care of the meeting place should also set a good example. Does your group work toward maintaining this goal?

What about the quality of our meetings? We must always remember that our primary purpose is to carry the message to the still-suffering alcoholic. Since each group is autonomous, there are many ways to have quality meetings. It is suggested that decisions on how your group can best have quality meetings should be arrived at by the group conscience. What is the feeling of your group? Are they mindful of newcomers and do they welcome them and make them feel comfortable? Is your group able to handle problems that arise *as a group*, or does one individual make the decisions? Disharmony in any group cuts into the quality of the meetings.

I believe every group should feel they have the best meeting place and best meetings available to extend the hand of A.A. to the still-suffering alcoholic. If each individual within the group strives for this, we may eventually attain that goal, keeping in mind "progress, not perfection."

*Christina Heindel (Northern Wisconsin/
Upper Peninsula Michigan)*

To the newcomer

Our First Tradition states that the recovery of the alcoholic will not be possible without A.A. groups. Furthermore, it states that without the A.A. group, personal survival is not possible. It clearly says how important the newcomer is for the continuity and growth of the A.A. group. All group members should be continually reminded that if the newcomer stays, our own sobriety is ensured.

Are the groups carrying out their responsibility to newcomers? To answer this question, I have to remember my first days in A.A. When I first arrived at the San Juan Group, I found a group of sober persons—well dressed and at peace with themselves. They talked about the A.A. recovery program and about themselves. One of these people became my sponsor. I must remember that if this group had not been there that night, I would not be sober today.

Through handshakes with group members, I found acceptance. The coffee, chairs, etc., were always ready when I came to meetings. Someone was always ready to answer my questions about A.A. I was never alone—very important for the newcomer. The literature was well displayed within the sight of all members. The members of my group were always ready to give the help I was asking for.

I suggest that all A.A. groups in all areas treat newcomers with the same importance and respect that I was given.

Jaime Rocafort (Puerto Rico)

Literature: What message do we carry?

There can be no doubt that the first responsibility of any A.A. group, intergroup, or service committee is to ensure that the A.A. message of hope is carried to the alcoholic. We carry this message in many important ways, one of which is our A.A. literature.

A.A. literature is special in two important ways: First, all A.A. literature is prepared by and for A.A. through the group conscience process. Our literature reflects the experience of the alcoholic as it is understood by the group conscience. Thus, our literature contains the "language of the heart" of one alcoholic talking to another about A.A.'s program of recovery.

Second, A.A. literature is prepared in keeping with the Twelve Traditions that guarantee our essential unity as a Fellowship. No other literature can carry our message because no other literature reflects our concern for the Traditions which keep us whole.

When it comes to non-A.A. literature, we are guided by both our Preamble and the Sixth Tradition—we "neither endorse nor op-

pose any causes." Therefore we have no opinion on non-A.A. literature, but we ought not offer it up in ways that lead the newcomer to become confused between A.A.'s language of the heart and other approaches. What we offer the newcomer must come from our A.A. experience, strength, and hope as expressed by our group conscience and in keeping with our Traditions. We owe it to our groups to urge them to maintain the special A.A. message, not someone else's message about A.A. or alcoholism.

It is important for the Conference to encourage A.A. groups to reflect upon the Sixth Tradition and the uniqueness of our group conscience as it shapes the A.A. message. If the groups do this, they will make the right decisions on the question of literature. In sum, we recommend that our groups act on behalf of the special message that is carried only by A.A.'s and A.A. literature.

Richard Roughton (Rhode Island)

Group autonomy

When I joined my home group, I brought to it all my arrogance, intolerance, negativity, and fear, together with a God complex that justified all of the foregoing character defects. A.A. taught me that I wasn't unique and that I haven't invented any new sins; therefore, I must presume that my fellow alcoholics suffer some of the same shortcomings. Occasionally, I forget that I'm not God and that my home group isn't God. Occasionally, I have all the answers for everybody else. The same failing is true of groups.

The Traditions are the twine that binds us together, the string of continuity from the oldtimers to the newest members. Sometimes they have to be broken for the new people to turn back to them and say, "Yes, they were right about that." I feel the time has come for us, individually and as groups, to stop criticizing ourselves and each other and to look at what we are doing right.

I have some questions about the Seventh Tradition. Does it mean that nonalcoholic spouses who attend open A.A. meetings should not be allowed to put money in the basket? Does it mean that A.A. groups should not contribute moral and/or financial support to other A.A. groups? Does it mean that while we are encouraged to carry meetings to jails, we don't carry a meeting to a group that is suffering from tired blood? Does it mean that A.A. groups shouldn't sponsor other A.A. groups?

Perhaps the time has come for us to use our moral independence, our self-directing freedom, to be more thoughtful of how our actions impinge on other groups and to be more constructive and encouraging as we grow in A.A. unity, love, and service.

Mary Ann Bagi (New Mexico)

Beyond the Seventh Tradition—group responsibility

With the late-afternoon presentation/discussion still fresh in their minds, Conference members continued sharing on the same topic in a workshop on Wednesday evening. Small groups met in separate rooms; Panel 34 delegates, trustees, and directors served as moderators and reporters. The following is a summary of the reports from all rooms, giving both the general consensus and, in some cases, reactions from various groups.

1 In addition to being self-supporting, what are the other responsibilities of an A.A. group? How does your group share information about group responsibilities with its members?

All agreed that groups have many responsibilities in addition to being self-supporting. Groups are responsible for welcoming newcomers, emphasizing sponsorship, providing literature and the A.A. Grapevine, making beginners' meetings available or, in small groups, having experienced members work with newcomers on a one-to-one basis. Groups should reflect the principles of the Fellowship by rotating responsibilities, showing consideration and respect for others, honoring commitments, and remembering A.A.'s singleness of purpose. Keeping the meeting place in good order and contributing to A.A.'s services are important responsibilities. Groups which meet in clubs should make a clear distinction between club and group activities and responsibilities.

Groups can share information about group responsibilities by holding regularly scheduled business meetings. Groups should assume financial responsibility for sending G.S.R.'s to district meetings and assemblies and allow time for G.S.R. reports. Literature and A.A. Guidelines are informative. *Box 4-5-9* and "The A.A. Service Manual" should be available to the group. Groups can hold Traditions meetings or briefly explain one of the Traditions at every meeting. Members might visit other groups to exchange ideas. Oldtimers can be encouraged to stay active and pass on information.

Steering committees usually keep groups well-informed. Periodic group inventories and the suggestions in the Group Handbook are also helpful. A.A. activities should be announced regularly to keep the members of the group informed and involved.



For many energetic Conference members, the day began with an early-morning jog around New York City's Central Park reservoir.

2 Our surveys show that almost half of those coming to A.A. leave before three months. What can groups do to keep them coming back?

A long list of suggestions included making newcomers feel welcome and wanted by getting them involved. Assign temporary sponsors who will get in touch with absentees. Many groups use the chip system and encourage newcomers to attend 90 meetings in 90 days. In some groups, those with fewer than 90 days are invited to identify themselves if they wish. (They are then encouraged with applause.) Talk to newcomers before and after meetings and encourage them to share at meetings. Groups can keep meeting topics focused on A.A., make beginners meetings available, and provide newcomer kits containing meeting schedules, phone numbers, and A.A. literature. Give the new member a Big Book if he or she can't afford one.

Introductory meetings explaining what A.A. is and is not are especially helpful for people referred by courts or coming from treatment centers. It is also helpful if new members can be escorted to meetings and offered transportation when necessary. Since newcomers respond differently, we cannot generalize about how they should be handled. A group must function well to attract newcomers.

3 How are group members informed of opportunities to serve beyond the group level?

Service sponsors lead the list of ways to inform group members of opportunities to serve beyond the group level. We can sponsor people into service by our enthusiastic example that service can be fun and lead to happiness. We can include service when we tell our stories, describe service opportunities at group business meetings, and take newer members along to service functions.

Providing time for G.S.R. reports and inviting area officers and district committee members to attend meetings and explain their responsibilities are also ways of informing group members. Some areas hold service workshops or G.S.R. schools for all interested members. Service filmstrips can be shown, and large service charts (available from the General Service Office) can be displayed.

Some groups order bulk subscriptions to *Box 4-5-9* to keep members informed. Many districts and areas mail periodic newsletters to groups to keep them up to date.

4 Other than holding meetings, how does the group fulfill A.A.'s primary purpose?

Making Twelfth Step calls and being available to carry the message lead a long list of ways groups can fulfill A.A.'s primary purpose. Groups might also take meetings into institutions, such as rehabs and jails, and cooperate with court programs. Working through P.I. and C.P.C. committees, group members can carry the message by speaking to local church and community groups. Members can carry the message on a one-to-one basis by sharing with their doctors, clergy, lawyers, teachers, etc.

Many groups contribute A.A. books, pamphlets, and Grapevines to libraries and provide meeting lists for local agencies. In addition, groups fulfill A.A.'s primary purpose by regularly contributing financially to their districts, areas, and the General Service Office. Groups might also support other A.A. groups if necessary.

5 What is a group's responsibility to its meeting place? How do the actions of group members affect the attitude of the community toward A.A.?

A group is responsible for paying rent and respecting the rules of the facility where the group meets. Members should treat the meeting place as they would their home. The meetings should remain geared to A.A. with no extracurricular activities. A responsible chairperson ensures that cars are parked only where allowed, sees that volunteers help clean up, and keeps the noise level down when the meeting ends.

As examples of the Fellowship, the actions of group members affect the attitude of the community toward A.A.; by being responsible, a positive public image is created.

6 When and why should groups take an inventory?

The responses to when groups should take an inventory varied from "when problems or conflicts arise" to "on a regular basis." Symptoms of group ill health might indicate when groups need to take an inventory. For example: when the group stagnates; when personalities are emphasized instead of principles; when groups aren't accepting responsibility; when newcomers or oldtimers drift away or there is a decline in membership; when there is unrest or lack of interest; when unity breaks down; when rotation fails; when the treasury grows; or when things are going well (to see why).

Group inventories are a remedy for complacency and measure effectiveness in carrying the message. Inventories help groups fulfill their primary purpose.

7 What are the implied responsibilities in "except in matters affecting other groups or A.A. as a whole" in the Fourth Tradition? How do actions of one group affect other groups or A.A.?

Implied in the Fourth Tradition are our responsibilities in helping new groups get started, the need for unity, and good communication. Groups need to be considerate of one another in terms of scheduling meetings and special functions. Groups have a responsibility to stick with their commitments to other groups and to institutions meetings.

Groups are responsible for cultivating A.A. in a way which benefits the entire Fellowship. Each group is a showcase to the public around it, and the public will judge us by our actions at that level.

Force of habit?

During the area service highlights on Tuesday afternoon, Garrett Taylor (Northeast U.S. regional trustee) commented on the peculiar way in which A.A.'s ended their prayers at memorial services for fellow members: "Keep coming back!"

The G.S.R.—the key role

Just before lunch on Thursday morning, Conference members listened attentively to four absorbing presentations on the role of the G.S.R. Jackie Solomon, general service trustee, moderated the discussion.

Obtaining the most qualified member

When my home group elects a new G.S.R., we usually have one of two problems: no qualified members eager to serve or too many wanting to serve. (The second problem seldom arises.) If no qualified member volunteers, the group must select the member most qualified.

The candidate for this "most important job in A.A." hopefully will know or can be informed of what is expected of him or her, particularly attending area assemblies and district meetings. This position affords an opportunity to serve and demonstrate a degree of gratitude. Therefore, we do not seek the attractive "smooth talker" who may not have the time available or fulfill the responsibilities.

The duties of the G.S.R. are explained to a candidate, but an explanation of how the group will support its G.S.R. is just as pertinent. We offer our prayers. We offer time for the G.S.R.'s report at business meetings. We offer our group conscience for his or her guidance. And we offer money to defray expenses.

An avid interest in the welfare of our Fellowship and a love of service work are qualities that we look for. A comprehensive knowledge of the Steps, Traditions, and Concepts, as well as a feeling of the importance of A.A.'s history, will make for an informed, effective G.S.R.

Jim Rogers (Southwest Texas)

The service sponsor

After almost four years of going to meetings, smiling, dressing carefully, talking the talk, I remained the same. Needless to say, I drank often. My sponsor wisely gave me up. In my arrogance, anger, and hurt, I told her I would get well in spite of her and her friends.

The next day I sat in the country kitchen (which was to become my second home) of a lady I had known since I came into the program. She listened as I poured out my story. When I finished, she told me there are many activities, many branches of service in A.A., that needed workers to carry the message. With a smile, she invited me to go with her to the answering service.

It never stopped from that day on—meetings in rehabs, hospitals, intergroup, and the assembly. Edith indirectly volunteered me for intergroup representative. Next, I became the G.S.R. for my group. Time flew by. I was sober and happy, and I was changing. There were not enough hours in the day. At the assembly election, I was elected D.C.M. My cup runneth over. One year later, we had our first district meeting with 100% participation (the only time). Edith died soon after that, but I believe she knows I am here.

My feeling is that every newcomer should be introduced to service, starting with cleaning ashtrays and making coffee. They should get a chance to welcome the early people plus the newcomers. I do not know anyone who went alone to an intergroup meeting or assembly and stayed to share without help and encouragement from those in service.

Ruth Nicol (Southern New Jersey)



Gordon Patrick and Ken Williams (nonalcoholics) share a Conference meal and lively conversation.

Love and tolerance—our code in service

Love and tolerance are principles that cannot be obtained by reading a book or pamphlet. We learn them in our A.A. recovery program. Love and tolerance are not the usual attributes of alcoholics when they arrive at the doors of A.A. We arrive sick—emotionally, mentally, spiritually, and (more often than not) physically. We are accepted by kind, compassionate, and understanding A.A.'s. They make us feel welcome, and we are no longer alone.

Our work in service begins where everything else in A.A. begins—at our own group. If we are fortunate enough, the group may elect us to some responsibility, placing their trust in us. We then may be elected the group's G.S.R. We may not realize it at this time, but we are embarked on an experience that we will never forget; for now we feel useful and are doing something constructive with our lives.

We may find a service sponsor to help guide us in our new endeavor. With his or her patient love and understanding, we learn that service is an expression of gratitude, and that by serving we stay sober, guaranteeing our own survival. It is now abundantly clear to us that here in service is love at work.

Thus love and tolerance, our code in service, are simply the ultimate expression of spirituality through a set of principles. Could we not then say that our code in service is "love and more love"? I think so!

Murray White (Manitoba)

The golden key of service

Is there a "golden key of service" in A.A.? In this, its 50th year, A.A. has grown to gigantic proportions and is still growing. Thus, service has taken on greater significance than ever before. My first and most important function was G.S.R. For this reason, I believe the G.S.R. is the golden key of service.

As a G.S.R., I was motivated to learn more about our Fellowship—its structure, Traditions, Concepts, and history—in short, the when's, where's, and how's of A.A. as a whole. Being a G.S.R. was the key to getting to know the Traditions and hopefully understanding them.

I'm sure you will all agree how important the group conscience is to A.A. as a whole. It is equally important that the group be aware of the conscience of A.A. as a whole. When we think of the G.S.R. as the golden key of service, we see the true two-way communication of group to Conference and vice versa. How easy and rewarding the "passing on" of the message became when I found this key of service.

Thomas Eser (Maryland)

50 years of caring and sharing

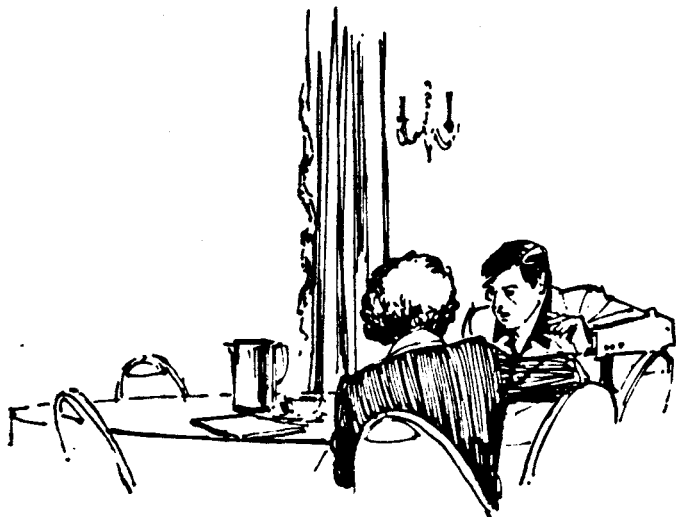
Late on Thursday afternoon, after the coffee break, many aspects of A.A.'s history were highlighted in a presentation session moderated by Ken Williams, Class A trustee.

In treatment centers

Today, almost all treatment centers are based largely on the A.A. program. It is easy to understand why many A.A.'s look upon A.A. as the chicken that laid the eggs which are the treatment centers we know today. Some A.A.'s think that A.A. was invented in a treatment center because Bill Wilson sobered up for the last time in Towns Hospital, one of the oldest hospitals in the U.S. for treating alcohol and drug addiction.

How did A.A.'s program of recovery become the basis for almost all the treatment centers in North America? A.A.'s program is based on the practical experience of our first members, which showed that alcoholics could stay sober by trying to help other alcoholics. Since most of our early members often required hospitalization while sobering up, they sought out new prospects in treatment centers and hospitals.





It is imperative that we remember that carrying the A.A. message into any institution is a privilege, not a right. We stick to our own experience, tell our own story, remembering that we are there because we are alcoholics, not because they might be. Treatment centers are in the business of helping alcoholics to recover from the disease of alcoholism. To do this effectively, they must use the most successful methods they can find. Most have found that introducing patients to A.A. in the center and recommending continued A.A. involvement upon discharge is the most successful method available.

For 50 years, A.A. members have ensured themselves immunity from drinking by caring and sharing with alcoholics in treatment centers. May we continue to carry our message wherever alcoholics are suffering for so long as God wills us to do so.

Bob Picard (Northern Minnesota)

In correctional facilities

Collectively the A.A. Fellowship has achieved some degree of maturity, but there are still a few signs of our residual adolescence as we wrestle with the problems of dual addiction, age (too young), and treatment center and court referrals. Also, like adolescents, we profess love and deference to our ancestral heritage, but we have not quite made the same degree of commitment to the still suffering alcoholic we haven't even met yet.

This day is not only the first day of the rest of our lives; it is also the first day of our Fellowship's next 50 years. Today there are 450,000 adults in U.S. prisons plus 25,000 in Canadian prisons. There are at least that many people in our jails. Now, if we relate those figures to five years ago when 300,000 adults were locked up, what is the prediction for the next five years? Fifty years? For those of us in the Fellowship, the next 50 years can be a mission in which, if we accept the challenge, the most severely suffering alcoholics in North America can be reached.

Within the last three years, the U.S. Department of Justice released a research report indicating as much as 80% of our prisoners should be classified as either problem drinkers or alcoholics. There is little evidence or reason to believe that the situation will change significantly during the next 50 years *unless*:

- We are willing to share without reservation or prejudice the joy of sobriety with the youths who are suffering alcoholics—most crimes are committed by males between the ages of 17 and 27.
- We are willing to carry the A.A. message to suffering alcoholics in the ghettos and barrios of our major cities. (A significantly disproportionate number of our prisoners come from black and Hispanic neighborhoods in metropolitan areas.)
- We are willing to go into our jails and detox centers in greater numbers.
- We are willing to establish a cooperative relationship with our overworked probation officers, who need the kind of support for their alcoholic probationers that only effective A.A. sponsors can provide.
- We are ready to test our collective maturity as we change our attitudes about referrals from treatment centers and the lower courts.

What we have established in our first 50 years of caring and sharing in correctional facilities is a sound foundation for what *could* be a golden era during the next 50 years toward the goal of stemming the rate of growth of alcoholics in our prison population. Part of the future of our Fellowship (too much) is right now locked up in jails, prisons, and juvenile detention centers. If that thought bothers you even a little bit, let's change it. We should change it if we love the Fellowship. We can change it if we love the still-suffering alcoholic. We must change it if we love ourselves in sobriety.

W. J. Estelle Jr. (Class A trustee)

With young people

Young people have been a big part of my recovery—the first A.A. meeting I attended was a young people's meeting. I remember that the people in the room were about my age and seemed happy. Later it became my home group.

The days of telling the newcomer that he or she is too young to be an alcoholic are long passed. Our 1983 membership survey shows that increasing numbers of young people have been coming to A.A. during the past nine years.

Young people's meetings are special-interest meetings, not age discrimination. We talk about finding a way to live where we can be happy, joyous, and free and about growing up emotionally and facing life. Young people's meetings are just another tool to help young alcoholics work through their uniqueness and join the Fellowship as a whole. I pray there will always be room for both young people and "longtimers" to share the gift of sobriety.

Chuck Asher (Southern Indiana)

Worth considering?

Ann Garrity (Panel 35, Southern California) and Diane Olsen (Panel 35, Northern Coastal California) were walking to G.S.O. on Tuesday afternoon. Diane was singing, and Ann was carrying her coffee cup. When they stopped at a street corner, a drunk stumbled up to them and dropped a penny in Ann's cup. The two thought that perhaps they had discovered a new way of receiving delegate out-of-pocket money.

In the group

Since the beginnings of A.A., "mutual give-and-take" has been at the very heart of A.A.'s Twelfth Step work. A.A. did not begin by being greatly publicized, but by alcoholics listening to each other and carrying the message of hope. Although most newcomers today come to A.A. by radio, press, television, etc., the real contact with A.A. begins in the group. The newcomer attends his or her first meeting and finds smiling faces, good handshakes, and good coffee. The newcomer receives the first ray of hope before the speaker begins. If we miss making the newcomer feel wanted in our group, we have missed the essential link that Bill W. found in his first meeting with Dr. Bob.

Every two hours, a new A.A. group is formed in America; and every hour, 15 new members join A.A. At my next meeting in my own group, will I be present when a newcomer arrives? One of my A.A. responsibilities is to be present in my group. Often, with the years, we take sobriety for granted. We justify our absenteeism from our groups with our activities. Our sobriety was acquired in the group—the activities were instituted to better it. All our committees are needed to get A.A. known around the world, but the group is still the real contact with A.A.

Jean-Marie Alain (Northwest Quebec)

Golden moments of reflection

Late on Friday afternoon, Conference business completed, members of the 35th Conference were inspired by the following presentations on A.A.'s history. Dr. John Norris, trustee emeritus, served as moderator and offered the final presentation.

The pioneers paved the way

I often think about the early days of A.A., and I can almost visualize Bill and Lois being put into the streets here in New York. If I had been in the same position, would I have had the courage to continue writing the manuscripts of the Big Book, or would I have gone to Wall Street and worked to straighten out my own personal and financial affairs? Much has been given to us so freely. We have inherited the benefits of other people's hard labor. The pioneers of A.A. paved the rough road to recovery which we all travel so smoothly today. Fifty years later, A.A. has flourished into the greatest Fellowship the world has ever known. Working with alcoholics is still the best way to maintain our own sobriety.

How can I express my love and gratitude for the Fellowship of A.A.? The only way I know is by being willing to carry the message of A.A. and the Conference to anywhere in my area anytime. I must be willing to go to any lengths to give. I have found that it is impossible to "outgive" A.A. I have received more abundant blessings than I can ever begin to repay.

For a person like me, who was so fog-brained when I came to A.A. that I could not recite the Serenity Prayer during the first six weeks, and who was no good to myself or anyone else—for me to be chosen as delegate is an undeserved gift of God.

Bob Woods (Wyoming)

'A worldwide spiritual network'

Today the dreams of the early members are largely a reality: Treatment centers for alcoholics abound; professionals are referring patients to the Fellowship in unsettling, if not overpowering, numbers; much unsolicited publicity is given in every media extolling the virtues of our movement; literature sales are beyond our imagination; and, most important, A.A. meetings exist in almost every city in North America and in 114 other countries.

Bernard Smith, nonalcoholic chairperson of the General Service Board, expressed the notion that the real miracle of A.A. is not that so many former drinkers no longer drink, but rather that so many have put their lives on a spiritual basis. Most people outside A.A. (and not a few inside) think of us as being solely "about not drinking and going to meetings." But surely the last 50 years have produced something far more—a program about the transformation of lives! Through our Steps and Traditions, we have been changed from spiritless, leaden creatures into golden examples of energy, usefulness, and happiness.

Carl Sandburg wrote: "When ever a society or civilization perishes, one condition can always be found. They forgot where they came from." Fortunately, from where I sit, we haven't forgotten where we've come from. If anything, more and more members and outsiders are fascinated at where we've come from and at the why's and how's of our enormous growth as faith-filled participants in a worldwide spiritual network. May our fire burn on!

Frank Mauser (G.S.O. archivist)

'Things of the spirit'

One can go to A.A. meetings regularly for a long time between references to the "things of the spirit." Then the reference is something like "the spiritual part of the program" or "the spiritual side of the program." As a matter of fact, there is no "spiritual part" of the program—the program itself is spiritual. One can delete the references to alcohol in the Twelve Steps, and they are altered very little. But if one deletes the references to "things of the spirit," there is very little left.

In reading the case histories of alcoholics in the Big Book, one becomes aware that alcohol meant something very special to the alcoholic long before the symptoms of uncontrolled drinking occurred. In other words, alcohol meant more to the alcoholic from the moment he or she began to drink. The aberrant behavior developed quickly in some and slowly in others. But they all liked what alcohol did for them from the very first.

This observation is extremely important for those who would help the alcoholic. And here lies one of the very basic problems in the treatment of alcoholism: We must remember that the practicing alcoholic is not seeking a way to quit drinking—he is seeking a way to continue.

Homer Wilkinson (Maine)

Distance is everything

Introduced by Gordon Patrick at the closing brunch as a "spiritual giant," David Aronofsky responded, "A halo is only 6 inches from a noose."

A vision of tomorrow

I have no fear about the future of A.A. as long as we continue to live by the Steps, Traditions, and Concepts, relating them to our day-to-day experience as the world outside A.A. changes and brings new pressures to bear on us—new situations with which we must live with serenity and courage. Since Bill and Dr. Bob first met and carried the message to Bill D., A.A. has grown in wisdom and strength as A.A. members have shared their experience honestly, in love, as they have sought and found the group conscience according to Tradition Two.

What is happening in the world outside A.A. that may influence our future? Physicians and other professionals are constantly searching for new and “better” ways to help people who are suffering—new ways of understanding what “make us tick”—in the hope that new tools of thought and chemistry will improve the results of treatment. Some of these have helped some people for a while.

Will there ever be a pill that will “cure” alcoholism? I don’t think so; but the search will continue, I believe, so long as there are those who will not or cannot accept the A.A. program, and so long as there are physicians and others who depend on chemical answers. Suffering people will be coming to us who are addicted to more than one drug. We are learning to live with that. Why do I think that no pill will do the job? Without the working of the Steps, there is no relief from the soul sickness which is the burden of alcoholism. Without the love and service that Dr. Bob talked

about, there is no joy. Unless we pass it on with joy, we lose it. We never get it by just being dry.

I look for continued improvement in our ability to work with physicians, social workers, police, and clergy as we learn more about each other and understand, trust, and respect each other. We are all important and needed in the recovery of the still-suffering alcoholic. As we work together, more people will find their way into A.A.; fewer will drop out during the critical first three months (when we lose half of those who come to us).

I look for continued growth of A.A. around the world as we do a better job in crossing the language and culture barriers. As we share more completely with people having other addictions in addition to alcohol, greater understanding will develop and fewer people will get lost on the way. Perhaps more young teenagers will come into A.A.

Will disagreements and personal jealousies within the Fellowship tear us apart? Not if we live by the Steps and Traditions and cherish the principle of anonymity. There have been, are, and will be those who demand their own strict interpretation of the A.A. program. So far, the group conscience has said “Keep It Simple” and don’t clutter it up with a lot of legalisms. I hope that it will continue that way, for, in my opinion, if A.A. became fixed according to the ideas of a few, it would no longer meet the needs of everyone where they now are.

John Norris, M.D. (trustee emeritus)

Reports on Area Service Highlights—Panel 35

Alabama/N.W. Florida: Our area has 19 districts with 278 groups. Our assemblies meet quarterly; our districts meet monthly or quarterly. The Budget, P.I., C.P.C., Institutions, Convention, and Grapevine Committees are active. The Grapevine Committee is growing despite problems. At our workshops G.S.R.’s and D.C.M.’s study the service manuals and participate in all service committees. The assembly ask-it-basket sessions generate many questions and sharing. Our concerns are dual addiction and court referrals.—*Jack McLemore*

Arkansas: Our assembly is growing in numbers, enthusiasm, and amount of younger members. Great strides have been made in getting panels of A.A. members in our schools (including higher education). Our two-day assemblies now begin (on Saturday morning) with a Traditions and Concepts session led by past delegates. These sessions have been very well received. A new assembly committee—Group Relations—has been formed, composed of D.C.M.’s and chairpersons of standing committees. The delegate meets with this committee to share district problems; and two of its members welcome newcomers and provide an orientation to the assembly. We don’t have as many “lost sheep” wandering around wondering what’s going on.—*Harlan Petter*

British Columbia/Yukon: Our new committee is a beehive of activity. P.I. and C.P.C. committees are sprouting up, carrying the message throughout the area. The archives are now housed in the Vancouver Intergroup’s new office, and materials are displayed

around the area. Our area convention is a tool for unity; members of different districts sponsor meetings. We are now planning our next convention, to be held August 15–17, 1985, with the theme “50 Years of A.A.” Service manual and history meetings are springing up all over our area.—*Harold Stevens*

California (Northern Coastal): Our area is healthier and more enthusiastic about service than ever. Over 1,200 groups receive our newsletter, and group contributions are increasing. All 18 districts have elected Panel 35 D.C.M. chairpersons, who hold monthly meetings for G.S.R.’s and D.C.M.’s. During the past year, each district held at least one service workshop (some held two). D.C.M.’s are better informed and assume more responsibility on the area committee. Our D.C.M.-at-large represents all Spanish-speaking groups within a district and encourages participation in the service structure. The increasing unity between H.&I. and general service is heartwarming.—*Diane Olsen*

California (Southern): Service in our area has grown tremendously during the past few years. The P.I. Committee (organized in 1983) is working on a project in the assembly (sending over 200 letters to doctors); if successful, it may be carried to the entire area. The Spanish districts hold their own workshops and sponsor Spanish events at general workshops. This year, the Hospital & Institutions Committee was given a more active role in the area assembly. Our major aim is for excellent communication between the intergroups, H.&I. Committee, and general service structure.

We share the same goal—carrying the message to suffering alcoholics—and we want to travel the road together in harmony, peace, and mutual understanding.—*Ann Garrity*

Colorado: Our area is growing all the time. We now have over 500 groups and 24 districts. We hold four assemblies and one state convention a year, which continue to increase in attendance. Our newly formed C.P.C. Committee is hard at work, as is the P.I. Committee. This year we are sponsoring the 1985 Young People's Conference. Our treatment and correctional facilities are concerned with the large influx of people from treatment centers and prisons, helping with temporary sponsorship. We hope our D.C.M.'s and G.S.R.'s will become more involved in workshops on the Twelve Traditions, Twelve Concepts, and "The A.A. Service Manual" and more informed about A.A. activity worldwide.—*Edwin Price*

Connecticut: Our area has no intergroups; the area service committee performs all service functions. We have nine special service committees, and we are divided into nine districts, each with a D.C.M. and alternate. In February 1984, a special meeting with gay people focused on the proposed gay A.A. pamphlet. A non-geographical district for Spanish-speaking A.A.'s has been added. Our September convention was successful, as was our roundup. An ad hoc committee, headed by the delegate, will look into our assembly voting structure.—*Richard Koseski*

District of Columbia: Our area has 32 districts, with over 357 groups located in Maryland and Northern Virginia. We hold monthly area meetings and three area assemblies a year, in addition to cluster meetings. Our annual "mini-Conference" is well attended, especially by our 12 very active Spanish-speaking groups. Our C.P.C. and P.I. Committee manned two A.A. exhibits for a national mental health show and for the N.C.A. Forum this year. The finance committee has been allotted funds to help pay expenses for A.A.'s who attend A.A. service functions. Many D.C.M.'s and G.S.R.'s are learning first-hand what service is all about.—*Eleanor Boyle*

Florida (North): Our area, with 330 groups, continues to experience stable and solid growth. Responding to a perceived need in correctional facilities, the assembly funded a film library, which is now available to D.C.M.'s and G.S.R.'s, as well as to "inside" and "outside" sponsors for correctional facilities groups. The proliferation of rehabilitation facilities has underlined the continuing importance of viable temporary sponsorship programs in most districts. Our Disabilities Committee is inspiring more consideration for members who have problems with breathing, locomotion, hearing, and seeing; they are beginning to receive more unselfish assistance.—*Robert Schneck*

Florida (South): We have made great strides this past year. In January 1984 we established P.I. committee, which has been well attended with much enthusiasm and input. A book of resolutions of the committee meetings was started; it will record all motions and their disposition. The quarterly workshop on "The A.A. Service Manual" was so successful that similar workshops will be set up. Our area is the third highest in number of GvR's (our alternate delegate is still Grapevine chairperson). We hope to host the Southeastern Convention in 1987 and the 1988 Regional Forum. Our mailing list is now computerized.—*Josh Hill*

Hawaii: We have nine districts, with over 250 meetings weekly. Committee meetings are held monthly, and assemblies are held three or four times a year (or when called). C.P.C. Committee



members are escorting third-year medical and nursing students to open meetings. Frequent visits to the libraries show that our literature is being checked out. Our Conference Committee purchased a computer, causing questions as to ownership of property. Our Founder's Day Weekend was held on May 31 and June 1, 1985.—*Patrick Walsh*

Illinois (Chicago): Our Spanish-speaking community now sends a representative to our area assembly. The suggestion by the Spanish community that they become a district, not geographically, but in language alone, was unanimously approved by our area assembly. We believe that this union will benefit all. During the past years, we have tried to bring a more personal knowledge of A.A. to the districts through workshops. We are planning an All-Chicago Open A.A. Meeting, to be held at the University of Illinois.—*William Wilson*

Illinois (Southern): Our Fourth Annual Spring Conference, held in conjunction with the March area assembly, had workshops and discussions on the Conference agenda to better prepare the delegate. Our area meetings are now held prior to the assemblies, and we hold G.S.R. workshops to arouse interest in service. The P.I. committee is making slow but steady progress on production of a 9.5-sec. videotape (area stations say the G.S.O. 30-sec. P.S.A.'s are too long). Our Grapevine committee needs much work. In November 1986 our area will host the 26th Annual Tri-State Convention—the first to be held in Illinois. Hopefully, it will provide much needed involvement with our southern districts.—*Jim Hill*

Indiana (Northern): Last year, our State Committee put our general service structure into effect, with two new committees: the Finance-Budget Committee and the State Convention Committee. This structure is working and has improved communication on the district and group levels. We have many more workshops and a steady increase in attendance at G.S.R. and district meetings. We are planning to meet with past delegates to share on service work and discuss current problems.—*Hubert Malone*

Iowa: Several districts have split due to the increased number of groups and to cut down on travel time. We now have 16 districts, and attendance at district and assembly meetings is growing. Cluster meetings were started last year, including workshops on service at the grass roots—the G.S.R.; these have been well attended. Our P.I. and C.P.C. Committees and our Grapevine and Literature Committees were separated. Our membership is becoming more service-oriented. Many groups have experienced nonalcoholic drug addicts attending closed A.A. meetings. We use our Third Tradition and the pamphlet "Problems Other Than Alcohol" for guidance.—*Evelyn Vyverberg*

Louisiana: We now have 23 districts, with 360 groups and about 5,000 members. Our area assembly meets quarterly, with workshops held on Saturdays and business meetings on Sundays. In November 1984 the workshop topic was our Third Legacy; in

February 1985 the topic was the newcomer. Attendance at our annual State Convention (held in Baton Rouge in July) is steadily increasing—in 1984, total registration was 833. Our main concern is that 153 groups (42%) do not contribute to the assembly—a job for the D.C.M.'s.—*D. T. Waller Jr.*

Massachusetts (Eastern): Our area is small geographically, but we have about 1,200 groups divided into 26 districts. Our area and district committees meet monthly; also, our districts meet in clusters three or four times annually. We have a number of Conference committees, two of which have representatives from district committees as well as from groups. One of these is the P.I. Committee. In the past few years, many young people have become active on this committee, carrying the A.A. message to young people in schools, church groups, and court programs. Our Archives Committee is now gathering an oral history of A.A. in our area. Our quarterly area newsletter has spotlighted the Concepts during the past year.—*Mary Reynolds*

Michigan (Central): Our area has about 300 groups. In spite of large distances, we maintain contact by holding meetings in a different city each month, with excellent attendance. Many districts have intra-group or unity council sessions, which help facilitate activities begun by intra-area; often they begin their own projects. This unity has enabled us to place about 300 Big Books and "Twelve and Twelve's" in schools, libraries, and prisons. Recently a woman was elected alternate delegate—a first in our area. We are striving to increase the number of A.A.'s active in service and work closely with our two sister areas.—*Chuck Furtaw*

Michigan (Southeastern): Service in our area has progressed a great deal, with a lot of achievements during the past few years. After redistricting, we have 23 districts. Each district is aware of the importance of electing a D.C.M. and has a monthly workshop. During the past two years, we have grown from 300 to 489 groups. We hosted a "Septemberfest" to raise funds for literature for our correctional institutions committee. The success of a statewide workshop, attended by about 200 people, motivated us to add two more area workshops.—*Adam Tengler*

Minnesota (Southern): During the past seven years, we have come a long way. We now have 13 districts, and we hold three assemblies a year plus a three-day service conference in January. The area committee meets before each assembly and also in December. Our ten committees are doing a fine job. We are in the black because of our good finance committee and group support. Archives sets up a fine display at our service conference and other A.A. functions. Quite a few districts hold workshops; and Big Book meetings have increased.—*Richard Klaras*

Missouri (Eastern): Our one-day assemblies are held quarterly; and an area committee meeting is held about a month before each assembly. We are now updating our "Procedure Manual." We are looking for a new location for the archives (now located in a private home). Our archivist is writing a book on our area history. Tapes of members with 20 years or more of sobriety are be-

ing collected; they give their views on service history. A district P.I. chairperson recently attended a health fair, where he met someone who puts on about 75% of these fairs; he contacted the C.P.C. Committee, and they're moving on from there.—*Dennis Moore*

Missouri (Western): Our assembly has experienced eight years of dynamic growth, both in attendance and in the development of a service structure for our 150 groups. This growth culminated on January 1, 1985, when our Western Missouri Area Service Guidelines went into effect to help the assembly, districts, and groups clarify problems of service work. Our main problems are: (1) the need for improved communication between the groups and A.A. as a whole through the levels of the service structure; and (2) the lack of commitment by a large number of groups to support their districts, area assemblies, and the General Service Office, not only financially, but through sending G.S.R.'s to district and area meetings.—*Richard Bush*

Nevada: Our biggest area highlight is our recent rapid growth. In the past ten years, our registered groups have tripled. At the 1983 area assembly we were given eight new districts; as of January 1, 1985, we had used seven of them (two in California). Part of this growth is due to activity in the rural districts, which regularly host workshops and area committee meetings, attracting many new members. The roles of the alternate delegate and alternate chairperson have been redefined. The current expansion of our C.P.C. program is being handled by two past delegates. We continue to strive for a stronger and unified area through better communication in service.—*Fred Yourdon*

New Jersey (Northern): 1984 was another year of growth for our area. All districts are now represented at the area level. Many districts have formed P.I. and C.P.C. committees, which work in tandem with the respective area committees. Regular meetings commenced between the area committee officers and the trustees of our Intergroup Association. A spirit of cooperation now exists, with joint projects planned for 1985. Our major problem in 1984 was the large number of open-discussion meetings set up by groups that do not meet the six-point definition of an A.A. group (many have nonalcoholics as members). We are trying to contact these groups to explain our Traditions and Bill's message about "singleness of purpose."—*John Quinn*

New York (Central): Our assembly meets monthly, convening at least twice in each of our six districts. For the past three years, we hosted a state workshop on P.I., C.P.C., and institutions, which has had an illuminating impact and has included the public and professionals. As a result, interest in service has increased. Our G.S.R.'s eagerly sponsor newcomers into service. Substantial unanimity can be felt in our monthly workshops. P.I. meetings are becoming common.—*James Doss*

New York (Southeastern): Our area has continued to grow, with more interest in service. We are divided into 13 counties, with 84 districts. We hold 11 committee meetings and five assemblies each year. D.C.M.'s are encouraged to plan district meetings. We have active P.I., C.P.C., Institutions, and Grapevine Committees. We also conduct a school for G.S.R.'s. Members who are not active in service are encouraged to attend.—*Emily Rayford*

North Carolina/Bermuda: The number of workshops in our May and November assemblies has been increased to ten, dividing the time so that each service person attends two different workshops. The first five workshops have different topics; the

Before or after?

Before giving his presentation on Friday afternoon, Frank Mauser (archivist) talked about his tendency to procrastinate about completing the presentation. Frank then referred to Jim Estelle Jr. (Class A trustee) as a "world-class procrastinator" who was adept at finishing a presentation after delivering it.

last five usually have the same topic. Support for the Grapevine has increased, and there is a GV table at all our functions. Distribution of A.A. literature has increased substantially. One of our concerns is the lack of attendance at the assemblies. The approximately 10% increase in the number of groups has not been reflected in our assembly attendance.—*James Johnson*

Nova Scotia/Newfoundland/Labrador: Our area is geographically very large, with 220 groups divided into 16 districts. Each province has a spring roundup to prepare for our fall assembly. Last year, for the first time, our service meeting was held separate from the roundup. Most districts have institutions committees plus active P.I.-C.P.C. committees. Our area continues to grow, with more interest in service. Most districts hold monthly meetings; many hold workshops on the Traditions, Concepts, etc. Recently several districts conducted a G.S.R. school. Due to geography, I am not able to visit each district as often as I would like. Fortunately, good communication exists with other area officers plus D.C.M.'s.—*David O'Leary*

Ohio (Central and Southeast): Our area has 15 districts with about 400 groups. We are now in a rebuilding stage. Since September, we have held district meetings. We have also elected new D.C.M.'s and alternates, and we are encouraging districts to hold monthly or quarterly meetings. By going out to the districts, assembly attendance has increased 15%. We are also hosting the Ohio State Conference in Columbus this year. A first for our area—this year we elected alternates for all officers. Our area did not get into this shape overnight, and we cannot rebuild overnight. I hope we have learned from past mistakes, and we look forward to a brighter future.—*George Mudrich*

Ohio (Northeast): Attitudes toward general service are changing in our area. Once, delegates had to pay their own expenses, and meetings and activities were sparsely attended. For the past two years, our area secretary has had a computer available, which allowed us to (1) print address labels for mailing nearly 1,000 pieces, (2) keep accurate records, and (3) provide G.S.O. with exact information. A letter requesting support was mailed twice a year to all groups, with a 25% response. The added revenue has helped to pay part of the expenses of our delegate and other officers. We are now deciding whether to obtain a computer to continue our progress.—*Lois Fischer*

Oklahoma: We have had an exciting and active year. The area office was moved to larger quarters and is now in the same building with intergroup and Al-Anon offices. Our archives is outstanding and has many originals. This past year, a separate C.P.C. committee was formed. Our "bridging the gap" program is doing well—we are in all Oklahoma City and most state treatment centers. On May 17-19, we will hold our 44th Anniversary State Conference, at which this delegate will report on this 35th Conference.—*Day Fezler*

Ontario (Eastern): Our area straddles the U.S./Canadian border. Two of our 23 districts have groups on both sides of the border, and one "Canadian" district has all its groups in the U.S. We are proud of our international configuration because it symbolizes the true flavor of our Fellowship, which does not recognize boundaries, either international or personal. Our area has about 450 groups. The area committee now contains the full slate of functional committees (we added a treatment facilities committee last year). We have the largest concentration of correctional facilities in Canada, largely centered in Kingston, Ontario.—*Bob Easby*



Ontario (Northeast): We are experiencing many growing pains. We grew from one intergroup (in Sudbury) to two (in Sault Ste. Marie), with a possible third (in North Bay) in the near future. Our area consists of 167 groups divided into eight districts, one of which is French-speaking. Our two annual assemblies are well attended by out-of-town G.S.R.'s and alternates but sparsely attended by G.S.R.'s from the three Sudbury districts (perhaps because they are held in Sudbury). All levels of service are represented at these assemblies.—*Noel Quesnelle*

Ontario (Northwest): In 1984 we had good membership support. We have 71 groups in seven districts spread over 250,000 sq. mi., most of which is accessible only by airplane or winter snow train. Thus our main means of communication is the written word. Many far northern A.A.'s speak Cree or Ojibway and little English; requests by some of these A.A.'s for A.A. literature translated into their native dialects are being considered. Half our districts are well established, and half are struggling but active. After 18 years, we have finally elected a female delegate, female alternate, female D.C.M., and female C.P.C. coordinator. The tables seem to be turning—our present area secretary is a man! —*Diane Salavich*

Pennsylvania (Eastern): Our area consists of 31 districts and 755 groups (60 are meetings only). We carry the message into 25 correctional facilities and about 60 treatment facilities. The area committee meets quarterly, the districts monthly, and the sub-committees at least quarterly. Four mini-assemblies are held annually to deliver the delegate's Conference report and hold ser-

vice workshops for G.S.R.'s and other A.A.'s; these assemblies have been invaluable. Our past delegates continue to serve on our convention committee and share their experience and counsel. Our area attitudes, structure, expansion, and A.A. relationships are healthy.—*Robert Neerland*

Pennsylvania (Western): Four area meetings were held in 1984. At the October 11 area meeting, elections were held using Third Legacy procedures. District 17 (Altoona) reported C.P.C. activity; District 14 (Washington County) installed an answering service; and District 23 reported activity with correctional institutions. Our sharing weekend (June 29 to July 1) was a great success, with wonderful guest speakers, workshops, ask-it baskets, delegate's reports, and a Twelve Traditions play. Another sharing weekend is planned for July 1985.—*Ray Donovan*

Quebec (Northeast): Our area has 314 French groups plus six English groups (with 35 new groups this year) split into 19 districts and two subdistricts. All districts have monthly meetings with all G.S.R.'s and P.I., C.P.C., Twelve Steps, Institutions, and Grapevine Committees. Our new Metro Central Service Office includes five districts, with 94 groups. Several districts have schools for G.S.R.'s. At our special assembly in January and February, G.S.R.'s, D.C.M.'s, and other A.A.'s shared on Conference topics. Our assembly after the Conference helps the delegate to communicate with members.—*Jean-Baptiste Lapointe*

Quebec (Southeast): The distance from one end of our area to the other is about 1,000 miles. (One district is on an island 90 miles out at sea.) Each of our 16 districts has its own P.I. coordinator and GvR. We have four area meetings annually plus one general assembly. Our 230 groups are all French-speaking (six English-speaking groups joined Area 87 for bilingual reasons, with our blessings). On our "Day of the Delegate" in February, we hold workshops to discuss Conference topics. At two dinners of gratitude each year, members express their gratitude toward A.A.; at one of these dinners, the delegate reports on the Conference.—*Maurice Rondeau*

Texas (Northeast): Our area has over 300 groups divided into 20 districts (33 groups are new). Our districts are becoming more involved in service. Tri-district and bi-district formats for meetings have helped to increase communication among the groups, districts, and committee members, as well as action committees and the delegate. Enthusiasm and mutual support are generated at these meetings, which focus on all areas of service. A seminar on alcoholism, held by one district's P.I.-C.P.C. workers in January 1985, had excellent results. Communication is a concern in our area. We get a great deal of strength and hope from sharing our service experience, and we are seeking ways of improving our communication.—*Pat Rosenstiel*

Going bananas!

While sharing ice cream with fellow delegates at the local Howard Johnson's restaurant on Sunday night, Dick Koseski (Panel 35, Connecticut) was visited by a lovely lady, Kathleen Carr (Panel 34, Alaska), who was roaming from table to table carrying a spoon and sampling everyone's ice cream. Kathleen sat down at Dick's table and requested that he order something good. A delicious ice-cream and banana feast was placed in front of her, and she devoured the entire banana. For the remainder of the Conference, Kathleen received a half-dozen bananas each day for breakfast from several admiring delegates.

Texas (Southeast): Our assembly has recently published a quarterly newsletter. We were just granted nonprofit status by the I.R.S., which reduces our mailing expenses and eliminates taxation of our bank accounts. We are moving toward support of our G.S.R.'s, D.C.M.'s, delegate, and alternate delegate. Despite these accomplishments, our area is experiencing an alarming degree of apathy. Although notices are sent to 300 members, only 50 to 75 attend our monthly meetings. At least one district a month requests a caucus to elect a D.C.M. We hope to turn this situation around as soon as possible.—*Helen McClure*

Utah: Unity has been achieved (through communication) between the service committee, G.S.R.'s, and D.C.M.'s—a long road built with a lot of patience, tolerance, and love. After our spring rally, a \$400 profit was sent to our area committee. We now have a prudent reserve and a nice balance. Our fall assembly is held in the north, and the spring assembly (spring rally) is held in the southern part of the state. We also have two annual summer campouts. Our main concerns are suggesting the reading of A.A. Guidelines and involving A.A.'s in hospital and correctional facilities work.—*Marilyn Hutchinson*

Virginia: Our area increased by 80 groups in 1984 and is already growing by leaps and bounds in 1985. Therefore, our area committee has elected a Growth Committee and approved guidelines for this committee. We are grateful for these growth problems. Our fall assembly voted to have a D.C.M. serve on all committees to achieve continuity of the committees and therefore improve their effectiveness. Our 1984 convention, held in Roanoke, received the largest attendance we ever had. Our 1985 convention will be held in Richmond on August 23–25.—*Tom Hearn*

Washington: We are writing our second history of our area, and every group and district are involved, including oldtimers. (Publication is expected in October 1986.) Our area Third Legacy Committee was formed to introduce service and service structure to the entire membership. Hopefully, this committee will become a part of the program for every assembly, workshop, and little assembly. We are now moving forward in ways that guard against complacency. The Pacific Regional Forum, which was held in Seattle in May 1984, helped to bridge the gap between grass roots and G.S.O., creating a surge in service participation.—*Robert Olson*

West Virginia: Our area has 13 districts, and our spring and fall assemblies rotate among the districts. Our area committee meets in January and July and makes up the agendas for the assemblies. New business at our spring assembly included reviewing an area directory, drawing up a two-year budget, and the expenses of our delegate and the committee. The workshop topic was people being sent to A.A. from the courts, jails, care units, and outside agencies. A.A. meetings now exist in all our penal institutions, with the exception of one. We have gained over 27 new groups during the past year.—*John Denham*

Wisconsin (Southern): Redistricting is our great concern. Our urban districts have a concentration of groups, while some geographically large districts have few groups. Also some districts have two to four counties with 6 to 50 groups, as well as counties with few or no meetings. (In these districts one must travel 60 or 80 miles to a meeting.) Since 1972, we have grown from 8 to 23 districts, and our A.A. membership has almost tripled. We feel that more growth would result if all districts were apportioned in more manageable sizes, according to either number of meetings or geographical size.—*Mildred Baeseman*

Questions Reflect a Diversity of Concerns

Ask-It Basket

Area Matters

Q How many areas or conventions have computers?

A A show of hands indicated that approximately 14 areas now have computers.

Q Do you require a quorum at your area assembly meetings to conduct business? At your area committee meetings?

A The majority of those sharing indicated that the number of people present at a particular area assembly or committee meeting constituted a quorum. It was also shared by one area that it conducts business as long as the delegate and alternate delegate are present.

Q Should the areas abide by "The A.A. Service Manual" in the selection of trustees and trustees-at-large, as per paragraph 6, page 100?

A It was suggested that the Third Legacy procedure should be used in area elections, as it is at the Conference.

Q Printed flyers concerning area events sometimes contain full names. Although the individuals have given permission to use their full names, is there a violation of the Eleventh Tradition since these flyers are often read at open meetings?

A Sharing on this question indicated that different areas handle this matter in different ways. Some areas feel that if the flyers are for distribution strictly within the Fellowship, then no anonymity break will result if full names are used. In this regard, one area delivers their flyers directly to the group G.S.R.'s for distribution. On the other hand, some areas post their flyers on bulletin boards in public buildings, and therefore only first names and last-name initials are used. Still another area feels that to use full names is a break of the Twelfth Tradition, not the Eleventh.

Q I would like to know more about the International Advisory Council of Young People in A.A. Does the area support them financially and, if so, why? If not, why?

A Once again, this matter is handled differently in different areas. Some areas give both moral and financial support, while others only give moral support. The type of assistance would be up to the group conscience of the area involved. This question was also discussed at last year's Conference, and the information is contained on page 29 of the *1984 Final Conference Report*.

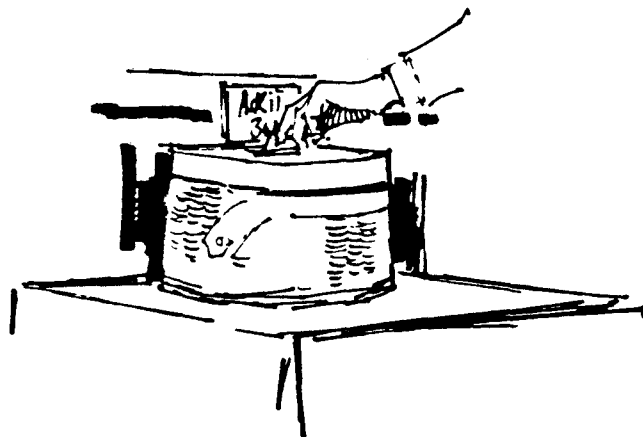
Central Offices

Q What would constitute a prudent reserve fund for central offices or intergroups?

A An earlier discussion of this question at the Conference indicated that a prudent reserve fund would lie somewhere between 1 to 12 months' operating expenses. However, this would be up to the intergroup, central office, or whoever oversees these entities.

Q How much do central office staffs get paid in different parts of the country?

A Since these entities range from large literature distribution centers to smaller central offices, the salaries also vary. In one area, the central office has two employees—one full-time and one part-time. The full-time employee receives \$6.50 per hour, and the part-timer \$4.50 per hour. Eight years ago in another area, the minimum wage was paid; and today some of the employees earn from \$15,000 to \$16,000 per year plus benefits, with the secretary making \$19,000 to \$20,000 a year. Another area has three central offices—one receives no pay; the second receives half pay; and at



another the secretary receives \$2,000 per month, and the clerk \$1,000 per month. Still another area has three central offices and several answering services. The two central office managers receive \$300 per month for doing just about everything—with a lot of volunteer help. And in still another area, the pay is \$1,400 per month, with two-weeks' paid vacation plus medical benefits. Another member shared, "When you pay peanuts for a salary, you get monkeys working for you!"

Conferences and Conventions

Q If A.A. is to be self-supporting, why does G.S.O. accept contributions from roundups and conferences instead of depending on group contributions?

A A show of hands indicated that almost all present felt it was okay for G.S.O. to accept contributions from conferences and conventions. One member shared that in his area a separate basket is passed around on Saturday night strictly for G.S.O. contributions.

Q The cost of attending many conventions is increasing rapidly. What innovative ways are working to bring down the cost and thus enable more participation by the Fellowship?

A Some suggestions included the following: If universities are located in the area, the use of dorm or university space for these events is less costly than hotels. Keep a close watch on coffee consumption. It was shared that some areas sell tickets for a cup of coffee. In Georgia, it was noted that the groups pay for a state fee-paid convention. Limiting the distance from which speakers are invited is also cost-saving. Northern New Jersey also cut the registration fee for their conference in half, and while they realized the same profit as at the former fee, there were twice as many people in attendance.

Q A.A. roundups—do they exist? What makes a gathering an A.A. roundup or not an A.A. roundup?

A Yes, A.A. roundups do exist. You can call a gathering anything your group conscience decides. One member shared that in his area, the young people's gathering is called a roundup so that it does not become confused with the area conference.

Hot or cold?

Eleanor Boyle (Panel 35, District of Columbia) asked the hotel management to supply heat for her room. Unable to repair the old radiator, management sent Eleanor a small refrigerator.

Cooperation With the Professional Community

Q If an area furnished the addresses of doctors who are heavily involved in the treatment of alcoholism, would G.S.O. mail pertinent new information to them concerning this disease?

A First of all, it should be noted that G.S.O. does not mail information on the disease of alcoholism to anyone. G.S.O. distributes information on the A.A. program of recovery to anyone who requests it. While G.S.O. does not mail any unsolicited material, if a delegate or area sends in a list of doctors' names and addresses, it would be assumed that these professionals have been approached and have requested that this material be sent to them. But, once again, G.S.O. would not send out any unsolicited material.

Finance

Q What does your area treasurer do about taxes on interest on an interest-paying checking account?

A Your best bet would be to talk to the people at the Internal Revenue Service regarding this matter.

Q Explain the retirement program at G.S.O. Who gets it? How long do you have to be there to participate? What formula is used to calculate it? Is it tied to social security in any way?

A All employees of A.A. World Services, Inc., and The A.A. Grapevine, Inc., are eligible to participate in the pension plan. To do so, one must be employed for at least one year and not have attained their 64th birthday. The formula used is 2% of the average annual salary based on the best 36 consecutive months of the last 10 years of service, times the years of service, with a social security offset.

Q When and by whom was it decided that Lois's royalties could and would be bequeathed to the next generation, and when will the royalties become A.A.'s totally, if ever?

A The royalties are paid on the books Bill Wilson wrote, which are: The Big Book; "A.A. Comes of Age"; "As Bill Sees It"; and "Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions" (two editions). The royalties are the result of an agreement between A.A.W.S. and Bill Wilson in 1963. Lois was to receive 13 1/2% of the retail value of the books, which she still receives today. Under the terms of the agreement between Bill and A.A.W.S., Lois could, on a one-time basis, bequeath 80% of the royalties to individuals who were age 40 or more in 1963. The remaining 20% could be left to individuals of any age. This agreement has now been amended, and Lois can leave the royalties to other than an individual, such as a foundation to maintain Stepping Stones. However, any royalties Lois wills to a foundation will terminate ten years after her death. All other royalties will revert back to the board upon the demise of the recipient. In the amendment, Lois gives up the right

to leave anything to individuals younger than age 40 in 1963 except for an individual who was a few months short of age 40 at that time.

General Service Conference

Q Is the idea of having committee assignments on name tags still alive?

A This matter was suggested on an evaluation form from last year's Conference. We considered doing it this year, but some of the committee names are quite long and would not readily fit on the name tags. It was also felt that asking what committee someone serves on would act as an icebreaker for Conference members.

Q Could we have a map depicting our area borders included in our 1986 Conference Kit so that everyone knows where each of us comes from?

A If it is a serious desire of the Conference that we prepare such a map and print it, then it will be done. It was pointed out, however, that it would be almost impossible to draw precise boundary lines in such states as California and New York.

Q Is there some tradition that dictates that we always have the General Service Conference at the Roosevelt Hotel? Wouldn't a suburban hotel, such as the Westchester Marriott in Tarrytown, be cheaper and more comfortable? Also, how about eliminating the meals in the hotel that are not essential to the agenda of the moment?

A Several years ago, the suggestion was made to hold the Conference in a suburban hotel or convention center, but the Conference was overwhelmingly negative on this idea. Many members who come to the Conference look forward to coming to New York City, and, as a result, the matter was dropped. However, if there is a strong movement in that direction, the Conference can do whatever it wishes.

Q Could we request that Conference members not circulate books for signatures while other Conference members are giving presentations or other Conference business is going on. At its worst, it is rude, and, at its best, it is distracting.

A A show of hands indicated that most Conference members felt that there was nothing wrong with the practice of circulating books for signatures during Conference sessions.

Grapevine

Q Why can't we have one set Canadian price on our Grapevine magazine?

A The main reason for this is the fluctuation in the exchange rate that makes it difficult to charge a set rate. Many groups also charge what they need to charge for the magazine. The standard practice is to have the U.S. price on the outside cover and the Canadian rates on the inside. The difference in these two costs is simply the cost of mailing the Grapevine to Canada.

They know us well

While serving George Murdoch (Panel 35, Central and South-eastern Ohio) a helping of tasty sausage, bacon, and ham during the closing brunch, a quick-witted waiter slipped him an extra sausage, saying, in a low voice, "One for the road!"



Group Matters

Q We feel that a group that has only open meetings or open discussion meetings does not constitute a group and should not be listed in the directory or intergroup listings. (Remember, a group's primary purpose is to help alcoholics recover.)

A It was the sense of the meeting that there was nothing wrong with open meetings, and it was pointed out that the pamphlet "The A.A. Group" states that open A.A. meetings can have non-alcoholics participate if this is the group conscience of the group. One member shared that if you eliminated open meetings in his part of the country, you would eliminate 75% of the groups.

Q We have a Sunday-morning A.A. Bible Study Group. Other than pointing out the Traditions and what constitutes an A.A. meeting, should we pursue it?

A It was suggested that even though we are a spiritual program, it would not be a good thing to call this group an A.A. group.

Q Would someone please share their experience with me on this matter? An A.A. group celebrates its anniversary and invites Al-Anon to participate. It then wants to split the proceeds with Al-Anon. Isn't this a violation of the Sixth and Seventh Traditions (keeping in mind our Fourth Tradition)?

A It was the sense of the meeting that this would be in violation of A.A. Traditions and that monies should not be contributed to Al-Anon. Another area shared that they pass two hats—one for A.A. and one for Al-Anon.

Q In the interests of keeping it simple and, at the same time, encouraging and maintaining the concept of the A.A. group versus the A.A. meeting, I'd like to suggest (again) the following definition for consideration by the General Service Conference: "Traditionally, two or more alcoholics meeting together for purposes of sobriety may consider themselves an A.A. group provided that they maintain group life* within the Traditions and Concepts of Alcoholics Anonymous. (*"and conduct the business of the group" could be inserted at this point if deemed necessary.)

A This matter was discussed at last year's Conference. As stated at that time, to pursue this matter further, a request should be brought to the attention of the Conference Literature Committee. However, it was felt by some that the six-point definition of an A.A. group is still valid.

International Convention

Q How many delegates are getting all or part of their expenses paid to attend the International Convention in Montreal?

A Of those responding, 14 indicated that all of their expenses were being covered, six were having half of their expenses paid, and 44 were going entirely at their own expense.

Literature

Q Why have we never had a pamphlet on the D.C.M.?

A There is a section on the D.C.M. in "The A.A. Service Manual." However, if someone wishes to pursue this matter further, it should be sent in through proper channels to the Conference Literature Committee for inclusion as a Conference item at a future Conference.

Q There is a need for a softcover Big Book for prisons, as hard-cover books are not permitted for security reasons. Would this be possible?

A The matter of a softcover edition of the Big Book was rejected most recently by the 1983 General Service Conference.

Q Two italicized paragraphs at the end of the chapter to wives were inserted when the Third Edition of the Big Book was printed. Why? On what authority? What is the process needed to remove these paragraphs from future editions?

A The two italicized paragraphs were added as footnotes simply to update the material and provide information. It was an editorial decision as is the case with all footnotes. Anyone interested in removing the two paragraphs may contact the trustees' Literature Committee.

Q Has any Conference ever approved the Big Book?

A Yes, it was approved in 1951.

Q Why don't we publish a morning meditation or one-day-at-a-time type of pamphlet? Newcomers use them.

A Such a decision would be up to the Conference. If the Conference would like to go that route, that would be up to them.

Miscellaneous

Q The word "primary" implies that something is "secondary." If our "primary" purpose is to stay sober and help other alcoholics to achieve sobriety, what is our secondary purpose? (I don't think we have a secondary purpose and consequently ask why we don't use the expression "only purpose.")

A You are getting into a matter of semantics on this. In addition to "primary," some A.A.'s use the phrase "singleness of purpose," and others use "main purpose." But they all really mean the same as far as the Fellowship is concerned.

Public Information

Q Can the General Service Office provide a filmstrip for P.I. presentations?

A The General Service Office can provide whatever the Conference wishes.

Q While the book "Courage to Change" by Dennis Wholey is enjoyable, it breaks our Eleventh Tradition. Can something concrete be done such as a letter to the author and a note in this year's *Final Conference Report* about the matter?

A The P.I. Committee has made some recommendations on this, and a letter will be written to the author. One member suggested that "if we leave it alone, it will just die."

Treatment Facilities

Q Some treatment centers in Louisiana are giving sobriety chips with A.A. on one side and the treatment center name on the other side. Could I have some comments on this practice?

A The A.A. name can only be used with permission, and we suggest you check to see if they have such permission. It sounds as if they are probably using the A.A. name illegally, and this should be investigated further.

Reports from the General Service Board, Trustees' Committees, and G.S.O.

These annual reports are submitted to each Conference—via its committees in cases where there are counterparts to the board entities; directly, where there are no counterparts. Unless the Conference as a whole takes some action to the contrary, acceptance of the reports indicates Conference approval of the activities and recommendations included.

General Service Board

A.A.'s unity no longer seems threatened

Trustees' report: 1984 was an active year for the Fellowship. The membership recorded at G.S.O. increased by 8% to approximately 702,000; literature sales increased by 14% to about \$6 million. In 1984 the worldwide recorded membership grew by 14% to an impressive total of almost 1.4 million. Big Book sales rose 15% to a total of 622,000 copies.

Board activities in 1984 included: 50th anniversary plans (our Seventh International Convention); participation in five Regional Forums (Vancouver, Seattle, Charleston, Sault Ste. Marie, and Hawaii); continued revision of some of our policies and procedures; participation in the Eighth World Service Meeting; and selection of a new G.S.O. general manager.

We were saddened by the loss of general service trustee and chairperson of the Grapevine Corporate Board, Mary Phelps—a gentle woman who contributed clarity of thought and incisiveness to board concerns and enriched our lives with her friendship.

During 1984, the recommendations of an Ad Hoc Committee (appointed in 1983) were implemented. Among the most significant were: (1) a revision of our bylaws to limit the term of appointed members of our committees; (2) a thorough revision of the responsibilities of the trustees' Nominating Committee; (3) a similar review and revision of documents on the history and actions of all trustees' committees; (4) the preparation of documents describing the scope and procedures of all trustees' committees; (5) a change in emphasis of the orientation of new trustees toward their board duties, as opposed to office operations; (6) a wider search for candidates for trustees' committees and subsidiary board directors; (7) a rescheduling of board weekends to make possible membership by trustees on more committees; (8) a change in emphasis at the trustees' sharing session to include in-depth reports to the board of the activities of its committees; (9) the appointment of another Ad Hoc Committee to oversee a revision in our handling of the Twelve Concepts; and (10) the inclusion of the short form of the Twelve Concepts in the bylaws of the board.

The Ad Hoc Committee concerned with the Concepts worked in 1984 toward recommendations which are before the Conference Report and Charter Committee. Their effect is to charge that committee with oversight of this important document and to publish it in a form in which Bill's original writing is presented unchanged; any changes that have been made through the years are to be presented in footnotes after each chapter. Some changes have simply updated statistical information; but it appears that many years ago, a zealous editor (or editors) went beyond this to modify Bill's writings in a few instances. In the future, this document will be handled in the same way as "The A.A. Service Manual," with nontrivial changes being approved by a Conference committee.

Last year, the board selected John Bragg to replace Bob Pearson as G.S.O. general manager. John assumed his responsibilities gradually and on an orderly basis. He has been general manager of G.S.O. for about nine months and will replace Bob on the A.A.W.S. board after this Conference, assuming the remainder of Bob's managerial responsibilities after the Montreal Convention. Bob will continue as consultant, general services, gradually decreasing his involvement until he retires in February 1987. The 1986 Conference will be Bob's last.

After 35 years of service to the Fellowship, Dennis Manders will retire in November 1985 at age 60. Dennis is a nonalcoholic employee who has directed G.S.O.'s administrative affairs during much of that time. The stability of that office and the success of our publishing operations are largely due to his wise and temperate stewardship.

There's no doubt that our rate of growth has been greater during the past five years than previously, much of it through increased participation of young people and dually addicted alcoholics. Court and hospital referrals have created problems, and we have found some solutions that work. We are talking freely about these problems, with less anger, more humor, and more hope. The unity of our Fellowship no longer seems to be threatened, even though difficult problems are yet to be solved. Our resolve to preserve our singleness of purpose seems undiminished.

Gordon Patrick, chairperson

A.A. World Services

A.A.W.S. benefits and copyrights examined

Director's report: This board met 12 times during 1984. The following significant items are noted:

- We reviewed and recommended to the trustees' Finance Committee the 1984 budget.
- We authorized the transfer of \$524,000 to the General Service Board to cover 1983 operating deficits. We transferred \$260,000 surplus cash in excess of basic operating requirements to the Reserve Fund.
- We reviewed and approved budget additions at mid-year, amounting to \$33,500, and recommended that this be forwarded to the trustees' Finance Committee for approval.
- We engaged Hay Associates to study the costs and value to employees of the A.A.W.S. entire benefits package. They reported that the total value of our benefits is very close to the average of that offered by other organizations. Specific benefits changes recommended by Hay will be studied and brought to the board separately and are not expected to change the overall costs of this package significantly.
- We forwarded to the Report and Charter Committee the recommendations of the A.A.W.S. Committee on Reviewing the A.A. Directories (subcommittee formed per 1984 Conference Recommendation No. 60).
- At the annual meeting of representatives from G.S.O. with four French-speaking delegates, the French Literature Commit-

tee, and the Eastern Canada trustee, procedures were established to improve communication and eliminate minor problems. Recently translated literature includes "It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell" and the C.P.C. Workbook. The film "A.A.—An Inside View" has been translated and produced on videotape.

- We agreed to an expenditure of about \$3,000 to enable the Central American Literature Committee to produce newer and better translations of some of their pamphlets.
- In May, the G.S.O. in Belgium mailed us a check for \$1,300 as a "free gift" to Poland A.A.'s. As Poland had asked us to help with the purchase of a typewriter, we agreed that Belgium's gift be applied to the cost of the typewriter (\$1,539.28), and that A.A.W.S. absorb the difference (\$239.28). A request from Poland to help with their literature operation was placed on the agenda of the Third European Service Meeting, held in Frankfurt, West Germany, in March 1985.
- The board refused a request from the Central Service Office in New South Wales, Australia, to reverse a 1979 A.A.W.S. action to rescind permission from that entity to reprint and distribute Conference-approved literature.
- We complied with a recommendation by the General Service Board to disapprove a request from the International Advisory Council of Homosexual Men and Women in A.A. to publish the script of the proposed pamphlet for the gay alcoholic, on the basis that giving it over to another entity would constitute subversion of the Conference decision to turn down the pamphlet.
- "Pass It On," the companion book to "Dr. Bob and the Good Oldtimers," was published in December 1984. This biography of Bill contains more than 30 photographs from the A.A. archives and Lois Wilson's personal collection.
- We approved the following prices: "Inside A.A." (Spanish), 10¢; Spanish P.I. Handbook, \$7; "A.A. at a Glance" display unit with easel (100 complimentary copies), \$1.50; "The A.A. Member—Medications and Other Drugs," 15¢; Treatment Facilities Discount Package, \$6.50; G.S.O. filmstrip, "Your G.S.O. Today," \$30 per set of 113 slides plus cassettes, and \$7.50 per filmstrip and cassette; Correctional Facilities Workbook, \$7; Correctional Facilities Guidelines, 10¢; Treatment Facilities Guidelines, 10¢; 12 posters of the Traditions (8 1/2" x 12"), \$5; Archives Scrapbook of newspaper clippings (to be sold primarily to local archival centers), \$50; "Pass It On," \$6.50 (group price, \$5.50); and "Dr. Bob and the Good Oldtimers" and "Pass It On" (gift package with a slip case), \$12 (group price, \$10).
- During 1984, the board granted 62 requests to reprint from A.A. literature and two requests to tape-record; three were tabled, and 13 were withheld.
- We denied a request from Hazelden for a 30% discount on literature they purchase from us.
- We are consulting with legal counsel on matters pertaining to the exclusive literature rights to works commissioned after 1978. The new copyright statute apparently establishes a nonrevokable right of the writer to the work after a period of 35 to 40 years, even when the work is initially licensed to A.A.W.S. by the writer.
- An inquiry terminal has been installed at G.S.O. to allow staff

members to call up group records, either by entering the group numbers or by geographical information. This is a first step toward providing automation capabilities to the staff; the use of the terminal will be monitored to determine the value of further installations.

- In an effort to alert A.A. members to the confusion that will undoubtedly ensue, with outside agencies, magazines, film and TV producers, etc., publicizing A.A.'s 50th anniversary, and in anticipation of questions from A.A.'s about these projects, an article has been written for *Box 4-5-9* emphasizing that the Fellowship be guided by the Traditions.
- It was brought to our attention that in the second and third editions of the Big Book, the word "at" in the sentence "We were prepared to look at it from an entirely different angle" (page 79 in the first edition; page 66 in the second and third editions) was inadvertently changed to "for." This typo will be corrected in the next printing.

Jacquelyn Solomon, chairperson

Literature Distributed—1984

English

Books

Alcoholics Anonymous	622,500
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (reg. edition)	323,000
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (gift edition)	55,500
A.A. Comes of Age	24,000
As Bill Sees It	69,200
Dr. Bob and the Good Oldtimers	23,100
Total	1,117,300

Booklets

Living Sober	167,800
Came to Believe	69,200
Total	237,000

Pamphlets

A.A. and Occupational Programs	44,100
A.A. and the Armed Services	33,900
A.A. as a Resource for the Medical Profession	90,500
A.A. for the Woman	201,700
The A.A. Group	137,600
A.A. in Your Community	162,800
A.A. in Prisons	37,300
A.A. in Treatment Centers	75,700
The A.A. Member	182,900
The A.A. Member and Drug Abuse	215,400
The A.A. Service Manual/Twelve Concepts for World Service	24,300
A.A. Tradition—How It Developed	73,800
A.A.'s Legacy of Service	23,300
A Brief Guide to Alcoholics Anonymous	284,100
A Clergyman Asks About A.A.	47,200
The Co-Founders of Alcoholics Anonymous	64,500
Do You Think You're Different?	244,900
44 Questions	501,900
G.S.R.	55,600
How A.A. Members Cooperate	43,200
How It Works	150,400
If You Are a Professional	104,200

Inside A.A.	96,400
Is A.A. For You?	607,700
Is There an Alcoholic in Your Life?	193,400
It Happened to Alice	91,400
It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell	66,100
The Jack Alexander Article	81,500
Let's Be Friendly With Our Friends	36,900
Letter to a Woman Alcoholic	160,800
A Member's-Eye View of A.A.	166,300
Memo to an Inmate Who May Be an Alcoholic	63,400
A Newcomer Asks	417,600
Problems Other Than Alcohol	167,300
Questions and Answers on Sponsorship	303,600
Speaking at Non-A.A. Meetings	42,700
This Is A.A.	626,000
Three Talks to Medical Societies by Bill W.	48,100
Time to Start Living	136,200
Time to Start Living (large print)	14,700
Too Young?	184,800
The Twelve Traditions Illustrated	70,500
Understanding Anonymity	141,300
What Happened to Joe	92,600
Young People and A.A.	299,400
Total	6,908,00

Miscellaneous

Wallet cards—twofold	943,800
Wallet cards—I Am Responsible	137,500
Wallet cards—Anonymity	79,000
Parchment—scrolls	8,200
Placards	1,000
C.P.C. Workbook	1,100
A.A. Guidelines	100,300
Group Handbook	5,700
Wire Racks	2,500
Cassettes	5,100
Alcoholics Anonymous book (cassette album)	3,100
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions book (cassette album)	1,800
Public Service Announcements (cassettes, tapes, records)	600
A.A. Public Information Workbooks	1,100
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions Shade Displays	2,600
Fact Files	4,700
Total	1,298,100

Spanish

Books

Alcohólicos Anónimos	7,800
El Sendero de Vida	1,800
A.A. Llega a su Mayor Edad	1,100
Total	10,700

Booklets

Vivir en Sobriedad	3,000
El Manual de Servicios de A.A.	1,200
Total	4,200

Pamphlets

A.A. en Su Comunidad	8,500
44 Preguntas	12,800
Esto Es A.A.	20,300
Es A.A. para Usted?	34,500
Carta a una Mujer Alcohólica	3,300
A.A. en Hospitales	1,500
Las Doce Tradiciones	7,400
Carta a un Preso que Puede Ser un Alcohólico	2,200
El Punto de Vista de un Miembro de A.A.	2,900

Los Doce Pasos	10,700
Alcohólicos Anónimos por Jack Alexander	1,900
Tres Charlas a Sociedades Médicas por Bill W.	2,000
A.A. y el Empleado Alcohólico	1,600
Como Trabaja el Programa	9,300
El Marido Alcohólico	3,400
Lo que le Sucedió a José y su Problema con la Bebida	5,000
Comprendiendo el Anonimato	1,900
El Grupo de A.A.	4,000
Preguntas y Respuestas sobre Apadrinamiento	5,600
El Miembro de A.A. y el Abuso de las Dragas	5,000
Las Doce Tradiciones Ilustradas	2,900
Los Jóvenes y A.A.	4,400
Las Tradiciones de A.A.—Cómo se Desarrollaron	1,500
Una Breve Guía a A.A.	4,500
A.A. en Prisiones	3,300
Problemas Diferentes del Alcohol	3,700
Cómo Cooperan los Miembros de A.A.	1,700
Dentro de A.A.	1,800
A.A. como Recurso para la Profesión Médica	2,600
Un Ministro Religioso Pregunta Acerca de A.A.	1,200
R.S.G.	3,600
Total	175,000

Miscellaneous

Tarjeta Tamaño Billetera	Total	8,800
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French

Books

Gros Livre Alcoooliques anonymes	7,900
Le mouvement des A.A. devient adulte	3,125
Réflexions de Bill	3,100
Total	14,125

Booklets

Nous en sommes venus á croire	2,350
Vivre . . . sans alcool!	2,075
Total	4,425

Pamphlets

Les 12 étapes	10,025
Voici les A.A.	10,600
Les A.A.: 44 Questions et Réponses	7,650
Les A.A.: sont-ils pour vous?	18,025
Les A.A. pour la Femme	2,275
Coopération des membres des A.A.	975
Les A.A. et le monde du travail	2,775
Le membre des A.A. et l'abus des drogues	3,075
Les A.A. Article du "Saturday Evening Post"	425
Collaborons avec nos amis	1,125
Questions et Réponses sur le Parrainage	3,050
Les A.A.: Une ressource pour les médecins	2,750
Les A.A. et la Profession Médicale (Medical Profession) disc	825
Les A.A. dans les centres de traitement	2,875
La Tradition des A.A./son Développement	1,925
Les Douze Traditions des A.A.	2,100
Alice l'a trouvée	1,550
Jos Levait le coude	1,675
Les A.A. dans votre milieu	3,075
Problèmes autres que l'alcoolisme	3,000
Point de Vue d'un membre sur les A.A.	1,350
Les Douze Traditions Illustrées	1,650
Notre Méthode	14,675
Les A.A. dans les Prisons	925
Ca vaut mieux que de poireauter en prison	600
Guide Abrégé des A.A.	10,925

Les A.A. et la Religion	1,350
Biographies des Co-Fondateurs	975
Lettre à un détenu	
Le Groupe des A.A.	4,575
Le Manuel de Services/12 Concepts	1,675
12 Etapes/12 Traditions (carte)	5,900
Carte des Etapes et Traditions	2,350
Le sens de l'anonymat	2,300
3 Causeries à des Sociétés Médicales	1,425
Y a-t-il un Alcoolique dans votre vie?	1,375
Si vous exercez des activités prof. à titre de	900
Le R.S.C.	2,150
Causeries à l'extérieur des A.A.	700
Trop Jeunes?	2,500
Les A.A. leur Structure	2,600
L' Héritage des Services des A.A.	750
Cercles d'Amour et de Service	2,725
Vous croyez-vous différent?	1,900
Lettre à une femme alcoolique	1,675
Carte Anonymat (français/anglais)	1,400
Le Membre des A.A.	3,200
Les Jeunes et les A.A.	2,450
Votre B.S.C.	1,425
Il est encore temps de vivre	1,750
Un nouveau venu veut savoir	9,450

Total 167,400

Miscellaneous

Réflexions sur les 12 Etapes	3,150
Les Cinq Articles de Bill	3,300
Prière Sérénité (carte)	49,175
Prière Sérénité (5 x 7)	3,525
Prière Sérénité (12 x 16)	850
Prière Sérénité (23 x 34)	225
Slogans (série 5)	375
Littérature, une aide essentielle	600
Suggestions pour réunions débutants	575
La Vigne A.A.	1,100
Médailles rhodium français	1,600
Jetons Aluminium appelle avant	4,200
Etiquettes Allô	3,500
Enseigne Meeting A.A.	30
Jetons 3 mois aluminium	2,300
Jetons 6 mois aluminium	1,750
Jetons 9 mois aluminium	1,275
Jetons 12 mois aluminium	1,125
Pochette/pour kit nouveau membre	1,925

Total 80,580

Kits nouveaux groupes	100
Panoplies Institutions	85
Panoplies Information Publique	35
Cahier Information publique	20
Aperçu sur A.A.	16,275
Conférenciers dans les prisons	3,150
Message aux adolescents	10,150
Où aller maintenant?	8,650
Renseignements sur les A.A.	4,125
Diverses façons de soutenir financièrement A.A.	1,950
Problèmes autres que l'alcoolisme (citations)	10,530

Total 55,070

HP's anniversary present

Jack Whitehouse (Panel 31 delegate) was overjoyed to learn that he had been elected East Central U.S. regional trustee on Wednesday afternoon—the day of his 11th A.A. anniversary.



Archives

Newsletter is revived

Trustees' committee: We met three times since the 1984 Conference. Our 16 volumes of newspaper clippings are undergoing comprehensive indexing. Also, we have arranged to produce copies of our first scrapbook years, 1939-1942, which chronicle many early historical A.A. events.

Our archival newsletter, *Markings*, has reappeared after a considerable hiatus. Two issues have been approved annually for distribution to archival centers and other interested parties in order to gather a pool of experience in the collection, preservation, and exhibition of early A.A. memorabilia.

Recently, we are designing a traveling historical exhibit, which features panels depicting interesting items from our scrapbook.

Acquisitions this year include: Marty Mann's A.A. correspondence; many area/state and even district histories, a large collection of early books and pamphlets from member collectors; and oral histories from early members.

Permission to review our material was given to many researchers involved in articles celebrating A.A.'s 50th anniversary.

Garrett Taylor, chairperson

Staff report: This has been a very enriching year, as a result of much study by many researchers of our history. Quite a number of important pieces reached completion, too: "Pass It On," "Nova" (a P.B.S. program); "The History of A.A. in Oregon"; "Northern California Coastal Area"; and "Idaho and the Roots of A.A. in Santa Clara County."

We are following behind the G.S.O. File Department in using an advanced microfiche system to reduce space needs, capturing all significant original documents. This will ensure that members and historians will have actual material to ponder. Since there are over 40,000 group folders, this is quite an undertaking and will take some years to complete.

Although many more visitors passed through the Archives Department last year, 858 lingered long enough to sign our guest book, thus leaving a memory of themselves. Not a few of these commented on the "aura of reflectiveness" that pervades the rooms.

Frank Mauser, archivist

Conference

Voting procedure to be studied

Trustees' committee: Suggestions for the 1985 Conference theme were reviewed, and we recommended to the Conference Agenda Committee (which makes the final selection) that the theme be "Golden Moments of Reflection."

The committee reviewed suggestions received through the Conference Evaluation Questionnaire and the post-Conference sharing session and suggested the following:

- That both Panels 34 and 35 delegates be asked to attend the regional orientation session, and that the session be extended to one hour.
- That regional trustees review the committee system with their delegates.
- That regional trustees remind delegates that some people take deep offense at tasteless, sexist language and jokes, and that these do not serve the purpose of being at the Conference.
- That the delegate chairperson suggest that past delegates share information regarding the Delegates' Dinner and Meeting with new delegates.
- Since the voting procedure at the Conference as described in the Conference Charter ("The A.A. Service Manual," page 23, 1983-84 edition) is inconsistent with the voting procedure actually used at the Conference, this committee recommends that the Conference Report and Charter Committee study this matter and consider changing the wording of the Conference Charter to make it consistent with actual practice.
- That the Conference coordinator specify the length for talks at the Closing Brunch in the letters of invitation sent to rotating trustees, and that a light system be used on the podium to help monitor the time.

With the approval of the Conference Agenda Committee, we recommended the following workshops: "Will the Hand of A.A. Always Be There?" and "Beyond the Seventh Tradition—Group Responsibility." Workshop questions were approved for distribution to Conference members.

Topics submitted for 1985 Conference consideration were reviewed, discussed, and referred to the appropriate Conference committee, presentation/discussion, workshop, Ask-It Basket,

or Sharing Session. A list of Conference members participating in the various sessions was reviewed and accepted. The committee reviewed and approved the Conference agenda.

With minor revisions, the committee accepted the Composition, Scope and Procedure, which was developed by the subcommittee assigned to this task; the revised History and Actions were also accepted.

Natalie Schwanke, chairperson

Staff report: The Conference coordinator is a point of contact among all Conference members and all those serving on the 91 area committees in the U.S. and Canada.

All A.A. members are encouraged to submit suggestions for the Conference agenda through the delegates. The suggestions are presented to the trustees' Conference Committee and the Conference Agenda Committee for approval. Then they are shared with the Fellowship via the *Quarterly Report*, Box 4-5-9, and the preliminary Conference agenda (which is mailed to delegates in January).

The Conference coordinator assumes responsibility for:

- 1 Collection of ideas for the Conference theme and agenda.
- 2 Serving as secretary of the Conference Agenda Committee and the trustees' Conference Committee.
- 3 Handling monthly letters and advance correspondence with all delegates in preparation for the Conference
- 4 Working with the general manager, office manager, and staff in planning and coordinating the Conference.
- 5 Scheduling and routing all reports and other material for the Conference Manual, Early Bird Box 4-5-9, and the *Final Conference Report*.
- 6 Coordinating the annual Open House at G.S.O.

The number of districts has increased, with 2,410 D.C.M.'s now listed at G.S.O. Districts have divided into smaller units when necessary; many now have slates of officers similar to area committees. In addition to current trusted servants, contact is maintained with 868 past delegates. Most areas and districts send us copies of their minutes and newsletters, which are reviewed and circulated among the G.S.O. and Grapevine staffs.

On September 29, 1984, we held our annual Open House; 725 A.A.'s from many states and Canada toured the G.S.O. and Grapevine offices. Then, in a nearby auditorium, G.S.O. and Grapevine staff members briefly described their assignments, allotting time for questions and discussion. The Spanish services coordinator simultaneously held an orientation for more than 100 Hispanic A.A.'s. A significant number of our visitors were young people who were seeing the offices for the first time. The South-east New York Area Committee hosted a delicious buffet lunch, which provided an opportunity for fellowship. Our next Open House will be held on November 16, 1985.

Lois Fisher



Cooperation With the Professional Community

An active year; many literature revisions

Trustees' committee: We had a busy and productive year. A.A. participated in 143 annual conferences and conventions. As a result, we received 1,860 requests for A.A. information; and 1,539 people and organizations requested they be added to the *About A.A.* mailing list. Over 400 C.P.C. committees in the U.S. and Canada are now listed with G.S.O.

In keeping with the Ad Hoc Committee's suggestion that all trustees committees review and update their Composition, Scope, and Procedure, a committee was formed, consisting of an attorney, psychiatrist, and an educator (all committee members), to formulate composition, scope, and procedure for this committee, which we ultimately adopted.

We completed the revision of "Memo on Cooperation in Research and Non-A.A. Survey Projects"; we felt that the new title should be "Memo on Participation of A.A. Members in Research and Other Non-A.A. Surveys."

In compliance with the Conference C.P.C. Committee's recommendation to amend the flyer "A.A. at a Glance" and the pamphlets "If You Are a Professional" and "How A.A. Members Cooperate" to include the following—"Nonalcoholic drug addicts do not meet A.A.'s one membership requirement . . . 'the desire to stop drinking' . . . and therefore are not eligible for A.A. membership"—it was felt that the following statement should be included: "There are other programs that are available for these individuals, such as Narcotics Anonymous, and so forth."

We reviewed the pamphlet "If You Are a Professional" and agreed it should be amended to include the recommended material. We also strongly recommended that this pamphlet be referred to the Conference C.P.C. Committee for possible rewriting.

It was felt that the above-suggested revisions could be included in the pamphlet "How A.A. Members Cooperate" on page 10, after the fourth paragraph of the section "A.A.'s Position in the Field of Alcoholism."

The committee discussed the sales of C.P.C. pamphlets and suggested that the pamphlet "The A.A. Member—Medications and Other Drugs" be included in the C.P.C. Workbook; this has been done.

We discussed in depth the revision of the A.A. Guidelines on Cooperation With the Professional Community and suggested basic areas of change.

O. S. Bruner Jr., chairperson

Staff report: We have six Professional Exhibits, which are sent to conferences of national professional organizations. In 1984 our exhibit was shown at 25 meetings and resulted in over 2,500 requests for additional information. These exhibits also help increase the *About A.A.* mailing list, which is now over 17,000.

The C.P.C. staff member sometimes attends annual meetings of

national organizations dealing with alcoholism and represents A.A. in a liaison capacity on the Advisory Council to the National Institute on Alcohol Abuse and Alcoholism.

Some of the other meetings that staff or board members have attended or participated include: Summer School of Alcohol Studies, Rutgers University, New Brunswick, N.J.; Ninth Southeastern Conference on Alcohol and Drug Abuse, Atlanta, Ga.; National Conference of the Alcohol and Drug Problems Assn., Washington, D.C.; Assn. of Labor-Management Administrators and Consultants on Alcoholism, Inc., Denver, Col.; University of Utah School on Alcoholism and Other Drug Dependencies, Salt Lake City; National Convention on Children of Alcoholics, Orlando, Fla.; and Northeastern Conference on Alcoholism and Drug Dependence, Newport, R.I.

C.P.C. committees have increased significantly over the past year, with over 400 now listed here at G.S.O. New committee chairpersons receive the C.P.C. Workbook free; additional copies cost \$7 each. A selection of complimentary C.P.C. literature and service material is sent to new C.P.C. committee members as well as *About A.A.* and *Box 4-5-9* (which now has a section on P.I. and C.P.C. activities).

Curtis Monahan

Correctional Facilities

Workbook is published

Trustees' committee: Following a 1984 Conference Advisory Action, this committee published a Correctional Facilities Workbook, designed to provide C.F. committees and individual A.A.'s with new ideas or new ways to implement old ideas in their corrections Twelfth Step work. The workbook was distributed to all correctional facilities chairpersons and is now available for sale.

Our committee sent a biannual letter explaining the Institutions Correspondence Service to new delegates and correctional facilities chairpersons and asking for A.A. volunteers to write to A.A. inmates. The list of inmates wishing correspondence on the Institutions Correspondence Service was updated and revised and mailed to "outside" A.A.'s who presently correspond with inmates.

The pamphlet "It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell" was translated into Spanish and is now available.

Updating of the correctional facilities directory is now under way; the 1985-1986 directory will be mailed late in the summer of 1985.

Because communication with the small population of A.A. groups in women's prisons continues to be sparse, the committee wrote to these groups to help keep the channels open. Responses are trickling in, although many groups have yet to be heard from.

The committee revised and updated the two committee documents: Composition, Scope and Procedure, and History and Actions of the Trustees' Committee on Correctional Facilities.

Consistent with a 1984 General Service Conference Advisory Action, the separate *Correctional Facilities Bulletin* has been dis-



continued; and correctional facilities news is now included in a larger, more comprehensive *Box 4-5-9*.

We recommended that the pamphlet "Memo to an Inmate Who May Be an Alcoholic" be rewritten in a simpler style, and that a female story be added or substituted for one of the seven male stories. This recommendation will be brought to the 1985 Conference for approval.

The committee discussed the feasibility of creating a filmstrip based on the pamphlet "It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell," directed toward the inmate. This suggestion will be considered by this committee at the 1985 Conference.

Jim Estelle Jr., chairperson

Staff report: We provide services to 1,552 A.A. groups in correctional facilities (about 47,000 A.A. members), which are also served locally by many of the 365 institutions committees.

The staff member on correctional facilities answers correspondence from inmates, institutions committees, "outside" A.A. sponsors, and correctional facilities professionals, writing about 500 letters a month (6,000 a year). She stays informed of A.A. group and institutional work through correspondence and committee minutes and reports, as well as correctional facilities newsletters prepared by inmates. She prepares correctional facilities A.A. news for publication bimonthly in *Box 4-5-9*.

Each A.A. group in a correctional facility is sent a new Correctional Facilities Group Handbook, which contains Conference-approved pamphlets directed to inmates and the *Directory of A.A. Groups in Correctional Facilities*. Each prison A.A. group also receives the Big Book, other complimentary literature, and *Box 4-5-9*.

Discount packages of A.A. literature (English and Spanish) are also available to "inside" A.A. groups and institutions committees. Grapevines are donated to inmates (75 per month), as well as "damaged" special literature (donated periodically by The A.A. Grapevine).

Before an inmate is released the staff member on this assignment

works with the local institutions committee, central office, A.A. group, and prison sponsors to obtain a prerelease contact.

The Institutions Correspondence Service now has 685 "outside" A.A.'s participating. Despite continuing efforts to interest more female inmates in this service, 96% of the correspondence received from inmates is from male A.A. members.

The films "A.A.—An Inside View," "Bill's Own Story," and "Bill Discusses the Twelve Traditions," and the filmstrip "Circles of Love and Service" are available on loan at no charge to A.A. groups in correctional facilities.

Eileen Gatz

Finance and Budgetary

New treasurer cites Concept XI

Trustees' committee: In 1984, the committee heard reports on G.S.O. and Grapevine operations, reviewed and approved budgets, supervised the administration of the Reserve Fund, and continued to monitor group contributions as to their sufficiency in relation to the cost of servicing our ever-expanding Fellowship.

Concept XI discusses the responsibilities of this committee: "The main responsibility of this body is to see that we do not become money-crippled or go broke. This is the place where money and spirituality *do* have to mix, and in just the right proportion." And: "Future committees, therefore, will ponder the difference between real prudence (which is neither fear nor hoarding and which may indeed require us sometimes to run temporary deficits) and that kind of persistent recklessness which could someday result in the severe contraction or collapse of our vital services." ("Twelve Concepts for World Service," 1981-1982 ed., pp. 50, 51.)

We will continue to work within the framework of Concept XI as it relates to this committee. As your new treasurer, I look forward to serving you for many Conferences to come. I would be glad to receive any input; letters are always welcome. (*See also presentations, pages 16-17.*)

Robert P. Morse, treasurer

General sharing session

Rotation; our past and future; a new format

Trustees' report: The topic for July was "The Spiritual and Practical Aspects of Rotation." Two fine presentations were delivered. In the discussion that followed, it was generally agreed that rotation is spiritual in intent and can be a joyful experience. It is anonymity in action. It prevents individuals from getting attached to service jobs, and it allows freedom and encourages humility. It was felt that rotation is a learning experience and gives the opportunity for a wider view. It is a builder of self-esteem and enhances the excitement of a new job. It helps new people assume responsibility through service; it also prevents too large a personal investment in A.A. and allows for development of the whole person. Much spiritual growth occurs just after rotation as

we turn to the Higher Power to help us handle the emptiness we experience. Rotation is the heart and life of the Fellowship; it allows us to turn things over to a Higher Power.

Rotation at the board and Conference level is essential because the board and Conference serve as an example to all other levels of the service structure. At G.S.O. rotation arose from practical need and later revealed its spiritual benefits. Here we operate a large and viable business, and in some cases rotation does not produce the most economical result. It was felt by some that rotation could be reexamined at some areas of staff responsibility.

"A.A.'s 50th Anniversary: Where Have We Come From—Where Are We Going?" was the topic of the October sharing session. Two provocative and informative presentations were given by Bob Pearson and John Bragg, the outgoing and incoming G.S.O. general managers, respectively. In the discussion that followed, many members marveled about how secure they felt about A.A.'s future. A trustee emeritus pointed out that A.A. has grown from a malignant anarchy to a benign anarchy to accepting our own group conscience. Finally, it was noted that the fact that A.A. has survived 50 years indicates we have a good chance for 50 years ahead. A.A. has a self-correcting mechanism. Our suffering is our strength.

A new format for the General Sharing Session was used in February 1985 in response to the Ad Hoc Committee's recommendation that in-depth reports be given by each of the board's committees in order for the full board to better understand the recommendations they approve on Monday morning of board weekend. Excellent reports were given by the trustees' Nominating, Literature, and P.I. Committees; and a healthy discussion followed:

William E. Flynn, M.D., chairperson

Group services coordinator

Variety of service material is available

Staff report: The primary responsibility of the group services coordinator is to provide communications services to the Fellowship as a whole, supervising production of all service material, updating the 14 A.A. Guidelines, and production of the five Group Handbooks (English, Spanish, French, Correctional Facilities, and Treatment Facilities).

New groups in the U.S. and Canada receive a Group Handbook, a G.S.R. Kit, and a complimentary supply of literature. They also receive *Box 4-5-9* bimonthly and the appropriate regional A.A. directory when issued. It is G.S.O.'s intention to provide services to all A.A. groups within the U.S./Canada service structure which are as nearly identical as possible. We list more than 1,000 French-speaking and 450 Spanish-speaking groups; and the Group Handbook, the G.S.R. Kit, and *Box 4-5-9* are available in these languages.

G.S.O. keeps a storehouse of service material, available to A.A. members upon request. Most service material is not listed on the order form because it is complimentary. Service material does not have the Conference-approved seal as it does not go through the various committee procedures required. It is produced when G.S.O. correspondence indicates there is a need for readily avail-

able information on a specific subject. Service pieces are prepared from files containing A.A. group experience or from sharing specifically requested by a questionnaire. Service material is constantly revised according to Fellowship needs.

Additional responsibilities of this coordinator include the updating of all order forms and literature kits as well as working with the other supporting departments in the preparation of the five A.A. directories. Periodically, the group services coordinator conducts a G.S.O. staff service meeting in which the service assignment of each staff member is discussed and suggestions for improvement and/or change are offered.

Helen Turnquest

International/World Service Meeting

Booklet on W.S.M. history proposed

Trustees' committee:

International—This committee is a focal point for information about A.A. around the world. We try to help A.A. growth in countries where it is just getting started.

In October 1984, this committee served as host to delegates to the Eighth World Service Meeting, who were invited to stay three extra days as guests of our General Service Board. We planned an evening of sharing for W.S.M. delegates, General Service Board members, Grapevine and A.A.W.S. directors, and G.S.O. staff members. The total experience was delightful!

As a result of the Eighth World Service Meeting, this committee made the following recommendations for future World Service Meetings:

- 1 That a similar sharing session (W.S.M. delegates and trustees of the General Service Board, U.S./Canada) be held at the Tenth World Service Meeting in New York.
- 2 That a Delegates Only Meeting be put on the agenda of the Ninth World Service Meeting, which will be held in Guatemala in 1986.
- 3 That the Composition, Scope, and Procedure of the Nominating Committee and method of appointing Class A trustees be sent to all participating delegates of the Eighth World Service Meeting, to be shared with their respective general service boards (implemented, 1985).

We discussed the following W.S.M. recommendation from the Literature/Publishing Committee and forwarded it to A.A.W.S. for implementation: "that A.A.W.S. prepare a booklet briefly

The "has-been" table

Harold Green (A.A.W.S. director) had a delightful experience at lunch on Tuesday. He happened to sit at a table with five rotating trustees—Michael Alexander, David Aronofsky, Buck Bruner, Joe Kraus, and Jackie Solomon. About to "move on," these trusted servants gave full vent to their nostalgia about "the way we were," bringing many "golden moments" to others at the table.

highlighting the purpose and history of the World Service Meeting and including recommendations from 1969 to the present. Recommendations will be updated as practicable, and information about interim meetings will also be included."

We reviewed and accepted a Composition, Scope, and Procedure, and we updated the History and Actions of this committee.

At present, we are working on coverage of the overseas booth at the 1985 International Convention in Montreal. We are also reviewing foreign literature available from G.S.O., U.S. and Canada, and other G.S.O.'s in order to make more basic pamphlets available to those writing for help who speak foreign languages.

David Aronofsky, chairperson

Staff report:

Overseas—The staff member on this assignment corresponds with 31 G.S.O.'s and literature distribution centers outside the U.S. and Canada in Argentina, Australia, Belgium (French-speaking), Belgium (Flemish-speaking), Brazil, Colombia, Costa Rica, Dominican Republic, El Salvador, Finland, France, Great Britain, Guatemala, Honduras, Iceland, Ireland, Italy, Japan, Mexico, Netherlands, New Zealand, Nicaragua, Norway, Paraguay, South Africa, Spain, Sweden, Switzerland, Uruguay, Venezuela, and West Germany.

When letters are received from groups and individuals in those countries, they are encouraged to correspond with their own G.S.O.'s. If an overseas G.S.O. then needs a more detailed sharing of experience, it contacts G.S.O., U.S./Canada. For countries having their own G.S.O.'s, we list only English-speaking groups and contacts, intergroups/central offices, and Loners. Travelers are encouraged to contact those offices for up-to-date meeting information. G.S.O., U.S./Canada, is grateful for up-to-date information about A.A. in other countries. All traveling A.A.'s are asked to share their experience with A.A. in foreign lands with this office. We distributed 10,000 copies of the *International A.A. Directory* for overseas travelers and groups in 1984.

Correspondence from countries where there is no service center or office is answered by the staff member on this assignment. We work closely with such countries to help them establish A.A. structures. Guidelines for this purpose are available. Correspondence that comes to us in a foreign language is translated, and a response is sent in the same language. We have translators (A.A. members) for 30 different languages; translators (A.A. members) are needed for Persian, Russian, Greek, Hungarian, and Arabic. Our Spanish services coordinator works closely with the overseas staff member and helps with correspondence.

To protect A.A.'s copyright, careful consideration is given to granting overseas boards and centers permission to print A.A. Conference-approved literature. A request should come from the board; and before any printing begins, G.S.O. first explores the way the material will be financed and distributed. The request for permission to print or reprint is then presented to A.A.W.S.

Here are some recent highlights about A.A. overseas:

- **Poland**—Thirty-nine A.A. groups now exist in Poland, with an intergroup in Warsaw, a national board, and a translations litera-

ture committee (which submits books and pamphlets for carrying the A.A. message in Poland). A manuscript for the "Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions" in Polish has been received and is being checked, edited, and revised.

- **Denmark**—The "Twelve and Twelve" in Danish is being distributed, and work is progressing on the Big Book translation.

- **Hungary**—A clergyman and a lawyer, both non-A.A., are working with alcoholics and want to start A.A. in Hungary.

- **Israel**—A Hebrew translation of the Big Book and a service structure are being worked on.

- **Interim Zonal Meetings**—Susan Daly, G.S.O. staff, attended the Third European Service Meeting in Frankfurt am Main, West Germany, in March 1985. A Spanish-speaking staff member will attend the Fourth Ibero-American Service Meeting in Uruguay. We found phenomenal A.A. growth in Europe and Latin America. We are seeing, beyond any doubt, that countries can sponsor countries into service, and that the World Service Meetings and the interim zonal meetings are extremely effective in contributing to A.A. growth worldwide—where there is structure, there is growth.

World Service Meeting—This report was given as a presentation (see page 14).

Susan Daly

International Convention/A.A. Regional Forums

Growing interest in Forums

Trustees committees:

International Convention—This report was given as a presentation (see page 12).

Regional Forums—Since 1975, a total of 39 Forums have been held. Four regions have hosted Forums within the past year, and one special Forum was held for Hawaii. Our committee discussed each Forum and found that they continue to be well received by service workers and to improve communication within our Fellowship.

How well are Forums working? Very well, according to results of a new questionnaire, conducted at two 1984 Forums. Attendance ranged from 270 to over 600; and 70 to 75% of registrants were attending their first Forum.

In response to local interest in the Concepts, workshops and presentations were held at some Forums, which were well attended and received.

The committee discussed whether simultaneous translation should be provided at each Eastern Canada Regional Forum. We felt that this matter should be brought up between the staff member on the Regional Forum assignment and the regional trustee to make a determination, and that it should not be presented to this committee each time for approval.

Much correspondence was shared with this committee on the rotation of the Forum for the West Central Region and the unhap-

piness it has caused some members. We recommended that in order to be fair to as many as possible, rotation should become a part of site selection for Regional Forums.

The *Box 4-5-9* calendar keeps the Fellowship informed of Regional Forums. Here is the schedule for future Forums:

1985		
May 3-5	East Central	Green Bay, Wis.
September 13-15	West Central	Sheridan, Wyo.
December 6-8	Southwest	Dallas, Tex.
1986		
May	Western Canada	Saskatchewan
July	Pacific	(tentative)
September	Eastern Canada	Nova Scotia or W. Ontario
December	Southeast	Montgomery, Ala.

Kenneth Dunphy, chairperson

Staff reports:

International Convention—Our theme for A.A.'s 50th-Birthday Party, to be held in Montreal, Quebec, July 4-7, 1985, is "50 Years With Gratitude." A.A.'s from over 30 countries will gather in Montreal to celebrate the birth of our Fellowship; and A.A.'s all over the world will be celebrating in their own home groups.

The opening, or get-together dance, will take place Thursday night at the Montreal Convention Centre; a disco dance will be held simultaneously at the Palladium (two Metro stops away). Both the English- and French-Language Marathon Meetings will begin at midnight at the Hyatt Regency Hotel and run through 8:00 a.m. on Sunday morning.

The Montreal Convention Centre will serve as the hub for our daytime activities; most panels and workshops will be held there. Special-interest meetings, alkathons, and A.A. films will be held in nearby hotels. The flag ceremony and Big Meeting (Friday night), professional entertainment (Saturday night), and the Spiritual Meeting (Sunday morning) will be held at the Olympic Park Stadium.

An International A.A. "fun run" will start at the Hyatt Regency Hotel at 6:30 a.m. on Sunday morning. The route will be three miles long, extending through city streets, down to the St. Lawrence River, and back again.

The International Convention assignment involves working on the Convention with four committees: trustees', Conference, Host, and G.S.O. Planning. The staff secretary coordinates and serves as secretary to these four committees. She is also the liaison to the AI-Anon Planning Committee.

Sarah Price

Regional Forums—This assignment involves organizing all plans for Regional Forums, working with regional trustees, delegates, host-city contacts, and G.S.O. general manager. Preparations usually begin about four months prior to a Forum, although initial arrangements are made with the host-city contact and hotel selected immediately following the Conference (where this information is learned).

All regions have hosted four Regional Forums, and we are now on our fifth round. Since the board supports four Forums per year and there are eight regions for the U.S. and Canada, each region can host a Forum every two years. Where a Forum is to be held is decided by the regions' delegates at the Conference.

The Regional Forum coordinator schedules all mailings to delegates (requesting agenda suggestions), service people, past delegates, and past trustees; prepares the agenda; makes hotel and travel arrangements for trustees and staff; makes arrangements with the hotel and the host-city contact; and is responsible for display boards of literature and service material. Reports of Forums are sent to all attendees, trustees, and present delegates.

Helen Turnquest

Internationalists, Loners, LIMs

'The largest A.A. group in the world'

Staff report: "I'm an alcoholic—I was a drunk. Another voyage ends. Welcome back S.S. LIM, and a salute to Home Port 459." For this Internationalist member of our worldwide correspondence group, the Loners-Internationalists Group, the *L.I.M.* provides an A.A. meeting, as it does for hundreds of A.A.'s living in isolated areas (Loners) with no A.A. groups or contacts. Other participants are housebound A.A.'s (Homers) and many active A.A.'s who serve as informal Loner Sponsors.

About 2,500 A.A.'s participate in this meeting by mail—it might be called the largest A.A. group in the world. A.A.'s international growth can be attributed largely to Loners in distant lands and Internationalists who sail the seven seas, carrying the A.A. message wherever they are.

A literature package is sent to each new Loner, Homer, or Internationalist. They also receive lists of Loners and Internationalists, along with the bimonthly bulletins *Box 4-5-9* and *Loners-Internationalists Meeting (L.I.M.)*, a discussion meeting in print which shares excerpts of letters received at G.S.O.

There are now over 600 Internationalists and Port Contacts; 67 Internationalists groups meet aboard ships or in ports. About 500 Loners and Homers join with them and stay sober reading A.A. literature and sharing A.A. experience, strength, and hope with Loner Sponsors around the world through letters and tapes.

Phyllis Masback

Literature

Important new literature in 1984

Trustees committee: Since the 1984 Conference, we have reviewed the following projects.

Projects Completed—Following Conference approval, the following items became available in 1984: "Pass It On" (biography of Bill Wilson); "The A.A. Member—Medications and Other Drugs" (replaces the pamphlet "A.A. Member and Drug Abuse"); and "Your G.S.O. Today" (filmstrip; replaces "P.O. Box 459").

In accordance with a 1984 Conference recommendation, we reviewed the pamphlet "The A.A. Group" with an eye toward underscoring the importance of an informed group conscience. We accepted our subcommittee's report that this subject is covered adequately, and also that the pamphlet is as helpful to small groups as it is to larger ones.

We forwarded to the Conference Literature Committee the following items for consideration: a suggestion to produce cassettes of "A.A. Comes of Age"; a suggestion to add a reference to the Big Book in all recovery literature and in other literature where appropriate; and a condensed version of the "Twelve Concepts."

We regret that we have been unable to complete the "Twelve Concepts Illustrated" because the artist is unable to proceed; we are open to artwork from other sources.

Projects in Progress—"A.A. for the Woman": Our subcommittee is continuing its review of this pamphlet. "A.A. and the Armed Services": At the request of A.A.'s in the Armed Services, we are looking for stories of military dependents for possible inclusion in this pamphlet. Pamphlets for young people: A subcommittee appointed to review the pamphlets "Too Young?" and "Young People and A.A." is contacting students, educators, and the International Advisory Council of Young People in A.A. for suggestions.

This committee has also developed its Composition, Scope, and Procedure; an in-depth report of our concerns and activities was submitted to the board during the February 1985 General Sharing Session.

Helen Harmon, chairperson

Staff report: The literature assignment involves coordinating all phases of copy preparation, editorial supervision, production, and distribution of A.A.'s publications and audiovisual materials. It is crucial that the literature coordinator work closely with other staff members, especially with the group services coordinator, on all service material.

We distribute *Box 4-5-9* (in English and Spanish) and six other periodical bulletins, with a combined circulation of over 100,000 copies, as follows:

	Mailing list	Issues per year
<i>Box 4-5-9</i> (English)	56,582	6
<i>Box 4-5-9</i> (French)	3,400	6
<i>Box 4-5-9</i> (Spanish)	10,521	6
<i>Loners-Internationalist Meeting (L.I.M.)</i>	3,718	6
<i>P.I.-C.P.C. Bulletin</i>	4,162	3
<i>Correctional Facilities Bulletin</i>	7,285	3
<i>Quarterly Report¹</i>	5,184	3
<i>About A.A.</i>	17,224	3
<i>Treatment Facilities Bulletin</i>	5,232	2
	113,308	38

All bulletins, except *L.I.M.*, are translated into French and printed by the French Literature Service in Montreal, Quebec, in cooperation with G.S.O.

¹ *The Final Conference Report* takes the place of the fourth issue.

The literature coordinator works closely with editors on updating and revising all pamphlets and with writers, artists, editors, and printers on the preparation of new pamphlets, books, displays, leaflets, and service materials, including films and filmstrips. She also serves as editor of *Box 4-5-9*.

Correspondence from A.A. groups and individuals requesting specific information about our literature comes to the literature desk. A letter is sent semiannually to all central offices, intergroups, and literature distribution centers to inform them of new developments in A.A. literature and other service material.

Vincina McCarthy

Nominating

Four-year term for Class B trustees regardless of when vacancies occur

Trustees' committee: The 1984 Conference Committee on Trustees agreed in principle with the trustees' Nominating Committee that all Class B trustees be elected for a four-year term regardless of when vacancies occur. Because this would represent a substantive change in policy, the Conference Committee on Trustees recommended that this committee conduct a survey of trustees and delegates and provide the results to the 1985 Conference Committee on Trustees. The survey was conducted: 40 responses favored the suggested change; and four opposed any change. The Conference Committee on Trustees will present its recommendation to the 1985 General Service Conference for final action.

We reviewed and approved letters, procedures, and résumé forms for election of candidates for Southeast and East Central regional trustees and for trustee-at-large/U.S. We also reviewed and approved as eligible for election candidates for East Central and Southeast U.S. regional trustees and for trustee-at-large/U.S.

We reviewed the procedures for election of Class A trustees and discussed at length the importance of a diligent painstaking search for all new Class A trustees.

After reviewing the draft of the proposed Composition, Scope, and Procedures for the committee, we recommended several changes to more accurately reflect Ad Hoc Committee recommendations on responsibilities of the Nominating Committee as set forth in the Twelve Concepts. An acceptable document has been prepared. The Committee reviewed and accepted the revised History and Actions of the Nominating Committee.

We recommended the nomination of James Shannon to serve as general service trustee (Class B) on the Grapevine Corporate Board; and of Shepherd Raimi to serve as general service trustee (Class B) on the A.A.W.S. Board.

We reviewed and recommended the following slate of trustees for election at the annual meeting of the members of the General Service Board in April, following presentation at the 1985 General Service Conference for their disapproval, if any:

Class A

W.J. (Jim) Estelle Jr.
William E. Flynn, M.D.
Joan K. Jackson, Ph.D.

Robert P. Morse
Gordon M. Patrick
Kenneth H. Williams, M.D.

Class B

Dan Byrne
Kenneth Dunphy
John Ford
Helen Harmon
Thomas Jasper Jr.
Wayne Parks

Shepherd Raimi
Ralph Rosenberg Jr.
Natalie Schwanke
James Shannon
Garrett Taylor

(To be selected 4/20/85)
One regional trustee—East Central U.S.
One regional trustee—Southeast U.S.
One trustee-at-large/U.S.

The committee recommended the following slate of officers of the General Service Board:

Chairperson
First vice-chairperson
Second vice-chairperson
Secretary
Treasurer
Assistant treasurer
Assistant secretary

Gordon Patrick
W.J. (Jim) Estelle Jr.
Kenneth H. Williams, M.D.
Natalie Schwanke
Robert P. Morse
Dennis Manders
Betty Liddle (to be replaced at rotation, 9/85)

The committee reviewed and recommended that the following directors of A.A. World Services, Inc., be presented to the 1985 General Service Conference:

John Bragg
William Croke
Jack Ford
Harold Greene
Thomas Jasper Jr.

Betty Liddle (to be replaced at rotation, 9/85)
Wayne Parks
Shepherd Raimi
Joseph E. Rhoads

The committee reviewed and recommended the following directors of The A.A. Grapevine, Inc., be presented to the 1985 General Service Conference:

Norm Adams
Dan Byrne
William E. Flynn, M.D.
Retha Gresham
Helen Harmon

Ralph Rosenberg Jr.
James Shannon
Stanley Silverman
Desmond Towey
Ann Warner

We recommended the following amendment to a recommendation made by this committee at its January 1984 meeting: When a Class B regional or at-large trustee vacancy occurs on either the A.A.W.S. or Grapevine Board, this committee should nominate a successor. This candidate should be a Class B regional or at-large trustee who can serve for two years and who has not previously served on either board.

The committee recommended that Jack Ford serve on the A.A.W.S. Board, replacing Natalie Schwanke; and that Helen Harmon and Dan Byrne serve on the Grapevine Corporate Board, replacing David Aronofsky and Ken Dunphy, respectively.

Joe Kraus, chairperson

Public Information

P.I. activity spotlights A.A.'s 50th birthday

Trustees' committee: The following projects have been completed:

- A press release on the Eighth World Service Meeting, held in October 1984, was mailed in August to wire services, major media outlets in the top ten markets, large-circulation dailies in the Northeast U.S., and all countries participating in the Meeting.
- A press release on the results of the 1983 membership survey was mailed to major dailies with a circulation over 50,000.
- The old anonymity memo was rephrased to more specifically address TV; it was sent to major dailies (circulation over 50,000) and P.I. committees, central and intergroup offices, and delegates during December 1984.
- The new Preamble 60-second public service announcement has been completed and added to the 3/4" video cassette of the combined P.S.A.
- "The A.A. Member" flyer, poster, and tabletop display were updated to reflect the 1983 membership survey results.
- A new press kit commemorating A.A.'s 50th anniversary was sent to all P.I. committee chairpersons, central and intergroup offices, and delegates. The kit includes several new projects.

The following projects are in progress:

- The new radio P.S.A.'s for young people recommended by the 1983 General Service Conference have been completed and await Conference approval.
- A new press feature story about young people in A.A. will be released soon.

Ralph Rosenberg Jr., chairperson



Staff report: Three individuals answer the P.I. correspondence at G.S.O.: the staff member and two other devoted employees. During 1984, we answered over 10,800 requests for information about A.A. from students, doctors, nurses, family members, clergy, and the public media. We also provided literature for 300 health fairs. We processed about 7,600 newspaper and magazines stories about A.A. and wrote letters of gratitude monthly to over 50 publications for good articles about our Fellowship. Each week, we followed up on approximately 23 anonymity breaks and sent about 20 letters of thanks for good P.I. committee work done by local A.A.'s. We reviewed 165 TV clips and wrote approximately 30 letters of thanks to TV stations.

There are 750 P.I. committees listed at G.S.O., as well as 700 P.I. contacts. Committee members listed here receive the bimonthly bulletin *Box 4-5-9* plus an assortment of P.I. service material. All committee chairpersons receive the P.I. Workbook (1,200 were sent this year); additional workbooks can be obtained for \$7.

For P.I. committees interested in sharing information about A.A. with the local media, 12 press feature stories are available. A Literature Display Container, designed to be placed in professional offices, is available for \$1.50 (the container contains 100 copies of "A.A. at a Glance"). During 1984, over 762,000 copies of "A.A. at a Glance" and 454,000 copies of "A Message to Teenagers" were sent to local P.I. committees, alcoholism agencies, and central and intergroup offices for use at non-A.A. meetings.

In 1984 we distributed 300 radio P.S.A.'s and 265 TV P.S.A.'s through local committees. Videos of "Alcoholics Anonymous—An Inside View" and the combined P.S.A.'s, including the new preamble spot, were sent to over 30 networks, local TV stations, and TV production companies for inclusion in programs about alcoholism and/or commemoration of A.A.'s 50th anniversary.

Other projects included: Information about Bill W. on the CBS show "An American Portrait"; continuing work on the two-hour film about Bill W. for NBC prime time; and several projects by the press commemorating A.A.'s 50th anniversary (including articles in the *Village Voice* and *Parade Magazine* and several stories by the Associated Press).



Serving on the P.I. assignment this past year has been an exciting experience. The cooperation and respect from the press continues to amaze us, and we know that many newcomers will find their way to A.A. as a direct result of these efforts. We are ever grateful to the communications media for their part in carrying the message to the alcoholic who still suffers.

Lyla Bonney Hogg

Spanish services coordinator

G.S.O.'s liaison to the Hispanic community

Staff report: The overall objective of this assignment (created in 1984) is to assist the G.S.O. staff in providing services to the Hispanic A.A. community which are as equal as possible to the services provided to English-speaking A.A. groups. The Spanish services coordinator acts as liaison between G.S.O. and the Spanish-speaking A.A. community.

The staff member on this assignment is a nonrotating, bilingual A.A. member. He corresponds with A.A.'s who write to G.S.O. in Spanish (this correspondence has almost doubled during the past year); greets Spanish-speaking visitors to G.S.O.; and translates literature (service material, pamphlets, and *Box 4-5-9*). He also attends many Spanish-speaking events; assists with interpreting at the World Service Meeting; and participates in Regional Forums which have two workshops conducted in Spanish.

Vicente Mejia

Staff coordinator

Area visits benefit staff members

Staff report: One of the important responsibilities of the 12 G.S.O. staff members is to answer correspondence. In 1984 more than 20,000 letters were answered. Staff members have specific assignments, some of which involve the preparation of special service bulletins; and most staff members also correspond with the A.A. groups in a given region of the U.S., Canada, or the rest of the world. The work is divided as follows:

Conference

Secretary, trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference and Conference Agenda Committee; Early Bird *Box 4-5-9*; Final Conference Report

Cooperation with the Professional Community

Secretary, trustees' and Conference Committees on Cooperation With the Professional Community; *About A.A.*; *Box 4-5-9* (editorial consultant for C.P.C. page)

Correctional Facilities

Secretary, trustees' and Conference Committees on Correctional Facilities; *Box 4-5-9* (editorial consultant for Correctional Facilities page)

Group Services Coordinator, Regional Forums

Supervision of service materials and Guidelines; A.A. directories; co-secretary, trustees' Committee on International Convention/A.A. Regional Forums; secretary, Conference Report and Charter Committee

International Convention	Co-secretary, trustees' Committee on International Convention/A.A. Regional Forums; coordinator for all activities concerning 50th Anniversary Convention in Montreal
Literature Coordinator	Secretary, trustees' and Conference Literature Committees; production and distribution of six G.S.O. bulletins, including Spanish <i>Box 4-5-9</i> ; coordination of French <i>Box 4-5-9</i> ; preparation of filmstrips; updating of old pamphlets and books; preparation of new pamphlets and books; film preparation and distribution; editor, <i>Box 4-5-9</i> ; assistant coordinator, International Convention
Loners, Internationalists	<i>Loners-Internationalists Meeting</i> ; secretary, trustees' Nominating Committee and Conference Committee on Trustees
Overseas, World Service Meeting	Secretary, trustees' International Committee; secretary, World Service Meeting; <i>World Service Meeting Report</i>
Public Information	Secretary, trustees' and Conference Public Information Committees; <i>Box 4-5-9</i> (editorial consultant for P.I. page)
Staff Coordinator	Assistant secretary, General Service Board; secretary, trustees' General Sharing Session; secretary, Committee on Conference Policy/Admissions; director, A.A.W.S.; <i>Quarterly Report</i>
Treatment Facilities	Secretary, trustees' and Conference Committees on Treatment Facilities; <i>Treatment Facilities Bulletin</i>

Staff meetings are held weekly to keep the staff informed and provide a forum for discussion of problems that need some direction from the group conscience. Another aspect of our work is the invitations received from the areas for A.A. get-togethers. On these trips, we are able to learn about local service activities and problems, which helps us to be a better service office. Additionally, over the past year, we have greeted about 1,500 visitors from around the world who have toured G.S.O.

The staff coordinator coordinates all staff activities, chairs the weekly staff meeting, makes sure mail is answered without interruption during vacations, sickness, or absences, and also serves as the liaison between the staff and other departments.

Betty Liddle

No complaints, please!

Before the Conference adjourned for lunch on Thursday, Lois Fisher (G.S.O. staff) announced that Tony Osnato wanted everyone to know that the dessert served at dinner on the previous evening was "Kiwi fruit," not "green bananas."

Treatment Facilities

New Workbook is prepared

Trustees' committee: The 1984 Conference asked this committee to prepare a draft of the Treatment Facilities Workbook in time for the 1985 General Service Conference. A subcommittee was



formed to prepare a draft of the workbook; it met monthly for three months, and the prepared material was reviewed by this committee at the October and February board meetings. The draft of the workbook reviewed by this committee in February is being presented to the 1985 Conference committee.

The A.A. Guidelines on Correctional and Treatment Facilities were separated and updated as per the 1984 Conference recommendation. The A.A. Guidelines on Treatment Facilities were printed and ready for distribution in October 1984.

Joan K. Jackson, Ph.D.

Staff report: The correspondence over the past year has revealed confusion regarding the two different types of A.A. meetings held in treatment centers, hospitals, and detoxification units; (1) a "regular A.A. group" (fulfills the six-point definition of an A.A. group); and (2) a "treatment facilities meeting" (for patients only, usually conducted by A.A.'s from outside the facility). New form letters explaining the difference between the two types of meetings are now being sent with regular group registration forms and treatment facilities meeting cards.

Three new treatment facilities service items are now available: the Treatment Facilities Meeting Kit (sent as a complementary package to new treatment facilities meetings listed with G.S.O.); the Treatment Facilities Committee Kit (sent to new chairpersons of treatment facilities committees); and the Treatment Facilities Discount Package (valued at \$11.25; available to A.A. members for \$6.50).

In addition to writing the *Treatment Facilities Bulletin*, the staff member on this assignment answers correspondence from A.A.'s and non-A.A.'s requesting information on the Traditions in relation to how A.A. cooperates with treatment facilities.

Cheryl Ann Burke

Reports from the A.A. Grapevine

Sales are on the upswing; third tape available

1984—it was a good year! Total income was \$1,193,000 (an increase of \$72,000 over 1983); net income amounted to \$26,000

Twice a year, we offer a bonus for gift subscriptions. In July, the offer was a "Best of Bill" with each gift subscription for a newcomer. Result: 1,000 newcomer subscriptions. At Christmas, we repeated an offer instituted many years ago; a Serenity Prayer for each Christmas gift subscription. Result: 4,680 Christmas gift subscriptions. The total subscription picture for 1984 was good: As of December 1984, paid circulation was 124,200 (an increase of 600 over December 1983).

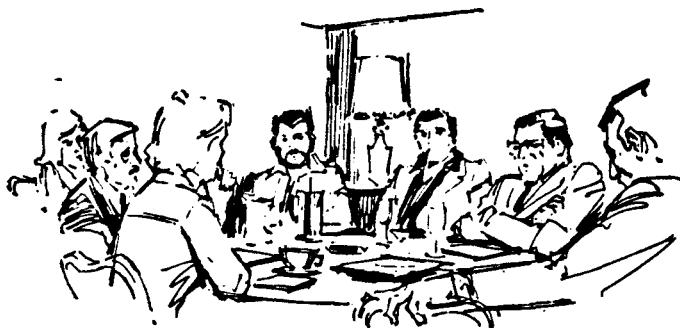
Orders for Grapevine special items continued to flow at a somewhat steady pace. Income from Wall Calendars and Pocket Planners came to \$76,430, an increase of \$8,380 over 1983. Sales of the first two Grapevine tapes amounted to \$62,000. And total sales for special items over all were up a solid \$26,000 compared with 1983.

This being the year of A.A.'s 50th anniversary and also the International Convention in Montreal, the work and concentration of the Grapevine's editorial and art staff have been divided more than usual. One of these projects is the mammoth and magnificent undertaking entitled "Best of the Grapevine" (a 288-page hardcover volume of a carefully studied selection of 40 years of Grapevine articles and artwork). Distributed at this Conference are the first copies of a new Grapevine tape (the third), comprised of readings of Grapevine articles which emphasize A.A. basics.

During 1984, more than 2,000 articles, letters, and jokes were submitted to the magazine for consideration from nearly all the U.S. and Canadian provinces and from about 20 foreign countries. Of the 334 articles and items actually printed in the Grapevine during 1984, 301 came from 47 states, 16 from seven Canadian provinces, and 17 from 14 foreign countries. Today the Grapevine reaches over one-third of the total A.A. population. It is in this fact (rather than dollars and cents) that the significance, well-being, and vitality of the Grapevine can be seen.

Ralph Rosenberg Jr., chairperson

Staff report: The Grapevine staff consists of four A.A.'s and two non-A.A.'s, with a supporting "crew" of 15 who take care of copy editing, the GvR program, circulation, bookkeeping, and mailing/shipping. (A.A. members on the staff, unlike A.A.'s at G.S.O., do not rotate because of the specialized nature of their jobs.)



As managing editor, I have overall responsibility for the operation; I oversee the office and serve as president of the corporation and thus as a member of the Corporate Board. Since the 1984 Conference, I have spent much time in direct communication with the Fellowship through attending A.A. events and working with the GvR network.

Ann Warner, editor of the magazine, evaluates manuscripts, selects the content of each issue, corresponds with writers, and makes sure that a new issue appears every month. For copy editing, she relies heavily on Janet Graves, who works part-time and is largely responsible for the praise the magazine has earned over the years for its near-perfect editorial quality.

Art editor Gene Austin has charge of the appearance of the magazine (layout and design, and cover and article illustrations). Gene's first year on staff (he joined us in April 1984) has been busy with special projects, such as "Best of the Grapevine."

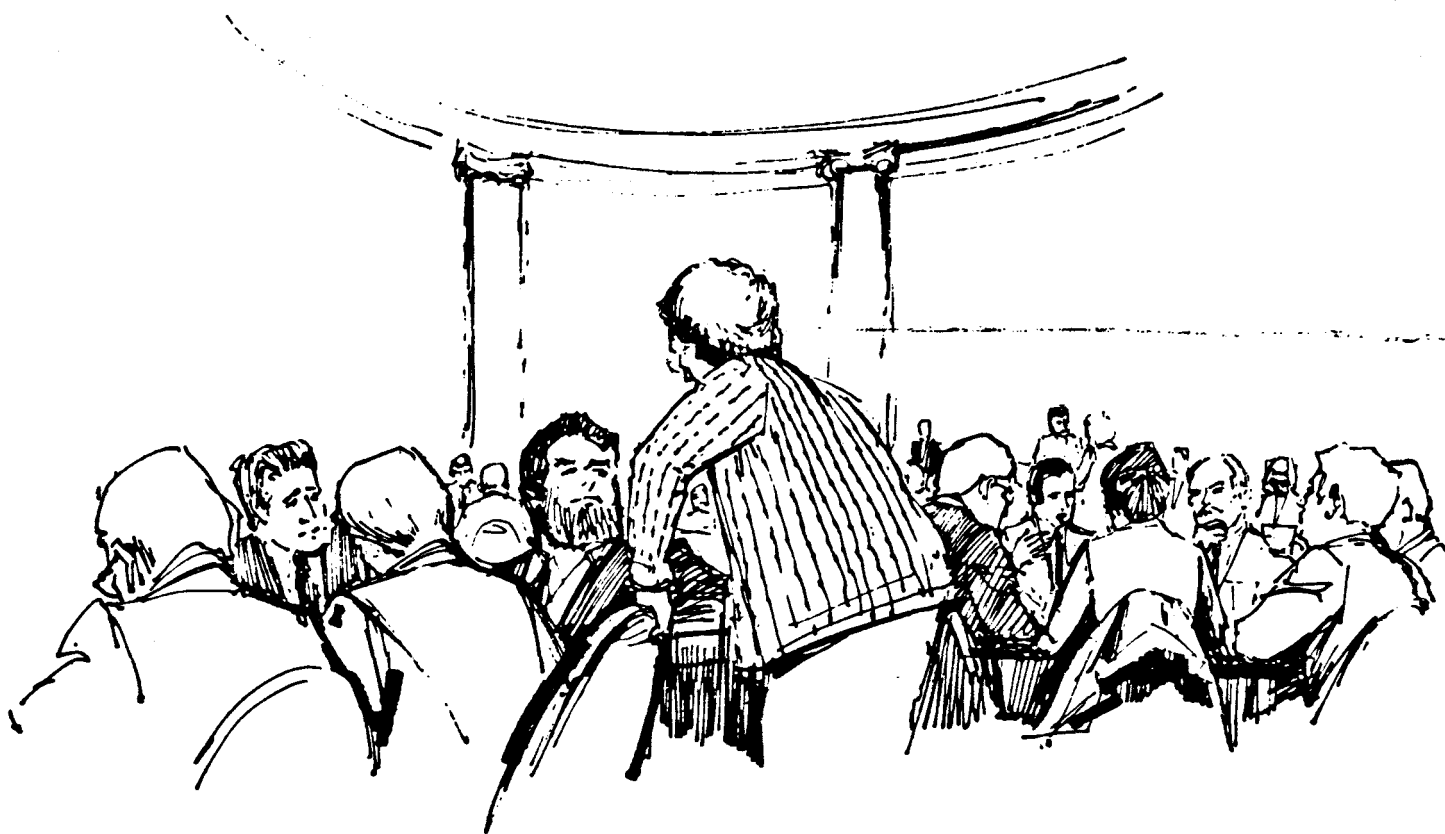
The newest member of our staff is Grace Hedderman, who joined us in February 1985 as circulation manager. Grace steps into a circulation department that is in a state of flux—key personnel have left recently, and the transition to an in-house operation is about to be completed. She works with the controller and an outside consultant to develop new procedures and ensure a smooth operation.

Our current team has the enthusiasm, dedication, and energy necessary to fulfill our obligation of service to the Fellowship. (See also *A.A. Grapevine presentations*, pages 14-17.)

Retha Gresham, managing editor

Grapevine circulation—geographic breakdown

U.S.	Circulation		Increase/ decrease
	4/84	4/85	
Alabama	986	1,049	+ 63
Alaska	453	473	+ 20
Arizona	1,299	1,323	+ 24
Arkansas	658	675	+ 17
California	11,830	11,061	- 769
Colorado	1,370	1,528	+ 158
Connecticut	2,081	1,980	- 101
Delaware	337	327	- 10
District of Columbia	331	300	- 31
Florida	4,808	5,188	+ 380
Georgia	2,187	2,249	+ 62
Hawaii	337	366	+ 29
Idaho	572	609	+ 37
Illinois	5,140	5,092	- 48
Indiana	1,770	1,867	+ 97
Iowa	1,756	1,875	+ 119
Kansas	1,830	1,771	- 59
Kentucky	907	1,014	+ 107
Louisiana	1,370	1,465	+ 95
Maine	704	754	+ 50
Maryland	2,054	2,186	+ 132
Massachusetts	3,949	4,142	+ 193
Michigan	3,174	3,125	- 49
Minnesota	4,907	4,785	- 122
Mississippi	794	822	+ 28
Missouri	2,120	2,182	+ 62
Montana	780	808	+ 28
Nebraska	1,872	1,884	+ 12
Nevada	372	475	+ 103



U.S.	Circulation		Increase/ decrease
	4/84	4/85	
New Hampshire	835	812	- 23
New Jersey	3,107	3,249	+ 142
New Mexico	706	770	+ 64
New York	7,596	7,303	- 293
North Carolina	2,829	3,052	+ 223
North Dakota	812	796	- 16
Ohio	3,492	3,614	+ 122
Oklahoma	1,937	1,946	+ 9
Oregon	1,088	1,108	+ 20
Pennsylvania	3,494	3,674	+ 180
Rhode Island	549	617	+ 68
South Carolina	1,501	1,573	+ 72
South Dakota	682	709	+ 27
Tennessee	1,217	1,244	+ 27
Texas	4,805	5,095	+ 290
Utah	307	319	+ 12
Vermont	563	600	+ 37
Virginia	2,598	2,644	+ 46
Washington	2,870	2,967	+ 97
West Virginia	591	568	- 23
Wisconsin	2,859	2,899	+ 40
Wyoming	390	373	- 17
Puerto Rico	82	84	+ 2
U.S. Possessions	32	10	- 22
	<u>105,690</u>	<u>107,401</u>	<u>+ 1,711</u>

Canada	Circulation		Increase/ decrease
	4/84	4/85	
Alberta	1,556	1,502	- 54
B.C./Yukon	1,901	1,720	- 181
Manitoba	838	882	+ 44
N.B./P.E.I.	621	567	- 54
N.S./Nfld./Lb.	1,075	929	- 146
Ontario	5,380	4,708	- 672
Quebec	450	375	- 75
Saskatchewan	<u>1,391</u>	<u>1,196</u>	<u>- 195</u>
	<u>13,212</u>	<u>11,879</u>	<u>- 1,333</u>
Foreign	<u>2,154</u>	<u>1,421</u>	<u>- 733</u>
Total	<u>121,056</u>	<u>120,701</u>	<u>- 355</u>

Recommendations Emphasize Carrying the Message

The group conscience of the Fellowship in the U.S. and Canada was expressed in the following Advisory (to the Board) Actions, which the General Service Board approved in its legally required annual meeting just after the Conference. In addition to the actions introduced on the floor before the whole Conference, others were based upon the reports of the Conference committees, as indicated in the headings. (Members and officers of the 1985 Conference committees are listed on page 60.)

Floor Actions

It was recommended that:

1 The general manager designate a staff person to coordinate and pull together (at the General Service Office), all available information about spreading the A.A. message to the native North American population, including but not limited to (1) translation of their languages and dialects, (2) experiences of various A.A. groups in their contact with these populations and to explore with a view toward consolidating and expanding A.A.'s experience in these areas; to report back to the 1986 General Service Conference through whatever committee the general manager feels is appropriate.

2 The Treatment Facilities, Correctional Facilities, and Cooperation With the Professional Community Workbooks be translated into Spanish.

Agenda

It was recommended that:

3 At the A.A. meeting following the opening dinner at the 36th General Service Conference, there be a light system on the podium; the chairperson of the Conference Agenda Committee be designated chairperson of the A.A. meeting; and that his or her duties be limited to introducing the leader and monitoring the time of the meeting.

4 In addition to the meeting chairperson, the format of the A.A. meeting following the opening dinner at the 36th General Service Conference remain the same as 1985, consisting of the alternate chairperson of the Conference Agenda Committee as leader to introduce five speakers—one trustee, two delegates, two staff members (one G.S.O. and one Grapevine).

5 For a possible theme for the 36th General Service Conference, the following suggestions be made: (a) "Service: Our Legacy of Life"; (b) "The Third Legacy: Hope for the Future"; (c) "A.A.'s Future: Our Responsibility."

Parks and Pigeons

Wayne Parks (Southwest U.S. regional trustee) traveled to the Conference with his "pigeon," Harlan Petter (Panel 35, Arkansas), and Harlan's wife (delegate to the Al-Anon Conference). On Wednesday afternoon, during the Area Service Highlights, Wayne introduced Harlan as a man who had "given a whole new meaning to the word 'pigeon.'" (It seems Harlan raises and "shows" pigeons!)

6 The following presentation/discussion topics for the 1986 Conference be considered: (a) "The Committee System"—(1) "Do We Trust It?" (2) "Does It Eliminate Conflict?" (b) "Responsibility in Service"—(1) "Why Are You a General Service Representative?" (2) "Why Are You a District Committee Member?" (3) "Why Are You an Area Officer?" (4) "Why Are You a Trustee?" (c) "Trusted Servants"—(1) "Do We Trust Them?" (2) "Ultimate Authority—Are We Listening?" (3) "Are Trusted Servants Informed?" (4) "The Importance of Rotation."

7 The following two workshops be considered for the 36th General Service Conference: (a) "Letting Go of Old Ideas," suggesting that the following be specifically addressed in the workshop questions—(1) "New Ways of Carrying the A.A. Message"; (2) "Are We Getting Too Rigid?"; (b) "A.A.'s Impact on the World," with emphasis on—(1) "Are We Being Friendly With Our Friends?" (2) "How A.A. Cooperates."

Cooperation With the Professional Community

It was recommended that:

8 The following be inserted in the pamphlets "If You Are a Professional" and "How A.A. Members Cooperate": "The only requirement for membership in A.A. is a desire to stop drinking. If the person is not sure about this point, then he or she is most welcome to attend an open A.A. meeting. If the person is sure that drinking is not his or her problem, then he or she may wish to seek help elsewhere."

9 The pamphlet "If You Are a Professional" be revised, and that a draft of the revision of that pamphlet be returned to the 1986 Conference Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community for their consideration.

Correctional Facilities

It was recommended that:

10 The language of the pamphlet "Memo To an Inmate Who May Be an Alcoholic" be rewritten in a simpler style, and that two of the seven male stories be replaced by female stories.

11 There be affirmation of the paramount importance of full compliance with all correctional facilities' rules and regulations by all A.A.'s who carry the message into correctional facilities; A.A. members are "guests" of the facility and subject to all security measures and constraints.

12 The words "and minorities" be deleted from the pamphlet "A.A. in Prisons." Thus the sentence in the pamphlet that now reads "And it keeps overambitious individuals and minorities from ever becoming entrenched in the leadership of a group" would be changed to read "And it keeps overambitious individuals from ever becoming entrenched in the leadership of a group."

13 Preliminary work begin on the creation of a filmstrip based on the thoughts contained in the pamphlet "It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell," directed toward the inmate.

Finance

It was recommended that:

- 14** A guideline on finances be developed by the General Service Office.
- 15** A cartoon treatment be approved illustrating need for greater group participation and how the individual contributions at the group level help carry the message worldwide.

Grapevine

It was recommended that:

- 16** Grapevine committees seek ways to work with Public Information, Cooperation With the Professional Community, Correctional Facilities, Treatment Facilities, and other service committees, with the aim of increasing the use of the Grapevine as a tool in carrying the message.
- 17** Since each issue of the Grapevine cannot go through the Conference-approval process, the Conference recognize The A.A. Grapevine as an international journal of Alcoholics Anonymous.
- 18** A workbook be produced for Grapevine committees.
- 19** Sections be added to the Service Manual defining the role of Grapevine Representatives at all levels, providing more information about the operation of The A.A. Grapevine, Inc., and refer this item to the Report and Charter Committee.

International Convention

It was recommended that:

- 20** For public information purposes, we permit a TV camera to film the flag ceremony from afar at the Olympic Park Stadium.
- 21** Because the Convention questionnaire is not helpful from one Convention to the next, we discontinue its use.

Literature

It was recommended that:

- 22** Preparation of a brochure or pamphlet of a condensed version of the Twelve Concepts be tabled until the 1986 General Service Conference, pending development of the "Twelve Concepts Illustrated."
- 23** As a condensed version of the Twelve Concepts would be especially valuable to service workers, the manuscript be reproduced and distributed by the General Service Office as service material.
- 24** A.A.W.S., Inc., produce cassette tapes of "A.A. Comes of Age."

25 A.A.W.S., Inc., explore the financial feasibility of reproducing the photographs from "A.A. Comes of Age" in a brochure to accompany the cassette album of the same title.

26 There is no need to add reference to the Big Book as our basic recovery source in all pamphlets and other literature.

27 There is no need to develop a pamphlet offering guidelines for A.A. meeting discussions.

28 The previous Conference actions regarding the Fourth and Fifth Step study guides be reaffirmed—i.e., there is no need for Fourth and Fifth Step study guides as existing literature adequately covers these matters.

29 Suggested editorial revisions in "Your A.A. G.S.O." pamphlet be approved: (a) *Archives*—replace the question "When did our group start?" with "When did A.A. start in our area?" (The question "When did our A.A. group start?" is now handled in our Records Department.) (b) *What Can You Do For G.S.O.?*—Under "share your experience" (line three), rewrite "A.A.'s help more alcoholics" to read "A.A.'s carry our message."

Policy/Admissions

It was recommended that:

- 30** No change be made in the Conference Questionnaire at this time.
- 31** The General Service Conference for 1986 be held from April 20 through April 26.
- 32** The Conference Policy Committee routinely review the dates for the General Service Conference to be held two years hence.
- 33** The 1987 General Service Conference be held from April 26 through May 2.
- 34** The decision regarding the South Florida Area invitation to the groups in the Virgin Islands be made by area assemblies involved.
- 35** The 1986 Policy/Admissions Committee study the need for a procedure to include into the service structure new states or provinces, U.S./Canadian territories and islands, etc.

Public Information

It was recommended that:

- 36** The phrase used in the membership surveys, #14—"Were you addicted to any drugs other than alcohol"—be reworded to "Were you addicted to drugs" in support of our singleness of purpose.
- 37** The new TV 30-20-10-second public service announcements be developed for approval at the 1986 General Service Conference as suggested by the trustees' Public Information Committee and requested by the major networks.

38 The phrase "or check your local newspapers" be added to the present ending statement on the radio public service announcements.

39 The request to drop the phrase "A.A.—it works" from all video public service announcements not be approved.

40 The wording in the fourth line, second page, of the flyer "A.A. at a Glance"—"past illness"—be changed to "alcoholism."

41 The new radio public service announcements for young people, as presented by the trustees' Public Information Committee, be approved with the exception of the Danny S. Story.

42 The words "and drugging" in the Kevin P. Story in the radio public service announcement be deleted.

43 The delivery plan for the new young people's public service announcements to preselected radio stations be approved as presented by the trustees' Public Information Committee, which would include notification to the delegates, central offices, and public information committees well in advance of airing.

44 An anonymity reaffirmation be read at the Big Meeting during the International Convention in Montreal.

45 An anonymity letter be sent to *Publishers' Weekly* (the book publishers' magazine) and *Folio* (the magazine publishing magazine) reaffirming A.A.'s position on the anonymity traditions.

46 We reaffirm our anonymity traditions through letters to all general service representatives, articles in the Grapevine, and Box 4-5-9.

47 The idea for a film, filmstrip, videotape or some other such instrument targeting young people be referred to the trustees' Public Information Committee for consideration, and that a report be returned to the Conference Public Information Committee in 1986.

Report and Charter

It was recommended that:

48 The Bylaws of the General Service Board be amended by adding the short form of the Twelve Concepts.

49 "The A.A. Service Manual" contain the original "Twelve Concepts for World Service" as adopted by the 12th General Service Conference on April 26, 1962.

50 Current factual and statistical information—bracketed, foot-noted, asterisked, and otherwise referenced—be checked for accuracy and included at the end of each essay in "Twelve Concepts for World Service."

51 The factual and statistical information in "Twelve Concepts for World Service" may be updated at the end of each essay whenever practical without having to go through the process of Conference action.

52 The Scope of the Conference Report and Charter Committee be amended to include the responsibility for "Twelve Concepts for World Service."

53 The action taken at the 1984 Conference regarding clarification of the portion of the Third Legacy Procedure pertaining to the fourth ballot and after be reaffirmed.

54 There be reaffirmation of the 1984 Conference recommendation regarding the definition of a quorum described in the Conference Charter, which reads: "The committee recommended that the definition of a quorum at the General Service Conference described in the Conference Charter on page 23 of 'The A.A. Service Manual' is adequately defined and should not be changed."

55 References to "nonalcoholic employees" at G.S.O. in "The A.A. Service Manual" be deleted since G.S.O. does not have a policy of hiring only nonalcoholics for the supporting departments.



56 Item 7a, page 50, in the "Suggestions for the Chairperson on Assemblies" section, referring to those eligible to run for delegate, remain as is, which reads "those eligible may be present or past committee members," since the suggestions in the Service Manual are guidelines and each area is autonomous.

57 Option 3, page 40, in the section on "How Do We Elect the D.C.M.?" be changed by deleting the word "immediate" from the phrase "Only immediate past G.S.R.'s are eligible to run. . . ." This option would be revised to read "Only past G.S.R.'s are eligible to run. . . ."

58 There is no need at the present time to add any additional illustrative charts of the service structure to "The A.A. Service Manual."

59 The responsibilities of the World Service Meeting delegates should be included in the Service Manual. The committee further recommended that a draft of these responsibilities be presented to the Report and Charter Committee in 1986 for their consideration.

60 A sentence which reads "Experience is now indicating that many groups are now financially supporting their general service representatives to attend service functions" be added to the last paragraph on page 35 of Chapter II on the General Service Representative in the Service Manual.

61 A sentence which reads "Experience is now indicating that many districts are now financially supporting their district committee members to attend service functions" be added to the end of paragraph 2 on page 41 under the section titled "What Does the D.C.M. Do?" in the Service Manual.

62 A committee from the General Service Office be formed to study Article 2 of the Conference Charter and report its findings to the 1986 Report and Charter Committee.

63 Articles 5 to 8 of the Conference Charter not be changed at the present time.

64 The format of the A.A. directories be changed by having a three-column page without general service representatives' addresses, zip codes, and membership figures.

65 Further discussion should be centered on methods of reaching groups which do not list themselves with the General Service Office, and that this problem be addressed through a presentation at a future General Service Conference.

66 Copy defining the role of Grapevine representatives at all levels and providing more information about the operation of The A.A. Grapevine, Inc., be prepared and presented by the Conference Grapevine Committee to the Report and Charter Committee in 1986 for their consideration.

Treatment Facilities

It was recommended that:

67 The draft of the Treatment Facilities Workbook be approved, with minor changes, for production and distribution.

68 In the Scope of the Conference Treatment Facilities Committee, the sentence "The purpose of the committee will be to encourage A.A. members to assume responsibility to carry the message to alcoholics who cannot, of their own free will, seek A.A. help" be changed to "The purpose of the committee will be to encourage A.A. members to assume responsibility to carry the message to alcoholics in treatment facilities."

Trustees

It was recommended that:

69 The following slate of officers and trustees be elected at the annual meeting of the General Service Board in April 1985 [see pages 44-45; Conference and board approved the slate approved by the trustees' Nominating Committee]: that the following be elected as officers of the General Service Board at its annual meeting [see page 45; slate of officers approved]; that the following be elected as directors of A.A. World Services, Inc. [see page 45; slate of directors approved]; that the following be elected as directors of The A.A. Grapevine, Inc. [see page 45; slate of directors approved].

70 All Class B trustees be elected for a four-year term regardless of when vacancies occur.

71 There be reaffirmation of the 1977 Conference Advisory Action—"Resumes for trustee candidates be sent to G.S.O. by the area delegate as soon as possible after the elections, but no later than January 1. Any résumés received at the G.S.O. after the January 1 deadline will be returned to the delegate in the submitting area."—with certain changes so that it will read—"Résumés for trustee candidates be sent to the General Service Office by the area delegate only, as soon as possible after the elections, but no later than January 1. Any résumés received at the General Service Office after the January 1 deadline will be returned to the delegate in the submitting area and will not be considered by the trustees' Nominating Committee in the current election."

72 The 1976 Advisory Action which reads—"No person be eligible simultaneously as a candidate for both regional trustee and general service trustee—U.S./Canada [changed in 1978 to trustee-at-large, U.S./Canada]"—be changed to read—"No area shall submit an individual as candidate for both regional trustee and trustee-at-large, U.S./Canada, in the same year."

73 A change in wording on the Class B trustee résumé forms from "Date of sobriety" to "Date of last drink" not be made at this time.

New Regional Trustees

On Wednesday afternoon, Conference members voted to recommend the election of the following to the General Service Board: as Southeast U.S. regional trustee, Joe Phelan; as East Central U.S. regional trustee, Jack Whitehouse; as trustee-at-large/U.S., Don Pritts. The three were elected at the April 20th meeting of the board after the close of the Conference.

The General Service Office

INCOME STATEMENT

YEAR ENDED DECEMBER 31, 1984

	1984	1983
INCOME		
Sales of literature	\$5,992,317	\$5,278,576
Less: Discount to A. A. groups	(252,541)	(229,210)
<u>Net Sales</u>	5,739,776	5,049,366
Less: Cost of printing	(1,906,104)	(1,757,042)
Royalties	(746,816)	(645,342)
<u>Gross Profit From Literature</u>	3,086,856	2,646,982
Contributions — A. A. groups and members	2,115,790	1,928,824
Interest income	28,216	18,796
<u>Total Income</u>	5,230,862	4,594,602
EXPENSES		
Salaries	2,003,947	1,769,446
Pension expense	240,677	224,493
Rent	300,647	260,486
Box 4-5-9	89,929	94,810
A. A. Directories	77,943	72,746
Other service materials	194,276	182,712
Shipping and mailing	610,367	572,739
Other office expenses	430,532	344,519
Insurance and payroll taxes	276,019	238,208
Professional services	44,168	30,078
Board, committee, and staff meetings	118,231	104,619
1984 World Service Meeting	69,351	—
Writers' fees	33,944	50,036
P. I. C., C. P. C. C., travel	88,756	63,096
General Service Conference	161,769	144,970
E. D. P. system development, equipment, and maintenance	46,400	54,035
Regional Forums and other expenses	76,780	57,453
Leasehold improvements	5,226	36,099
Filmstrip	15,396	5,242
Foreign literature assistance (net)	(9,748)	36,392
<u>Total Expense</u>	4,874,610	4,342,179
NET INCOME (EXPENSE) FOR YEAR (Exhibit C)	<u>356,252</u>	<u>252,423</u>
NET INCOME (EXPENSE) BY FUNCTION		
Publishing — A. A. World Services, Inc.	\$1,141,934	\$ 776,447
General Fund — General Service Board	(785,682)	(524,024)
CHANGES IN RESERVE FUND		
Balance, January 1	\$3,147,931	\$2,575,504
Transfers: from A. A. W. S.	260,000	220,780
Investment income	440,354	351,647
<u>Balance, December 31</u>	<u>3,848,285</u>	<u>3,147,931</u>

() denotes red figures

The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc.—Notes to Financial Statements, December 31, 1984

Note A — Purposes and Restrictions of Different Funds

The RESERVE FUND was established in 1954 for the purpose of accumulating a prudent operating reserve which, during 1977, was redefined as one year's combined operating expenses of A. A. World Services, Inc., The A. A. Grapevine, Inc., and the General Fund of the A. A. General Service Board. The 1977 General Service Conference also recommended that all investment activities of the operating entities be consolidated into the Reserve Fund. That Advisory Action was approved by the board of trustees and, since that time, all funds of the operating entities, in excess of those required for working capital, have been transferred to the Reserve Fund. Included in such transfers from The A. A. Grapevine, Inc., were amounts held as a deferred liability to subscribers and, therefore, reflected as a liability of the Reserve Fund.

(continued)

The Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.

INCOME STATEMENT

YEAR ENDED DECEMBER 31, 1984

	1984	1983
INCOME — from subscriptions and other sales	<u>\$1,192,978</u>	<u>\$1,121,043</u>
EDITORIAL AND PRINTING		
Salaries, including temporary help	\$156,639	\$143,695
Printing	181,592	164,576
Mailing — service	91,070	89,904
— postage	100,944	103,881
Other production costs	36,125	23,048
Calendar costs	25,299	22,815
Occupancy costs	31,334	27,307
Telephone	1,680	1,478
Office supplies and expenses	4,150	3,922
Other editorial expenses	3,390	2,109
Total	632,223	582,735
CIRCULATION AND BUSINESS		
Salaries, including temporary help	229,421	202,230
Data processing costs	57,251	51,113
Stationery and supplies	7,643	6,295
Occupancy costs	31,334	27,307
Telephone	1,679	1,501
Office expense, including agency fees	13,690	7,125
Selling expense — regular	28,446	39,840
— GvR program	13,971	8,660
Postage	43,449	40,784
Total	426,884	384,855
GENERAL AND ADMINISTRATIVE		
Consultant fees	5,496	5,496
Insurance	24,015	17,973
Professional fees	11,320	11,565
Payroll taxes	29,622	25,729
Meetings and conferences	9,510	7,214
Computer system development, etc.	5,024	43,419
Furniture and equipment	138	1,249
Contribution to Retirement Plan	29,040	26,253
Canadian exchange	1,470	876
Total	115,635	139,774
TOTAL COSTS AND EXPENSES	<u>1,174,742</u>	<u>1,107,364</u>
INCOME (LOSS) FROM OPERATIONS	18,236	13,679
Interest earned	8,451	5,360
NET INCOME (LOSS) FOR YEAR (Exhibit C)	<u>26,687</u>	<u>19,039</u>

() denotes red figures

The GENERAL FUND comprises those assets not included in any of the other funds and may be used for any purposes for which the corporation was formed.

(continued)

The General Service Office and The A.A. Grapevine, Inc. COMBINED BALANCE SHEET

DECEMBER 31, 1984

	December 31, 1984		December 31, 1983	
OPERATING FUNDS	Service Office	A.A. Grapevine	Service Office	A.A. Grapevine
ASSETS				
Cash — checking accounts	\$ 243,486	\$ 37,220	\$ 179,497	\$ 69,753
Short-term cash investments (includes \$402,100 for 1985 convention)	800,821	143,764	416,695	124,813
Investment (Note C)	—	454,138	—	394,138
Accounts receivable	86,852	1,854	73,673	2,534
Due from Grapevine	6,760	—	7,113	—
Inventories	1,196,446	82,632	971,397	69,979
Prepaid expenses	61,188	90,358	105,602	79,614
Total Assets	2,395,553	809,966	1,753,977	740,831
DEDUCT LIABILITIES				
Accounts and accruals payable	540,193	71,400	375,624	57,897
Deferred income	380,755	824,882	—	786,437
Due Reserve Fund	—	—	—	9,500
Total Liabilities	920,948	896,282	375,624	853,834
NET WORTH				
Balance, January 1	1,378,353	(113,003)	1,346,710	(132,042)
Net income (loss) (Exhibits A and B)	356,252	26,687	252,423	19,039
Transfer to Reserve Fund	(260,000)	—	(220,780)	—
Total Net Worth	1,474,605	(86,316)	1,378,353	(113,003)
NET WORTH BY FUNCTION OR FUND				
Publishing — A.A. World Services, Inc. (Note A)	\$1,417,592		\$1,321,340	
General Fund — G.S.B. (Note B)	57,013		57,013	
Total Operating Funds — as above	1,474,605		1,378,353	
Reserve Fund	3,848,285		3,147,931	
Total Net Worth	5,322,890		4,526,284	
RESERVE FUND				
Cash	\$ 16,425		\$ (297)	
Money market and certificates of deposit	158,197		218,094	
Due from (to) A.A. Grapevine	—		9,500	
U.S. Treasury obligations	4,003,365		3,199,199	
Accrued interest	124,436		115,573	
Less: Liability for Grapevine subscribers	(454,138)		(394,138)	
Balance, December 31	3,848,285		3,147,931	

() denotes red figures

(continued)

Note B — After transfers of \$785,682 in 1984 and \$524,025 in 1983 from Publishing to General Fund.

Note C — Grapevine investment with Reserve Fund — \$454,138, represents the deferred subscription income of the Grapevine at December 31, 1979, less \$100,000 withdrawn by the Grapevine during 1981 to restore its then-depleted working capital, of which \$13,418 and \$60,000 was reinvested during 1983 and 1984, respectively.

These attached financial statements and above notes have been prepared from the reports on the three separate corporations submitted by our independent certified public accountant.

1985 G.S.O. Budget

A.A. WORLD SERVICES, INC. — PUBLISHING

Income: Sales income has been budgeted at \$7,236,100. Included in this projection is the income from the first year sales of the new book "Pass It On." During 1985, it is anticipated that A.A.W.S., Inc., will distribute 700,000 copies of "Alcoholics Anonymous," 360,000 "Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions"—regular edition, 62,000 "Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions"—pocket edition, 27,000 "A.A. Comes of Age," 76,000 "As Bill Sees It," 25,000 "Dr. Bob and the Good Oldtimers," 150,000 copies of "Pass It On," and more than 7,000,000 booklets, pamphlets, and miscellaneous items. After deducting \$3,473,300—the amount representing the cost of printing and producing items sold and the royalties paid on book sales—the gross profit from sales is estimated to be \$3,762,800. Adding interest earned on daily cash flow, the total income from the publishing activity is expected to be \$3,787,800.

Expenses: Expenses charged against the publishing operation are budgeted at \$2,283,100, representing an increase of 16% over 1984. Considered in this increase are higher costs related to increased publishing activity, the additional cost of handling, packing and shipping the new book and, to some extent, continuing inflationary pressures. Net publishing income, after operating expenses, is expected to be \$1,504,700.

GENERAL FUND — GROUP SERVICES

Income: Contributions from groups and A.A. members have been budgeted at \$2,281,100, an increase of 7.8% over 1984 actual, and interest on cash flow has been budgeted at \$4,500.

Expenses: Total expenses, representing the cost of group services that are paid out of contributions, are expected to be \$2,764,100. Included in this portion of the General Service Office budget is the cost of the General Service Conference, totaling \$165,700. The cost of all service expenses is budgeted to be \$478,500 greater than contribution income. This shortfall will be funded from the net income of the publishing operation.

GENERAL FUND — OTHER EXPENSES

Other expenses of the General Service Board are budgeted at \$282,900. Included in this category of expense are such items as the cost of quarterly trustee meetings, the expenses of the Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community, the cost of Regional Forums, legal and auditing fees, the expense of the archives, and the costs of filmstrips and displays. These expenses will be offset by net income from the publishing operation.

Net income for the General Service Office has been budgeted at \$743,300.

1985 Grapevine Budget

Total income: Income from magazine and other sales is budgeted at \$1,429,000. This represents an increase of \$236,000 over 1984, on the basis of additional sales income from the sale of the new book "The Best of Grapevine."

Total expenses: Expenses are budgeted at \$1,390,800. A net operating income in the amount of \$38,200 has been budgeted for 1985.

Including \$4,000 in interest earned on cash flow, total net income is budgeted to be \$42,200.

1985 G.S.O. Budget

The budget for 1985 operations of G.S.O. activities is as follows:

BUDGET

A.A. WORLD SERVICES, INC. — PUBLISHING

INCOME

Net sales	\$7,236,100*
Less: Cost of products and royalties	3,473,300
Gross profit from sales	3,762,800
Interest income	25,000
Total income	3,787,800

TOTAL EXPENSES

Net income	1,504,700
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*Based on the sale of:

700,000 books	—	"Alcoholics Anonymous"
360,000 books	—	"Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions" (reg.)
62,000 books	—	"Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions" (pocket)
27,000 books	—	"A.A. Comes of Age"
76,000 books	—	"As Bill Sees It"
25,000 books	—	"Dr. Bob and the Good Oldtimers"
150,000 books	—	"Pass It On"
and		
Pamphlets, booklets, and miscellaneous items		

GENERAL FUND — GROUP SERVICES

INCOME

Contributions	\$2,281,100
Interest income	4,500
Total income	2,285,600

TOTAL EXPENSES

Net expense	(478,500)
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**Includes cost of General Service Conference—\$165,700

GENERAL FUND — OTHER EXPENSES

TOTAL EXPENSES (NET)

\$ (282,900)***

***Board meetings, P.I.C. expense, C.P.C. expense, legal and auditing fees, Regional Forums, archives, filmstrips, etc.

The publishing activity will contribute \$761,400 toward the budgeted deficits, leaving a net G.S.O. income in the amount of \$743,300.

1985 Grapevine Budget

Estimated income from subscription and other sales	\$1,429,000
Total costs and expenses	1,390,800
Net income from operations	38,200
Interest	4,000
Total net income	42,200

Contributions

1984 Contributions From Groups – by Delegate Area

(in U.S. dollars)

Area #	General Service Conference Area	#Gps. Re-ported	#Gps. Contrib.	% of Gps. Contrib.	Total Group Contrib.	Member-ship	Contrib. per Capita	Area #	General Service Conference Area	#Gps. Re-ported	#Gps. Contrib.	% of Gps. Contrib.	Total Group Contrib.	Member-ship	Contrib. per Capita
1.	Ala./N.W. Fla.	279	170	60.9%	\$ 11,653.53	3,546	\$3.29	63.	S.Dak.	111	75	67.6	\$ 5,776.65	2,303	\$2.51
2.	Alsk.	139	64	46.0	6,283.94	1,595	3.94	64.	Tenn.	296	172	58.2	16,233.59	4,511	3.60
3.	Ariz.	472	223	47.2	20,231.31	7,906	2.56		Tex.						
4.	Ark.	174	84	48.3	5,163.36	2,531	2.04	65.	N.E.	283	170	60.1	23,534.38	8,283	2.84
5.	Calif.							66.	N.W.	180	89	49.4	8,639.36	3,897	2.22
6.	S.	1,177	518	44.0	67,107.32	36,672	1.83	67.	S.E.	349	181	51.9	19,732.33	10,351	1.91
7.	N. Coastal	1,347	928	68.9	115,384.51	32,503	3.55	68.	S.W.	322	178	55.3	17,029.41	6,272	2.72
8.	N. Int.	475	244	51.4	21,716.88	9,785	2.22	69.	Utah	147	70	47.6	5,437.01	2,390	2.27
9.	San Diego	413	230	55.7	19,885.99	10,614	1.87	70.	Vt.	129	65	50.4	5,250.53	2,002	2.62
10.	Mid-S.	1,034	537	51.9	57,358.53	31,716	1.81	71.	Va.	739	465	62.9	44,343.53	13,981	3.17
11.	Colo.	474	273	57.6	26,296.52	9,224	2.85	72.	Wash.	819	468	57.1	50,013.96	14,447	3.46
12.	Conn.	811	423	52.2	40,772.35	16,893	2.41	73.	W.Va.	184	99	53.8	6,319.82	1,954	3.23
13.	Del.	100	71	71.0	7,539.77	1,608	4.69		Wis.						
14.	D.C.	292	183	62.7	28,084.39	8,999	3.12	74.	N.Wisc./Upper Pen. Mich.	474	238	50.2	18,103.12	7,062	2.56
15.	N.	327	201	61.5	21,991.54	5,284	4.16	75.	S.	537	273	50.8	20,945.30	8,991	2.33
16.	S.	883	527	59.7	63,564.21	14,286	4.45	76.	Wyo.	100	64	64.0	3,072.05	1,501	2.05
17.	Ga.	488	307	62.9	29,769.12	8,915	3.34	77.	P.R.	107	68	63.6	3,254.61	1,369	2.38
18.	Haw.	160	110	68.8	11,014.77	2,688	4.10	78.	Alta./N.W.T.	436	208	47.7	17,658.79	5,641	3.13
19.	Idaho	153	64	41.8	3,769.95	1,690	2.23	79.	B.C./Yukon	545	267	49.0	22,336.96	7,793	2.87
20.	Ill.							80.	Man.	141	69	48.9	7,180.95	3,148	2.28
21.	Chicago	657	313	47.6	40,406.60	14,762	2.74	81.	N.B./P.E.I.	211	104	49.3	7,208.36	3,008	2.40
22.	N.	688	324	47.1	27,288.60	12,858	2.12	82.	N.S./Nfld./Lab.	234	121	51.7	7,665.58	2,730	2.81
23.	S.	288	125	43.4	9,166.04	4,590	2.00		Ont.						
24.	Indiana							83.	E.	475	191	40.2	18,648.23	10,526	1.77
25.	N.	404	216	53.5	20,185.90	6,092	3.31	84.	N.E.	168	69	41.1	6,047.79	1,957	3.09
26.	S.	232	154	66.4	15,985.24	4,324	3.70	85.	N.W.	75	35	46.7	6,469.69	1,156	5.60
27.	Iowa	517	293	56.7	21,622.27	9,988	2.16	86.	W.	417	157	37.6	17,291.33	6,417	2.69
28.	Kans.	297	188	63.3	14,112.96	6,118	2.31		Que.						
29.	Ky.	365	201	55.1	24,857.74	5,599	4.44	87.	S.W.	510	59	11.6	3,664.90	13,560	.27
30.	La.	375	212	56.5	17,405.43	5,973	2.91	88.	S.E.	222	183	82.4	12,707.35	3,052	4.16
31.	Me.	258	124	48.1	8,686.44	4,040	2.15	89.	N.E.	313	313	100.0	3,473.12	5,449	.64
32.	Md.	567	281	49.6	29,992.44	8,011	3.74	90.	N.W.	274	274	100.0	10,528.66	5,145	2.05
33.	Mass.							91.	Sask.	299	175	58.5	10,764.86	3,608	2.98
34.	E.	811	420	51.8	48,678.85	22,926	2.12		Total U.S./Canada	36,025	19,317	53.6%	\$1,864,249.87	702,052	\$2.66
35.	W.	131	82	62.6	8,665.04	2,612	3.32		Bahamas	7	1	14.3	74.30	87	.85
36.	Cent.	342	172	50.3	23,699.66	6,757	3.51		V.I. of U.S.	8	3	37.5	631.50	172	3.67
37.	S.E.	383	203	53.0	21,711.29	8,537	2.54		(U.S. dollars)	36,040	19,321 ^①	53.6% ^①	\$1,864,955.67 ^①	702,311	\$2.66 ^①
38.	W.	290	156	53.8	14,405.58	5,643	2.55		Individual, in-memoriam & special meetings				\$ 73,012.89		
39.	Minn.								Specials				155,659.18		
40.	N.	450	241	53.6	14,403.04	7,060	2.04		Total for U.S. & Canada (U.S. dollars)				\$2,093,627.74		
41.	S.	781	395	50.6	35,480.74	22,102	1.61		FOREIGN AND OTHER						
42.	Miss.	200	100	50.0	6,061.49	2,320	2.61		Birds of a Feather				\$ 585.00		
43.	Mo.								Correctional facility groups				107.65		
44.	E.	373	219	58.7	20,253.37	4,908	4.13		Foreign				14,531.16		
45.	W.	173	99	57.2	10,603.48	3,152	3.36		International Advisory Council of Young People in A.A.				492.96		
46.	Mont.	249	109	43.8	7,766.97	3,182	2.44		International Doctors in A.A.				350.00		
47.	Nebr.	527	296	56.2	30,458.82	9,406	3.24		International Lawyers in A.A.				300.00		
48.	Nev.	179	75	41.9	5,756.36	2,335	2.47		Internationalists				303.00		
49.	N.H.	243	116	47.7	11,128.53	3,365	3.31		Loners				1,354.28		
50.	N.J.								Treatment facility groups				4,536.91		
51.	N.	837	400	47.8	55,441.48	17,828	3.11		World Hello				60.03		
52.	S.	221	123	55.7	15,266.45	3,273	4.66		Grand Total				\$2,116,248.73		
53.	N.M.	199	109	54.8	9,452.81	2,905	3.25								
54.	N.Y.														
55.	Cent.	418	212	50.7	22,083.56	5,496	4.02								
56.	H./M./B.	376	186	49.5	12,167.15	4,568	2.66								
57.	S.E.	1,126	632	56.1	87,959.01	28,789	3.06								
58.	W.	194	92	47.4	6,642.05	2,766	2.40								
59.	N.C./Ber.	522	329	63.0	31,047.09	8,154	3.81								
60.	N.Dak.	144	78	54.2	5,883.79	2,397	2.45								
61.	Ohio														
62.	Cent. & S.E.	351	143	40.7	10,969.50	5,191	2.11								
63.	N.E.	779	224	28.8	14,722.45	19,434	.76								
64.	N.W. Ohio/														
65.	S.E. Mich.	207	91	44.0	7,896.17	2,840	2.78								
66.	S.W. Ohio/														
67.	N. Ky.	283	161	56.9	10,783.27	5,320	2.03								
68.	Okla.	313	234	74.8	21,695.85	4,018	5.40								
69.	Oreg.	463	238	51.4	18,242.16	6,273	2.91								
70.	Pa.														
71.	E.	688	397	57.7	43,403.95	14,688	2.96								
72.	W.	473	263	55.6	20,758.26	6,844	3.03								
73.	R.I.	166	98	59.0	11,691.00	2,773	4.22								
74.	S.C.	190	136	71.6	12,440.78	2,876	4.33								

CONTRIBUTION COMPARISON — 1984-1983

(in U.S. dollars)

	#Gps. Re-ported	#Gps. Contrib.	% of Gps. Contrib.	Amount of Contrib.	Member-ship	Contrib. per Capita
U.S. and Canada 1984	36,040	19,321 ^①	53.6% ^①	\$1,864,955.67 ^①	702,311	\$2.66 ^①
U.S. and Canada 1983	34,024	18,676 ^①	54.9% ^①	\$1,685,633.24 ^①	655,754	\$2.57 ^①
Increase (Decrease)	2,016	645	(1.3%)	\$179,322.43	46,557	\$.09

① Reflects not only those groups that contributed directly to G.S.O., but also those groups that contributed to G.S.O. through their Conference areas (per lists submitted by areas).

② Group contributions reported on this schedule do not include contributions received as specials, individual, in-memoriam, and special meetings.

U.S.	#Gps. Re- ported	#Gps. Contrib.	% of Gps. Contrib.	Amount of Contrib.	Member- ship	Contrib. per Capita
Alabama	222	136	61.3%	\$ 8,764.82	3,241	\$2.70
Alaska	139	64	46.0	8,151.64	1,595	5.11
Arizona	464	220	47.4	23,221.55	7,901	2.94
Arkansas	174	84	48.3	8,060.12	2,531	3.18
California	4,472	2,468	55.2	327,230.14	122,219	2.68
Colorado	473	273	57.7	31,885.91	9,214	3.46
Connecticut	823	431	52.4	47,841.44	17,134	2.79
Delaware	100	71	71.0	7,547.07	1,608	4.69
District of Columbia	128	71	55.5	12,248.83	4,231	2.90
Florida	1,266	761	60.1	98,843.27	20,281	4.87
Georgia	488	307	62.9	32,303.36	8,915	3.62
Hawaii	160	110	68.8	12,569.27	2,688	4.68
Idaho	184	80	43.5	4,414.83	2,035	2.17
Illinois	1,629	763	46.8	85,888.14	32,368	2.65
Indiana	666	385	57.8	40,171.89	10,889	3.69
Iowa	518	293	56.6	25,672.59	9,992	2.57
Kansas	297	188	63.3	14,679.76	6,118	2.40
Kentucky	340	188	55.3	28,151.14	5,253	5.36
Louisiana	375	212	56.5	18,907.84	5,973	3.17
Maine	250	119	47.6	10,253.21	3,955	2.59
Maryland	725	390	53.8	50,154.60	12,687	3.95
Massachusetts	956	506	52.9	65,526.30	25,764	2.54
Michigan	1,155	593	51.3	67,093.00	22,938	2.93
Minnesota	1,228	636	51.8	57,260.06	29,091	1.97
Mississippi	199	99	49.7	6,179.56	2,314	2.67
Missouri	547	319	58.3	33,298.44	8,073	4.13
Montana	249	109	43.8	8,136.22	3,182	2.56
Nebraska	527	296	56.2	41,000.82	9,406	4.36
Nevada	165	67	40.6	8,241.66	2,158	3.82
New Hampshire	247	120	48.6	12,151.40	3,423	3.55
New Jersey	1,055	522	49.5	77,840.73	21,036	3.70
New Mexico	198	110	55.6	10,100.03	2,783	3.63
New York	2,125	1,118	52.6	138,601.30	41,650	3.33
North Carolina	506	326	64.4	31,132.44	8,004	3.89
North Dakota	145	78	53.8	7,219.79	2,402	3.01
Ohio	1,592	613	38.5	51,401.39	32,158	1.60
Oklahoma	316	237	75.0	25,088.76	4,047	6.20
Oregon	467	238	51.0	21,489.15	6,327	3.40
Pennsylvania	1,178	667	56.6	66,798.45	21,793	3.07
Rhode Island	159	95	59.7	12,487.15	2,606	4.79
South Carolina	192	136	70.1	12,582.54	2,903	4.33
South Dakota	111	75	67.6	7,393.65	2,303	3.21
Tennessee	293	172	58.7	17,708.88	4,474	3.96
Texas	1,135	618	54.4	78,484.59	28,454	2.76
Utah	147	70	47.6	5,519.89	2,381	2.32
Vermont	127	62	48.8	5,801.53	1,962	2.96
Virginia	748	468	62.6	46,487.51	14,152	3.29
Washington	775	449	57.9	53,256.70	13,973	3.81
West Virginia	178	96	53.9	7,588.38	1,888	4.02
Wisconsin	903	458	50.7	36,399.47	14,935	2.44
Wyoming	101	65	64.3	3,085.05	1,509	2.04
Commonwealth of P.R.	107	68	63.6	3,421.11	1,369	2.50
Bahama Islands	7	1	14.3	74.30	87	.85
Virgin Islands of U.S.	8	3	37.5	631.50	172	3.67
Bermuda	15	2	13.3	470.00	134	3.51
TOTAL for U.S.	31,754	17,106	53.9%	\$1,916,913.17	630,679	\$3.04

① Reflects not only those groups that contributed directly to G.S.O., but also those groups that contributed to G.S.O. through their Conference areas (per lists submitted by areas).

CANADA (stated in Canadian dollars)	#Gps. Re- ported	#Gps. Contrib.	% of Gps. Contrib.	Amount of Contrib.	Member- ship	Contrib. per Capita
Alberta	390	190	48.7%	\$ 30,534.90	5,054	\$6.04
Atlantic Provinces						
New Brunswick	160	79	49.4	7,369.42	1,990	3.70
Newfoundland	86	36	41.9	3,311.98	835	3.97
Nova Scotia	147	83	56.5	7,177.79	1,874	3.83
Prince Edward Island	59	30	50.8	3,135.52	1,099	2.85
Labrador	2	2	100.0	44.45	37	1.20
British Columbia	576	277	48.1	39,656.06	8,150	4.87
Manitoba	141	69	48.9	10,361.49	3,148	3.29
N.W. Territories	16	5	31.2	229.15	188	1.22
Ontario	1,096	433	39.5	76,331.18	19,695	3.88
Quebec	1,303	831	63.8	41,942.56	25,786	1.63
Saskatchewan	302	176	58.3	17,476.39	3,663	4.77
Yukon Territory	8	4	50.0	460.59	113	4.08
TOTAL for CANADA (Canadian dollars)	4,286	2,215①	51.7%	238,031.48	71,632	3.32①
(converted to U.S. dollars)				176,714.57		2.47)
TOTAL for U.S. and CANADA (U.S. dollars)	36,040	19,321①	53.6%	\$2,093,627.74	702,311	2.98①
FOREIGN AND OTHER						
Birds of a Feather				585.00		
Correctional facility groups				107.65		
Foreign				14,531.16		
International Advisory Council of Young People in A.A.				492.96		
International Doctors in A.A.				350.00		
International Lawyers in A.A.				300.00		
Internationalists				303.00		
Loners				1,354.28		
Treatment facility groups				4,536.91		
World Hello				60.03		
GRAND TOTAL				\$2,116,248.73		

CONTRIBUTION COMPARISON — 1983-1984 (in U.S. dollars)

	#Gps. Re- ported	#Gps. Contrib.	% of Gps. Contrib.	Amount of Contrib.	Member- ship	Contrib. per Capita
U.S. 1984	31,754	17,106	53.9%	\$1,916,913.17	630,679	\$3.04
U.S. 1983	29,827	16,155	54.2	1,723,066.61	585,823	2.94
Increase (Decrease)	1,927	951	(0.3%)	\$ 193,846.56	44,856	.10
Canada 1984	4,286	2,215①	51.7%①	\$ 176,714.57	71,632	\$2.47①
Canada 1983	4,197	2,521①	60.1 ①	184,700.05	69,931	2.64①
Increase (Decrease)	89	(306)	(8.4%)	(\$ 7,985.48)	1,701	(\$.17)
U.S. and Canada 1984	36,040	19,321①	53.6%①	\$2,093,627.74	702,311	\$2.98①
U.S. and Canada 1983	34,024	18,676①	54.9 ①	1,907,766.66	655,754	2.91①
Increase (Decrease)	2,016	645	(1.3%)	\$ 185,861.08	46,557	\$.07

1985 Conference Committees

Conference Agenda

²Ken Beckerich
Ray Donovan
Georges Filion
James Johnson
¹Tillie McNulty
Emily Rayford
Pat Walsh
Drexel Williams

Secretary: Lois Fisher

Cooperation With the Professional Community

²Charles Asher
Paul Black
Richard Bush
Day Fezler
Noel Quesnelle
¹Richard Roughton
Evelyn Vyverberg
Max Wilson

Secretary: Curtis Monahan

Correctional Facilities

Jean-Marie Alain
Robert Easby
²M. Lee Forsythe
Marian Hutchison
Bobby Melton
Jack Ostrem
John Quinn
D. T. Waller Jr.

Secretary: Eileen Gatza

Finance

Chuck Furtaw
Ann Garrity
²Richard Haas
Richard Koseski
¹Jim McKnight
Ruth Nicol
Robert O'Rourke
Pat Rosentiel

Secretary: Dennis Manders

Grapevine

¹Jeff Hampton
James Hill
Josh Hill
Egbert Jones
Ed Price
²Frank Rice
Maurice Rondeau
John Schutt Jr.
Frederick Yourdon

Secretary: Ann Warner

Literature

Mary Ann Bagi
Elke Forbes
Jean Lapointe
²Tom McKay
Jack McLemore
Robert Olson
¹Bob Picard
Diane Salavich
Kathleen Tartre

Secretary: Vinnie McCarthy

Conference Policy/Admissions

²Kathleen Carr
Jim Doss
Lois Fischer
Mel Hanna
¹David Hill
David O'Leary
Mary Reynolds
Jaime Rocafort

Secretary: Betty Liddle

Public Information

John Denham
²Christina Heindel
Bob Neerland
Harlan Petter
¹Jim Rogers
Frank Sauer
Adam Tengler
Murray White

Secretary: Lyla Bonney Hogg

Conference Report and Charter

Eleanor Boyle
Richard Klaras
Helen McClure
Robert Schneck
²Lawrence Shuler
Dale Skelton
¹Leslie Watson
Faye Woodall

Secretary: Helen Turnquest

Treatment Facilities

Thomas Eser
Elizabeth Garnett
²John Landon
¹Willard Machen
Hubert Malone
George Mudrich
Diane Olsen
William Wilson

Secretary: Cheryl Ann Burke

Committee on Trustees

Mildred Baeseman
Tom Hearn
²Agnes Krueger
Dennis Moore
Harold Stevens
¹Donald Weaver
Suzanne Wieland
Homer Wilkinson
Robert Woods

Secretary: Phyllis Masback

1985 International Convention Committee

Day Fezler, Oklahoma
¹Georges Filion, S.W. Quebec
Agnes Krueger, N. Dakota
Robert Olson, Washington
Emily Rayford, S.E. New York

Bob Schneck, N. Florida
John Schutt Jr., W. Massachusetts
Dale Skelton, S.W. Ohio/N. Ky.
Murray White, Manitoba

Secretary: Sarah Price

New chairpersons and alternate chairpersons

Committee

Conference Agenda
Cooperation With the Professional Community
Correctional Facilities
Finance
Grapevine
Literature
Conference Policy/Admissions

Public Information
Conference Report and Charter
Treatment Facilities
Committee on Trustees

Chairperson

Patrick Walsh, Hawaii

Day Fezler, Oklahoma
Robert Easby, E. Ontario
Ann Garrity, S. California
Frederick Yourdon, Nevada
Diane Salavich, N.W. Ontario
Jim Doss, Cent. New York

Harlan Petter, Arkansas
Robert Schneck, N. Florida
Diane Olsen, N. Coastal Calif.
Harold Stevens, B.C./Yukon

Alternate

James Johnson, N.C./Bermuda

Richard Bush, W. Missouri
John Quinn, N. New Jersey
Pat Rosentiel, N.E. Texas
Josh Hill, S. Florida
Bob Olson, Washington
David O'Leary, Nova Scotia/
Nfld./Lab.
Bob Neerland, E. Pennsylvania
Helen McClure, S.E. Texas
Bill Wilson, Chicago
Dennis Moore, E. Missouri

Archives

Garrett Taylor, *chairperson*
Joan Jackson, Ph.D.
Joe Kraus
Milton Maxwell, Ph.D.
Shepherd Raimi
James Shannon
Kenneth Williams, M.D.
George Gordon, Ph.D., *consultant*
Nell Wing, *consultant*
Frank Mauser, *secretary*

Conference

Natalie Schwanke, *chairperson*
David Aronofsky
Dan Byrne
John Ford
Harold Greene
Ralph Rosenberg Jr.
Jacquelyn Solomon
Garrett Taylor
Lois Fisher, *secretary*

Cooperation With the Professional Community

O. S. Bruner, *chairperson*
Paul Dooling
William Flynn, M.D.
Joan Jackson, Ph.D.
Joe Kraus
Herbert McBride, M.D.
Corryne Pettey
Shepherd Raimi
James Shannon
Kenneth Williams, M.D.
Curtis Monahan, *secretary*

Correctional Facilities

W. J. Estelle Jr., *chairperson*
Dan Byrne
Kenneth Dunphy
Hermine Johnson
William Kubinski
Stanley Silverman
Hylan Sperbeck
Garrett Taylor
Eileen Gatz, *secretary*

Employee Retirement

Robert Morse, *chairperson*
W. J. Estelle Jr.
Thomas Jasper
Joe Kraus
Stanley Silverman
Michael Alexander, *consultant*
George Dorsey, *consultant*
Owen Flanagan, C.P.A., *consultant*
Robert Pearson, *secretary*
Dennis Manders, *assistant secretary*

Finance

Robert Morse, *chairperson*
Michael Alexander
David Aronofsky
O. S. Bruner
W. J. Estelle Jr.
John Ford
Wayne Parks
Shepherd Raimi
Owen Flanagan, C.P.A., *consultant*
Dennis Manders, *secretary*

International

David Aronofsky, *chairperson*
John Ford
William Flynn, M.D.
Harold Greene
Helen Harmon
Robert Morse
John Norris, M.D.
Stanley Silverman
Isa Stanfiel, *consultant*
Susan Daly, *secretary*

International Convention/ A.A. Regional Forums

Kenneth Dunphy, *chairperson*
William Croke
William Flynn, M.D.
Harold Greene
Thomas Jasper
Wayne Parks
Natalie Schwanke
Desmond Towey
Sarah Price, *secretary*

Literature

Helen Harmon, *chairperson*
Michael Alexander
William Croke
John Ford
Joan Jackson, Ph.D.
Ralph Rosenberg Jr.
Jacquelyn Solomon
Desmond Towey
Kenneth Williams, M.D.
Vinnie McCarthy, *secretary*

Nominating

Joe Kraus, *chairperson*
Michael Alexander
Dan Byrne
O. S. Bruner
W. J. Estelle Jr.
Helen Harmon
Wayne Parks
Natalie Schwanke
Jacquelyn Solomon
Phyllis Masback, *secretary*

Public Information

Ralph Rosenberg Jr., *chairperson*
Walter Bobbie
O. S. Bruner
William Bruner
William Croke
Robert Durling
Sam Elfert
Karen Irland
Howard Levine
Lynn Palmer
Garrett Taylor
Desmond Towey
Edward McDougal, *consultant*
Lyla Bonney Hogg, *secretary*

Treatment Facilities

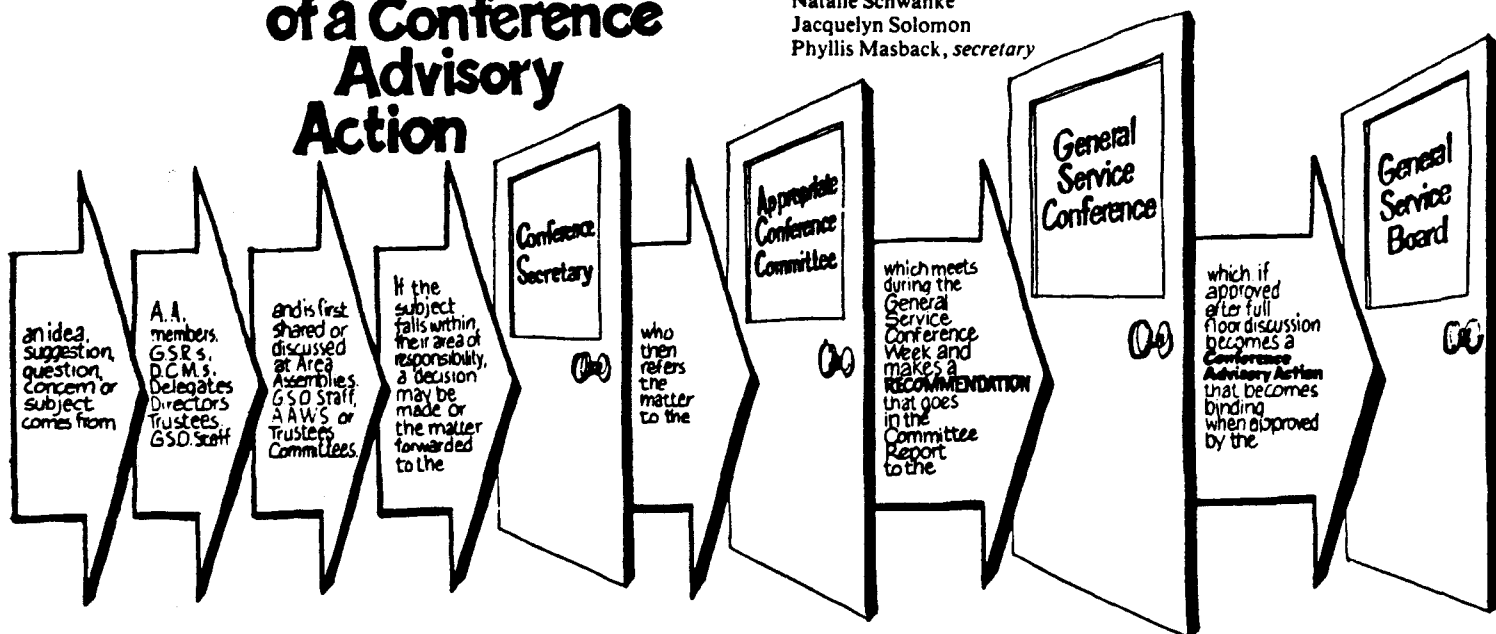
Joan Jackson, Ph.D., *chairperson*
James Ahern
Kenneth Dunphy
Hugh Freyer
Helen Harmon
Thomas Jasper
James Shannon
Kenneth Williams, M.D.
Cheryl Ann Burke, *secretary*

General Sharing Session

William Flynn, M.D., *chairperson*
Betty Liddle, *secretary*
All members of the General Service Board, A.A.W.S. and GV Boards, G.S.O. and GV staffs, and trustees' committees participate in this "town meeting."

Gordon Patrick and John Bragg are ex officio members of all committees. Committee secretaries and consultants do not vote.

Flow Chart of a Conference Advisory Action



1985 Conference Members

Nonalcoholic (Class A) trustees

Gordon M. Patrick (Box 100, Lyndhurst, Ont. K0E 1N0, Canada) was elected to the board in 1975 and became its chairperson in 1982. Recently retired, he was a management consultant with a special interest in helping organizations develop programs for employees disabled by alcoholism. Formerly associated with the Addiction Research Foundation of Ontario and the Donwood Institute, he has a continuing interest in employee assistance programs and professional education. A longtime friend of A.A., Gordon considers it "the most useful resource for recovery from alcoholism."

Michael Alexander (150 East 69th St., New York, NY 10021) was elected a trustee in 1976 after 20 years as legal advisor to the board. A partner in the law firm of Smith, Steibel, Alexander, and Saskor, P.C., Mike was long an associate of the late Bernard Smith—so significant in A.A. history. Graduated from the University of Pittsburgh and Harvard Law School, Mike was a captain in the U.S. Army. He is a director and past president of the British American Chamber of Commerce, trustee and past president of the Consular Law Society, and director and secretary of the Ireland-U.S. Council for Commerce and Industry. Mike serves on the Finance and Budgetary, Nominating, and Literature Committees and is a nonvoting consultant on the Employee Retirement Committee.

W. J. (Jim) Estelle Jr. (114 Sunset Lake Dr., Huntsville, TX 77340), former director, Texas Department of Corrections, became a trustee in April 1977. Born in Indiana and educated in California, Jim began his corrections career in 1952 and served as warden of Montana State Prison for two years. He has taught courses in corrections and is a member of seven professional societies concerned with criminal justice, correction, and services to children and youth. Since retiring from corrections work, he has been employed as vice president of the First National Bank, Huntsville, Texas. Jim is chairperson of the Committee on Correctional Facilities and also serves on the Finance and Budgetary, Employee Retirement, and Nominating Committees.

William E. Flynn, M.D. (1164 Old Gate Ct., McLean, VA 22101) joined the board in April 1980. A graduate of the Georgetown University School of Medicine, he was certified in psychiatry by the American Board of Psychiatry and Neurology. Currently assistant professor of psychiatry at Georgetown and director of studies in alcohol and drug abuse, Bill is also consultant to the National Center for Alcohol Education and the alcohol treatment unit at Arlington Hospital, Virginia. Bill serves on the Cooperation With the Professional Community, International, and International Convention/A.A. Regional Forums Committees and is a member of the Grapevine Corporate Board.

Joan K. Jackson, Ph.D. (72 Downs Rd., Bethany, CT 06525) was elected to the board in April 1983. A graduate of McGill University, Montreal, and the University of Washington, Seattle, Joan taught sociology at both universities for many years. She has served as consultant and editorial adviser for many local and national boards and committees on alcoholism and on health and human behavior. At the University of Washington Medical School in Seattle, Joan engaged in research and teaching about alcoholism, A.A., and Al-Anon. She is a member of the Archives, Literature, and Cooperation With the Professional Community Committees and serves as chairperson of the Treatment Facilities Committee.

Robert P. Morse (96 Cove Rd., Oyster Bay, NY 11771) was elected to the board in April 1984. A graduate of the University of Pennsylvania, he has over 15 years' experience in the investment business, with an in-depth background in the fixed-income sector and management of equity portfolios. He now has his own investment counsel firm and is president of the Wall Street Fund. Robert is a member of the International Committee and is chairperson of both the Finance and Budgetary and Employee Retirement Committees.

Kenneth H. Williams, M.D. (Universal Health Recovery Center, Universal Health Services, 367 S. Gulph Rd., King of Prussia, PA 19506) joined the board in 1979. Formerly an associate professor at the University of Pittsburgh School of Medicine, he also served as medical consultant to the Governor's Council on Drug and Alcohol Abuse (Pennsylvania) and to a residential detoxification program in Pittsburgh. Previously, Ken was a full-time faculty member at the Yale University School of Medicine. He is now director of a community-oriented alcoholism treatment program which involves families and employers, and he spends much time speaking and writing about alcoholism. Ken serves on the Treatment Facilities, Archives, Cooperation With the Professional Community, and Literature Committees.

Alcoholic (Class B) trustees

David H. Aronofsky (2503 W. Jefferson, Dallas, TX 75211) was elected trustee-at-large/U.S. in May 1981. He has been chairperson of the Dallas Metroplex Intergroup and of the Conference Finance Committee (as a Panel 27 delegate) and has remained active in area service. A doctor of dental surgery, David belongs to five professional organizations. He is chairperson of the International Committee, a member of the Conference and Finance Committees, and serves as treasurer of the Grapevine Corporate Board.

O. S. (Buck) Bruner (5161 Windridge Dr., Indianapolis, IN 46226) joined the board as East Central U.S. regional trustee in May 1981. Buck has background of intergroup, area, and state service and was a Panel 28 Conference delegate. A World War II bomber pilot, he is a graduate of the University of Michigan Law School and currently heads his own insurance agency. Buck serves on the Finance and Budgetary, Nominating, and Public Information Committees and chairs the Cooperation With the Professional Community Committee.

Dan M. Byrne (2900 19th Avenue, Marion, IA 52302) was elected West Central regional trustee in April 1984. Dan has a background of group and area service and was a Panel 29 Conference delegate. He is currently employed by the Quaker Oats Cereal Company, Cedar Rapids. Dan serves on the Conference, Correctional Facilities, Finance and Budgetary, and Nominating Committees.

Kenneth L. Dunphy (115 Humphrey St., Moncton, N.B. E1C 6P2, Canada), elected Eastern Canada regional trustee in 1982, has been active in district and area service and was a Conference delegate (1976-77). Having a background in electromechanical drafting, Ken taught drafting in high school. He then worked in the mining industry and later for the Canadian Government, where he is now employed as a drafting supervisor and is an A.A. contact for the employee assistance program. Ken serves on the Correctional Facilities and Treatment Facilities Committees and

chairs the International Convention/A.A. Regional Forums Committee. He is also a member of the Grapevine Corporate Board.

John R. (Jack) Ford (3092 West King Edward, Vancouver, B.C. V6L 1V5, Canada) was elected Western Canada regional trustee in April 1984. Jack has been active in group, intergroup, and area service; as a Panel 29 Conference delegate, he chaired the Finance and Budgetary Committee. He is owner of an auto sales and service center. Jack currently serves on the Conference, Finance and Budgetary, International, and Literature Committees.

Helen A. Harmon (Box 391, Melita, Man., R0M 1L0, Canada) was elected trustee-at-large/Canada in April 1983. Helen has served her area as G.S.R., D.C.M., and a Panel 28 Conference delegate, and she remains active in group and area service. She is owner and operator of a franchise for income tax preparation and a salesperson for mutual funds and investments. She has served on the board of directors of the Alcoholism Foundation of Manitoba. Helen is a member of the Treatment Facilities, International, and Nominating Committees and chairs the Literature Committee.

Thomas K. Jasper Jr. (486 Seventh St., Brooklyn, NY 11215), elected general service trustee in April 1984, has been active in group and area service. A practicing attorney, he has acted as general counsel to many nonprofit organizations. Tom is a member of the Treatment Facilities, Employee Retirement, and International Convention/A.A. Regional Forums Committees and serves on the A.A.W.S. Board.

¹**Joe F. Kraus** (P.O. Drawer G, Lawrenceburg, TN 38464) joined the board as Southeast U.S. regional trustee in May 1981. After a term as a delegate (Panel 26), Joe returned to area activities. He has been in insurance, real estate, and finance, has his own company specializing in the last two fields, and has also taken part in many aspects of community service. Joe is a member of the Archives, Employee Retirement, and Cooperation With the Professional Community Committees and chairs the Nominating Committee.

Wayne Parks (1120 West Cypress, Rogers, AR 72756) was elected Southwest U.S. regional trustee in April 1983. Wayne has a background in area service; after serving as Conference delegate (Panel 29), he returned to area activities. He has worked in the oil sales, freight, and furniture fields. Wayne serves on the Arizona Alcohol and Drug Abuse Authority and on the Alcohol and Drug Abuse Advisory Council. He is a member of the Finance and Budgetary, International Convention/A.A. Regional Forums, and Nominating Committees and serves on the A.A.W.S. Board.

²**Joe Phelan** (272 The South Chace, Atlanta, GA 30328) was elected Southeast U.S. regional trustee in April 1985. Joe has been active in group and area service; as a Panel 30 Conference delegate, he chaired the Conference Finance Committee. He has served on the Georgia Task Force on Alcohol, Marijuana, and Other Drugs and was president of the Metro Atlanta Council on Alcoholism. Now retired, Joe's background is in the finance and banking fields.

²**Don I. Pritts** (1009 So. Lewiston Way, Aurora CO 80017) was elected trustee-at-large, U.S./Canada in April 1985. He has been active in group and area service and was a Panel 31 Conference delegate. A part-time volunteer for adolescent treatment units, Don has been an employment counselor. Currently he is an area

manager for the Conklin Co., in which capacity he establishes and trains franchise holders.

Ralph Rosenberg Jr. (410 West 24th St., New York, NY 10011), elected general service trustee in April 1984, has been active in group and intergroup service. He has been a radio and TV writer and has a background in advertising. Ralph has served on the Grapevine Editorial Board and is now a Grapevine director, a member of the Conference and Literature Committees, and chairperson of the Public Information Committee.

Natalie Schwanke (14601 N.E. 35th Bellevue, WA 98007) was elected Pacific U.S. regional trustee in 1982. Natalie has served both the Seattle Intergroup and her area and was a Panel 25 Conference delegate. She has been active in community affairs and is a manufacturers' representative in women's clothing and accessories. Natalie chairs the Conference Committee and is a member of the International Convention/A.A. Regional Forums and Nominating Committees. She also serves on the A.A.W.S. Board.

¹**Jacquelyn (Jackie) Solomon** (303 E. 37th St., New York, NY 10016) became a general service trustee in May 1981, having been an A.A.W.S. director from 1976 to 1980. Jackie has also been involved in group, intergroup, and area service. Her background is in the fashion sales field (she once owned a boutique), but she is now a distributor/supervisor in the field of nutrition. Jackie is a member of Conference, Literature, and Nominating Committees and serves on the A.A.W.S. Board.

Garrett Taylor (50 55th St. S.E., Washington, DC 20019) was elected Northeast U.S. regional trustee in April 1983. Garrett was chairperson of Washington Intergroup and of the area committee. After serving as a Panel 27 delegate, he returned to area activities. A retired postal manager, Garrett remains active in civic affairs. He is a member of the Conference, Public Information, and Correctional Facilities Committees and chairs the Archives Committee.

²**John R. (Jack) Whitehouse** (24353 Bashian Dr., Novi, MI 48050) was elected East Central U.S. regional trustee in April 1985. He has been active in group and area service and was a Panel 31 Conference delegate. A practicing attorney, Jack now serves as administrative law judge, Workers' Disability Compensation Bureau, for the State of Michigan's Department of Labor.

Officers of the General Service Board

Chairperson	Gordon Patrick
First vice-chairperson	Michael Alexander
Second vice-chairperson	W. J. (Jim) Estelle Jr.
Secretary	Joe Kraus
Treasurer	Robert P. Morse
Assistant treasurer	Dennis Manders
Assistant secretary	Betty Liddle

The new slate of officers (post-Conference) is given on page 45.

1 Retiring at the close of the 1985 Conference Meeting.

2 New trustee, becoming a Conference member immediately after election by the General Service Board, April 20, 1985.

1985 Conference Members

A.A. World Services directors

Jacquelyn Solomon, *chairperson*
William Croke
Harold Greene
Thomas Jasper
Betty Liddle

Wayne Parks
Robert G. Pearson
Shepherd Raimi
Natalie Schwanke

A.A. Grapevine directors

Ralph Rosenberg Jr., *chairperson*
David H. Aronofsky
Kenneth L. Dunphy
William E. Flynn, M.D.
Retha Gresham

Jim Shannon
Stanley Silverman
Desmond Towey
Ann Warner

General Service Office staff

John Bragg, *general manager*
Cheryl Ann Burke
Susan Daly
Lois Fisher
Eileen Gatzka
Lyla Bonney Hogg
Betty Liddle

Phyllis Masback
Vincina McCarthy
Curtis Monahan
Sarah Price
Helen Turnquest
Frank Mauser, *archivist*
Vincente Mejia, *Spanish services*

Grapevine staff

Gene Austin
Retha Gresham

Ann Warner

Others Assisting at the Conference (nonvoting)

G.S.O./Grapevine Personnel

Rosa Blanco, *Steno/Clerical Department*
Ed Brady, *Steno/Clerical Department*
Lynda Ernst, *Steno/Clerical Department*
Owen J. Flanagan, *independent C.P.A.*
Elizabeth Garcia, *supervisor, Steno/Clerical Department*
Edward Gordon, *assistant controller/manager, supporting departments*
Dorothy Graham, *writer/editor, Conference Report*
Margie Janicek, *Steno/Clerical Department*
Carrie Jaycox, *Steno/Clerical Department*
John Kirwin Jr., *supervisor, Accounting Department*
Ceile Lerner, *Steno/Clerical Department*
Jean Nicol, *Steno/Clerical Department*
Dennis Manders, *controller/business administrator*
Dorothy McGinity, *Conference Manual coordinator*
Don Meurer, *Grapevine controller*
Tony Osnato, *office manager*
Elsie Oxman, *assistant to the office manager*
Virginia Poole, *Steno/Clerical Department*
Ivelisse Rivera, *Steno/Clerical Department*
Frank Segui, *Steno/Clerical Department*
Joan Smith, *Steno/Clerical Department*
Naomi Strassberg, *Grapevine executive secretary*
Cynthia White, *Steno/Clerical Department*
Madeline Whitlock, *secretary, A.A. World Services*
Eleanor Widdoes, *production, Early Bird Box 4-5-9*
Adeline Wilmot, *assistant to the Conference coordinator*

Trustees emeriti

Milton Maxwell, Ph.D.
John L. Norris, M.D.

All nontrustee, nondirector members of the trustees' committees are encouraged to attend and participate at the joint meetings. They are also encouraged to attend, as observers, the Monday sessions of the Conference and one presentation session related to the committee on which they serve.

Area delegates

What do panel numbers mean? Delegates to each Conference are made up of two "panels." One is even-numbered and includes those elected to start serving in an even year. The other is odd-numbered and includes those elected to start serving in an odd year. The 35th Conference includes Panel 34 (delegates now serving for their second year) and Panel 35 (new delegates).

State	Area no.	Panel	
Alabama/N.W. Florida	1	35	Jack K. McLemore, 820 Giles Dr. N.E., Huntsville, AL 13801
Alaska	2	34	Kathleen J. Carr, P.O. Box 87-3453, Wasilla, AK 99687
Arizona	3	34	David H. Hill, 373 N. Wilmot #814, Tucson, AZ 85711
Arkansas	4	35	Harlan Petter, 5 Kings Highway, Eureka Springs, AR 72632
California	5	35	Southern—Ann Garrity, 1418 Los Osos Rd., Los Osos, CA 93402
	6	35	Northern Coastal—Diane M. Olsen, 14630 Springer Ct., Saratoga, CA 95070
	7	34	Northern Interior—Leslie S. Watson, 204 Touchstone Pl., W. Sacramento, CA 95691
	8	34	San Diego—Tom McKay, 309 S. Nevada, Oceanside, CA 92054
	9	34	Mid-Southern—Frank Sauer, 1356 Summerland, San Pedro, CA 90732
Colorado	10	35	Ed Price, P.O. Box 377, Franktown, CO 80116
Connecticut	11	35	Richard Koseski, 260 Three Mile Rd., Glastonbury, CT 06033
Delaware	12	34	Elke B. Forbes, 1314 Quincy Dr., Wilmington, DE 19803
District of Columbia	13	35	Eleanor Boyle, 10820 Georgia Ave. #312, Wheaton, MD 20902
Florida	14	35	North—Robert Schneck, 1282 The Grove Rd., Orange Park, FL 32073
	15	35	South/Bahamas—Josh Hill, 2500 S.W. 75th Ave., Miami, FL 33155
Georgia	16	34	Frank Rice, 660 Highway 314, Fayetteville, GA 30214
Hawaii	17	35	Patrick Walsh, P.O. Box 89200, Honolulu, HI 96830

State	Area no.	Panel	
Idaho	18	34	Jeff Hampton, 228 Dubois, Twin Falls, ID 83301
Illinois	19	35	Chicago—William Wilson, 9231 S. Mozart, Evergreen Park, IL 60642
	20	34	Northern—Jack L. Ostrem, 913 Grand Blvd., Joliet, IL 60436
	21	35	Southern—James R. Hill, 85 Forest View Rd., Morton, IL 61550
Indiana	22	35	Northern—Hubert Malone, 50 Elkton Ct., Lafayette, IN 47905
	23	34	Southern—Charles Asher, 414 S. Garvin, Evansville, IN 47713
Iowa	24	35	Evelyn Vyverberg, 5638 Quercus Ln., Davenport, IA 52806
Kansas	25	34	Robert O'Rourke, 112 E. Third, Smith Center, KS 66967
Kentucky	26	34	Drexel Williams, 206 Princess Dr., Ashland, KY 41101
Louisiana	27	35	D. T. Waller Jr., 7344 Sheffield Ct., Baton Rouge, LA 70806
Maine	28	34	Homer Wilkinson, Box 146, Otter Creek, ME 04665
Maryland	29	34	Thomas Eser, 1014 Emmerick Dr., Joppatowne, MD 21085
Massachusetts	30	35	Eastern—Mary E. Reynolds, 18 Rainbow Pond Dr., Walpole, MA 02081
	31	34	Western—John F. Schutt Jr., 66 Mill St., Springfield, MA 01108
Michigan	32	35	Central—Charles Furtaw, 3802 Craig, Flint, MI 48506
	33	35	Southeastern—Adam Tengler, 22447 Oaklane, Warren, MI 48089
	34	34	Western—Donald Weaver, 920 Washington #1, Kalamazoo, MI 49001
Minnesota	35	34	Northern—Bob Picard, 3801 East Third St., Superior, WI 54880
	36	35	Southern—Richard J. Klaras, R.R. 1, Box 21, Webster, MN 55088
Mississippi	37	34	James R. Parker,* R.R. 4, Box 437-B, Batesville, MS 38606

State	Area no.	Panel	
Missouri	38	35	Eastern—Dennis Moore, #12 Trailside Dr., Lake St. Louis, MO 63367
	39	35	Western—Richard Bush, P.O. Box 176, Neosho, MO 64850
Montana	40	34	Faye Woodall, 397 Bonner Rd., Helena, MT 59601
Nebraska	41	34	Max Wilson, 3026 S. 32nd St., Omaha, NE 68105
Nevada	42	35	Fredrick Yourdon, 365 Denslowe Dr., Reno NV 89512
New Hampshire	43	34	Tillie McNulty, 338 Laydon St., Manchester, NH 03103
New Jersey	44	35	Northern—John Quinn, 66 Brookwood Pkwy., Jackson, NJ 08527
	45	34	Southern—Ruth Nichol, 70 N. Girard St., Woodbury, NJ 08096
New Mexico	46	34	Mary Ann Bagi, Star Rt. 2, Box E-227, Moriarty, NM 87035
New York	47	35	Central—Jim Doss, P.O. Box 68, Harford, NY 13784
	48	34	Hudson/Mohawk/Berkshire—Suzanne Wieland, 56 Red Fox Dr., Albany, NY 12205
	49	35	Southeastern—Emily Rayford, c/o Mrs. Darby, Apt. 1D, 151 N. Oxford Walk, Brooklyn, NY 11205
	50	34	Western—Elizabeth Garnett, 320 Perry St. #3 C, Buffalo, NY 14204
	51	35	James S. Johnson, P.O. Box 3146, Wilson, NC 27895-3146
North Carolina/Bermuda			
North Dakota	52	34	Agnes L. Krueger, Rt. #2, Pick City, Hazen, ND 58545
Ohio	53	35	Central & Southeast—George Mudrich, 3387 Medina Ave., Columbus, OH 43224
	54	35	Northeast—Lois Fischer, 16340 Heather Lane, Middleburg Heights, OH 44130
	55	34	N.W. Ohio/S.E. Mich.—Paul Black, Box 1354, Toledo, OH 43603
	56	34	S.W. Ohio/N. Ky.—Dale Skelton, Box 1943, Cincinnati, OH 45201

*Alternate Egbert Jones (335 Chulahoma Ave., Holly Springs, MS 38653), was seated at the Conference in place of James Parker.

Rosters

State	Area no.	Panel	
Oklahoma	57	35	Day Fezler, 3508 Treadwell Dr., Oklahoma City, OK 73112
Oregon	58	34	Kenneth E. Beckerich, 20150 S. Leland Rd., Oregon City, OR 97045
Pennsylvania	59	35	Eastern—Robert G. Neerland, 1235 Wilmington Pike, Westchester, PA 19380
	60	35	Western—Ray Donovan, 415 Duquesne Dr., Pittsburgh, PA 15243
Rhode Island	61	34	Richard A. Roughton, 20 Phillips St., Providence, RI 02906
South Carolina	62	34	Lawrence Shuler, Route 5, Box 160, Chester, SC 29706
South Dakota	63	34	John M. Landon, 200 E. Short St., Box 386, Beresford, SD 57004
Tennessee	64	34	Bobby Melton, 1615 Eagle Dr., Hixson, TN 37343
Texas	65	35	Northeast—Pat Rosenstiel, Box 682, Commerce, TX 75428
	66	34	Northwest—Willard Machen, 1931 S. Harrison, Amarillo, TX 79109
	67	35	Southeast—Helen McClure, 4910 Maple St., Bellaire, TX 77401
	68	34	Southwest—Jim Rogers, 2001 N. 25th St., Harlingen, TX 78550
Utah	69	35	Marian Hutchison, 738 North 1100 East, St. George, UT 84770
Vermont	70	34	Richard Haas, Box 276, Townshend, VT 05353
Virginia	71	35	Tom Hearn, P.O. Box 1457, Suffolk, VA 23434
Washington	72	35	Robert Olson, 142 Lake Blvd., Shelton, WA 98584
West Virginia	73	35	John R. Denham, 111 Seneca Dr., Clarksburg, WV 26301
Wisconsin	74	34	N. Wis./Up. Pen. Mich.—Christina J. Heindel, 504 N. Margaret St., Kaukauna, WI 54130
	75	35	Southern—Mildred Baeseman, 5700 W. Wahner #203, Brown Deer, WI 53223

State	Area no.	Panel	
Wyoming	76	34	Robert F. Woods, P.O. Box 164, Sheridan, WY 82801
Puerto Rico	77	34	Jaime L. Rocafort, #1691 Calle Juan Kepler, Urb. Tulipan, Cupey, Rio Piedras, PR 00926
Canada			
Province			
Alberta/ Northwest Territories	78	34	Kathleen Tartre, 1606-10531 90th St., Edmonton, AB T5H 4E7
British Columbia/ Yukon	79	35	Harold M. Stevens, 1529 Dogwood Ave., Comox, BC V9N 5W9
Manitoba	80	34	Murray White, 131 Barron Dr., Winnipeg, MB R3K 0G3
New Brunswick/Prince Edward Island	81	34	M. Lee Forsythe, 4 Messer Dr., Sherwood, P.E.I. C1A 7S7
Nova Scotia/ Newfoundland/Labrador	82	35	David F. O'Leary, 3 Nightingale Rd., St. John's, Nfld A1E 2G4
Ontario	83	35	Eastern—Robert Easby, 919 River Rd., Ottawa, ON K1K 3V2
	84	35	Northeast—Noel T. Quesnelle, 701 Prete St., Sudbury, ON P3E 3X4
	85	35	Northwest—Diane Salavich, Box 9, Group 19, R.R. #1, Dryden, ON P8N 2Y4
	86	34	Western—Mel Hanna, Box 651, Owen Sound, ON N4K 5R4
Quebec	87	34	Southwest—Georges Filion, 114 6eme Ave., Verdun, PQ H4G 2Z9
	88	35	Southeast—Maurice Rondeau, P.O. Box 16, Norton, VT 05907
	89	35	Northeast—Jean Baptiste Lapointe, 100 Dorval, Charlesbourg, PQ G2N 1J3
	90	34	Northwest—Jean-Marie Alain, C.P. 254, Succ. Ahuntic, Montreal, PQ H3L 3N8
Saskatchewan	91	34	Jim McKnight, 2846 Wyllie Cres., Prince Albert, SK S6V 6M2